CRASH BANDICOOT™

PlayStation™

SONY COMPUTER ENTERTAINMENT

THE OFFICIAL STRATEGY GUIDE

MY TRIP TO SEATTLE

BY CRASH BANDICOOT™

1. HERE'S ME DRIVING.

4. HERE'S ME SHOWING OFF MY GAME'S REAL-TIME 3-D WORLD WITH ITS LUSH, ORGANIC ENVIRONMENTS, TONS OF OBSTACLES, SECRET PATHWAYS AND BONUS LEVELS. OUTSIDE OF NINTENDO® HEADQUARTERS.

5. HERE'S ME BEING ESCORTED OFF THE PREMISES. BY SECURIT

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KIDS TO ADULTS K-A CONTENT RATED BY ESRB

2. HERE'S ME AT THE SPACE NEEDLE.

3. HERE'S ME WITH SOME OF THE GALS AT SEATTLE SLIM'S.

MY GAME →

CRASH BANDICOOT™

Crash Bandicoot™

PlayStation

Sony's long-awaited entry into the platform game arena. You've never experienced anything quite as sensational as this fully animated cartoon world coming to life. It's flooded with obstacles, enormous levels, unbelievable graphics, detailed real-time lighting, amazing music and sound effects. Packed full of solid gameplay, hidden bonus levels, secret pathways and fiendish traps, this is the "must-have" game of the year. Travel in real time across 3D worlds in over 30 levels of intriguing gameplay with thousands of frames of animation! Interact with hilarious, fully rendered 3D cartoon-animated characters. It's packed with all the clas-

MY LOGOS ↓

SONY COMPUTER ENTERTAINMENT

universal interactive studios

NAUGHTY DOG™

PlayStation

THE OFFICIAL STRATEGY GUIDE

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Zach Meston leads a life not unlike that of our hero, Crash Bandicoot: his existence is one continuous video game played out in a tropical paradise. Zach is one of the old, grizzled veterans of video game book and magazine publishing (at age 24), having, over the years, written for, in addition to our own PSExtreme: Wired, Video Game Adviser, Video Games and Computer Entertainment, Computer Player and many others. He has also authored a number of video game strategy guides dedicated to some of the best selling games of all time. Most recently, Zach penned our own "Resident Evil: The Official Strategy Guide." One of the nicest guys you'll ever meet, and an absolute gaming legend, on those rare occasions when he isn't playing or writing about video games, Zach can be found on the beach, on the big island, jetting off on one press junket or another or, most recently, on the beaches of San Diego, California. Rumor has it that Zach has, indeed, found a female companion that actually understands why her significant other finds writing about video games to be a legitimate life-pursuit ... what are the odds?! But, we'll let ZM tell you about it in his own words ... We hope you enjoy the book and we KNOW you're loving the game.

— The Boys at Dimension Publishing

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Table Of Contents

A conversation with the developers of Crash Bandicoot™ 8-13

ISLAND #1 WALK-THROUGH 14-45

N. Sanity Beach 16-19
Jungle Rollers 20-23
The Great Gate 24-27
Boulders 28-29
Upstream 30-33
Papu Papu 34-35
Rolling Stones 36-39
Hog Wild 40-41
Native Fortress 42-45

ISLAND #2 WALK-THROUGH 46-81

Up the Creek 48-51
Ripper Roo 52-55
The Lost City 56-61
Temple Ruins 62-67
Road to Nowhere 68-71
Boulder Dash 72-73
Sunset Vista 74-79
Koala Kong 80-81

ISLAND #3 WALK-THROUGH 82-129

Heavy Machinery 84-87
Cortex Power 88-91
Generator Room 92-95
Toxic Waste 96-99
Pinstripe Potoroo 100-101
The High Road 102-105
Slippery Climb 106-109
Lights Out 110-113
Jaws of Darkness 114-117
Castle Machinery 118-121
Nitrus Brio 122-123
The Lab 124-127
The Great Hall/Dr. Neo Cortex 128-129

BONUS ROUNDS, SECRETS AND ENDINGS 130-153

Bonus Rounds 130
Gems 131-145
Keys 146
Hidden Levels 148-151
Endings 152-153

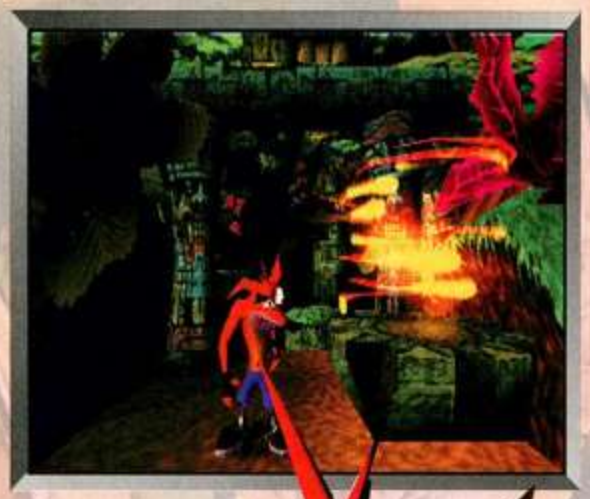
A conversation with

universal interactive studios®

NAUGHTY DOG

The Developers

of Crash Bandicoot

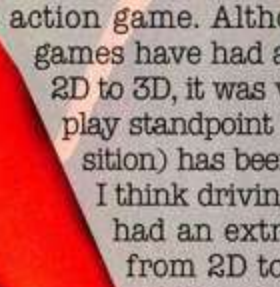


DP: Tell us about the origins of Naughty Dog and Crash.

Jason Rubin (Naughty Dog): ND's last project was Way of the Warrior (a one-on-one fighting game for the 3DO.) We came out here (to Los Angeles, CA and Universal Interactive) as a two person team: Andy Gavin and I. We didn't want to do another project that was done by two people on a tight budget. Universal Interactive offered us not only a larger budget, but a lot more. They offered us Mark Cerny's talents and Mark's history in the video game industry. They offered us anything around the studio lot to use. And, they offered us the ability to attract talent that we could mix with Andy's and my talents and, hopefully, create a bigger, better project, than Way of the Warrior, although I thought Way of the Warrior was great for what it was.

We wanted to attack a genre; the biggest of which is definitely the character based action game. Although, I think fighting games have had a great transition from 2D to 3D, it was very easy, from a gameplay standpoint and I think it (the transition) has been extremely successful. I think driving games have, likewise, had an extremely easy transition from 2D to 3D.

When we studied Crash, there was no 3D game, in the character platform game genre, on the market at all and we didn't expect that, or we expected them, but we hadn't heard of any that had been initiated. We knew that there was Clockwork Knight, but it was more of a 2D game with a bunch of 3D backgrounds. We knew that there was something called Bug on the horizon, however we had absolutely no idea what it was, but we did know it was going to have a 2D character. We decided that we wanted to do something that was entirely 3D. We wanted to take the genre, as the driving/fighting games had been taken, from 2D to 3D, without, and this was the challenge, losing the gameplay and the action inherent to a great character based action game. That's hard, because, in a fighting game, you're trying to get as close to one other person as you can. So, the arena's small, there is not much room to move within, you can't really get out of it. In a driving game, even though they've been 2D, they are naturally in 3D; it comes without any effort. But, in the character based action game, we found, when we started trying to put everything together, that it was very easy to destroy the action by going around it and, if you had a choice between going head-to-head with something and going around it, you just go around it and, in a way, you start to ruin the game. As we had guessed, and soon found out, it's very hard to design levels, and our initial effort proved that theory. It's very hard to design a level, if you can't control where a character is going ... very hard.



Exec.Producer Mark Cerny

Naughty Dog's Jason Rubin

So, after a lot of soul searching, a lot of code, a lot of levels that were thrown out; in fact, as it turns out, exactly one year after we began the project, which was October 1994, we really began to create Crash. So it was .... let's say, ten months after we began, before the first level (it actually remains in the game) was ready. This means that there was literally a period of time, while we were designing the first level, where someone else could have brought to market a competing game within the category — that is how we started.

DP: In looking at the game, there is a lot of technology that we have never seen before. Can you give us an idea of how you went about building the game?

JR: When we started, we knew what other people were going to say: "Well, this is a good idea — this is the biggest genre in history, Mario has sold more than any other game", etc. I think what happened, in the end, is that four teams, Nintendo, with Mario 64, Accolade and Eidetic with Bubsy 3D, ourselves, and Crystal Dynamics with Pandemonium, decided what they wanted, in creating a next-generation platform game, and all came up with very different results. The question is, are any of them better? I don't know if any of them are better. They're definitely different and I think, in the end, it's great, because one of these directions may take the lead and say, hey, this is where it should go. On the other hand, maybe all three directions are valid. Maybe, in 3D, you have more options; maybe you can do more. I definitely think, however, that Crash is far different from these other games. It was really important to us that we created a character that was not only visible, but was also non-polygonal looking and non-video game looking; something that looked like a character that just happened to be in a video game, not a bunch of polygons thrown together. I think we have done a pretty good job with the hardware. And there are a lot of things we did to accomplish that. When we started, we had Crash's character at the same size and same resolution of polygons, but we didn't have a shadow that he cast on the ground; we didn't have some of the other tricks we've pulled with the environment around him to link him to the world, and it looked like a bad cartoon. My definition of a bad cartoon is a foreground and a background, where the foreground moves and doesn't look like the background has anything to do with it. It took a lot to marry the two together. If you go by a tree and there's a shadow on the ground, you should be dark and I think we're one of the only games out there that is doing that right now.

Mark Cerny (Universal): Also, Crash does show something that Mario 64, to pick one of the games that Jason referred to earlier, can't. Crash has close to one million polygons and there just isn't enough data on the Nintendo 64 cartridge to handle this level of detail. And it is very expensive. Not only is Crash a great game, but it reinforces CD-ROM as the most flexible, and cheapest, delivery medium.

JR: Geometry is just one of the issues. We have, in each one of the levels, six to eight megabytes of textures — they have eight to sixteen megabyte cartridges. So, how many levels can you put on a cartridge? There's sound and music and everything else on there, as well. If you take each piece of a level, we're already half a cartridge; if you start adding up all the pieces of the level, you're way beyond a cartridge. There's 64 megs of textures in the game. At 16 megs, which is the biggest N64 cartridge I've heard mentioned, that's huge and expensive. Nintendo is talking about a 64 DD drive; it's going to have 64 megs of storage capacity. We're at 64 megs of textures in Crash, that's JUST the textures, without any geometry to sit on top of! We believe that we have achieved a level of

A 3 island tour... (to the tune of Gilligan's Island)

Koala Kong

A typical bonus round

"Crash look good ... Crash feel good!"

Gems open up all new areas

One of the game's many secret places

technology, with Crash, that the competition simply can't deliver.

DP: Now that you've broached the subject of Nintendo and Mario 64, Crash's world allows the player to move freely within the environment, but with restrictions. Each level gives the player different barricades that keep him on a certain path. Miyamoto and his team have taken a different approach in Mario 64 — allowing the player to roam and explore mapped areas, much like games such as Doom and Magic Carpet. What was your design rationale in taking more control over the play environment?

JR: When we started, we made the decision to make Crash more of a classic action/platform game than an open, 3D exploration game. That decision gave us a lot of advantages. We can take advantage of that to make our trees 3D. In Mario 64, the trees are 2D. They're in a 3D world but, if you notice, as you are running around a tree, it simply rotates. It's flat, it's a Doom-like, four year old technology. But, they have a "Z" buffer (this technology allows the N64 to calculate character and object placement and movement along a third axis). So, when you jump into it, it sort of looks 3D and that is a very big advantage for them. But, it is a 2D tree; they don't have enough data to store all that stuff, to store all the 3D, and it's very hard for them to deal with the 3D from all angles, while allowing the player to move freely in an open environment. What we did is to create a game that's just like the classics ... a more directed flow and look. It's not just the gameplay that improves, but there are also a lot of other things that can improve as well.

For example, we like Warner's characters in the foreground. Background-wise, their style is pretty sparse — what were we going to do? It's the characters that make Warner survive. The backgrounds are neat, but the characters are brilliant and they make Warner Brothers. Disney has a great amount of talent in their backgrounds. If you go back to Snow White and look at the backgrounds, you're in a world and what they're doing is getting artists who have a talent for light and shadow, for depth of field, for directed flow of your attention. These are things that Warner never really thought about when they were doing their stuff. They did klunky shapes, very abstract, stylized worlds. And it's a valid approach, certainly, but it wasn't what we

were looking for; we were looking for art and one of the nice things about having a directed flow is that we can say: "OK you're going into a specific area, we're going to cast this shadow that's going to create this darkness"; next to it we can put a light; we can direct the flow of your eye; we can do the things an artist does with a still image. I think that people who were doing full motion video games had hoped that they could accomplish this — let's make a movie with movie quality, but it's a game. Their problem was that they couldn't get the game part right.

We hope we've gotten that movie look. To a certain extent, we definitely want to be a cartoon, we're not trying to be any sort of film. But we hope we achieved that sort of look and, at the same time, that we have all the gameplay of the classics. Our art director, Bob Rafei, wanted something organic, which has really never been done well in a 3D game. So, by bringing things closer and closer to you, we had more and more capabilities; we could use our polygons in wiser ways. The texture maps would be more evident, as opposed to pushing them off in the background and watching them fade-out, blur and lose pixels. This was actually the turning point of the project. We said, hey, if we can script the char-

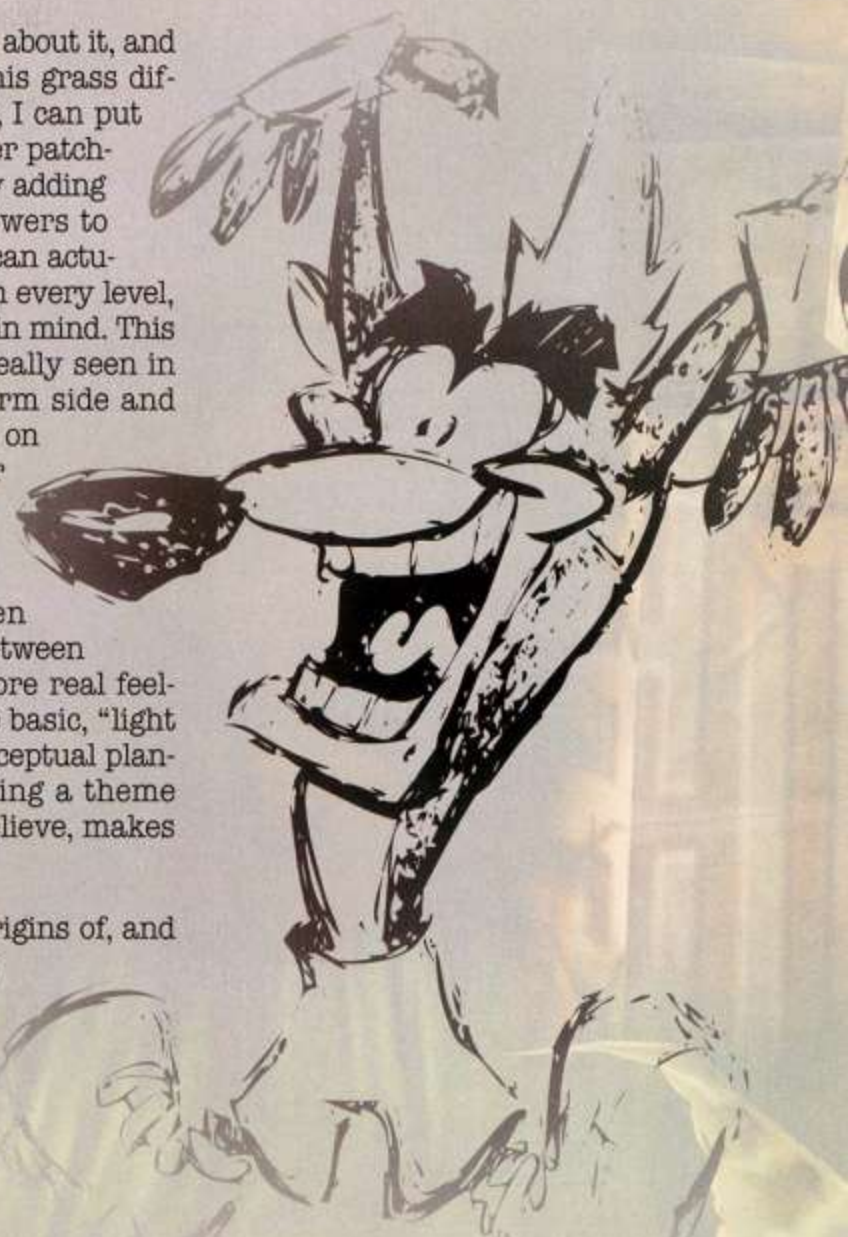
acter to go down a path, we can create art. We can create something that you can pause the game and be impressed by the images. If you pause Crash and you look at the shadows, and you notice that Crash is in the shadows, and you look at things like that and you see the leaves and this leaf

N. Brio

is the right shape and the right color to lead your eye in, that is very different than anything else I've seen or played. Classically, video game designers, in games like Pac Man and Asteroids, weren't thinking art, they were thinking gameplay. Which, at that time, was all they could do — and they did it brilliantly. We wanted to start with that kind of gameplay experience and create a beautiful world to contain it. So, we said "why fight it, let's just go with this (the game's structured flow)."

DP: In talking about the look of the game, Crash's world seems to be "living", in the sense that there looks to be a greater level of attention to detail. This focus seems to have produced a more vibrant play environment than we have yet to experience. Was this 'organic' approach to Crash's world one of the major focuses of your development effort?

JR: Definitely. We could have gone with any of a million styles out there and, for a long time, we did explore different styles. The ruins are a good example of our approach. The idea behind the ruins is that, if you have a snow level and you have a beach level and you have an inside the building level, how do you tie them together? The ruins were simply an idea; OK, let's say there was an ancient civilization, they were around whenever they made ruins, the ruins are all over the place. So, from one level to the next, the ruins are showing you and telling you that you're still in the same world. The other thing we did is to design absolutely everything on paper before we actually got into it. This is where the details that you spoke of are coming from. All of the textures are designed from the beginning, how everything is going to look, and that is extremely useful because the texture is not only that texture, it also adds polygons. If you use your texture map right, you can create a bevel or you can create a crack that isn't actually a polygonal crack, and that gives you something that looks real. If you're just randomly putting noise textures on the ground, like green grass; "OK, this is green grass so let's put green on there" ... it doesn't change color, doesn't do anything, it's just green grass ... you're not really adding much more than noise. If you think about it, and you say; "Well, I can make this grass different colors as it goes along, I can put flower patches here and flower patches there", then you're actually adding something. You're adding flowers to what was just grass and you can actually get a lot if you pre-plan. In every level, we began with a graphic goal in mind. This is something that I haven't really seen in many games. We have a warm side and a cold side. Not only is it light on one side and dark on the other side, but the lights are "redder" and the darks are "bluer" and that's nice, very nice, because the color then blends across the gradient between them and you get a much more real feeling than you get from a more basic, "light and dark" approach. This conceptual planning and our focus on creating a theme in Crash's world is what, I believe, makes our product unique.



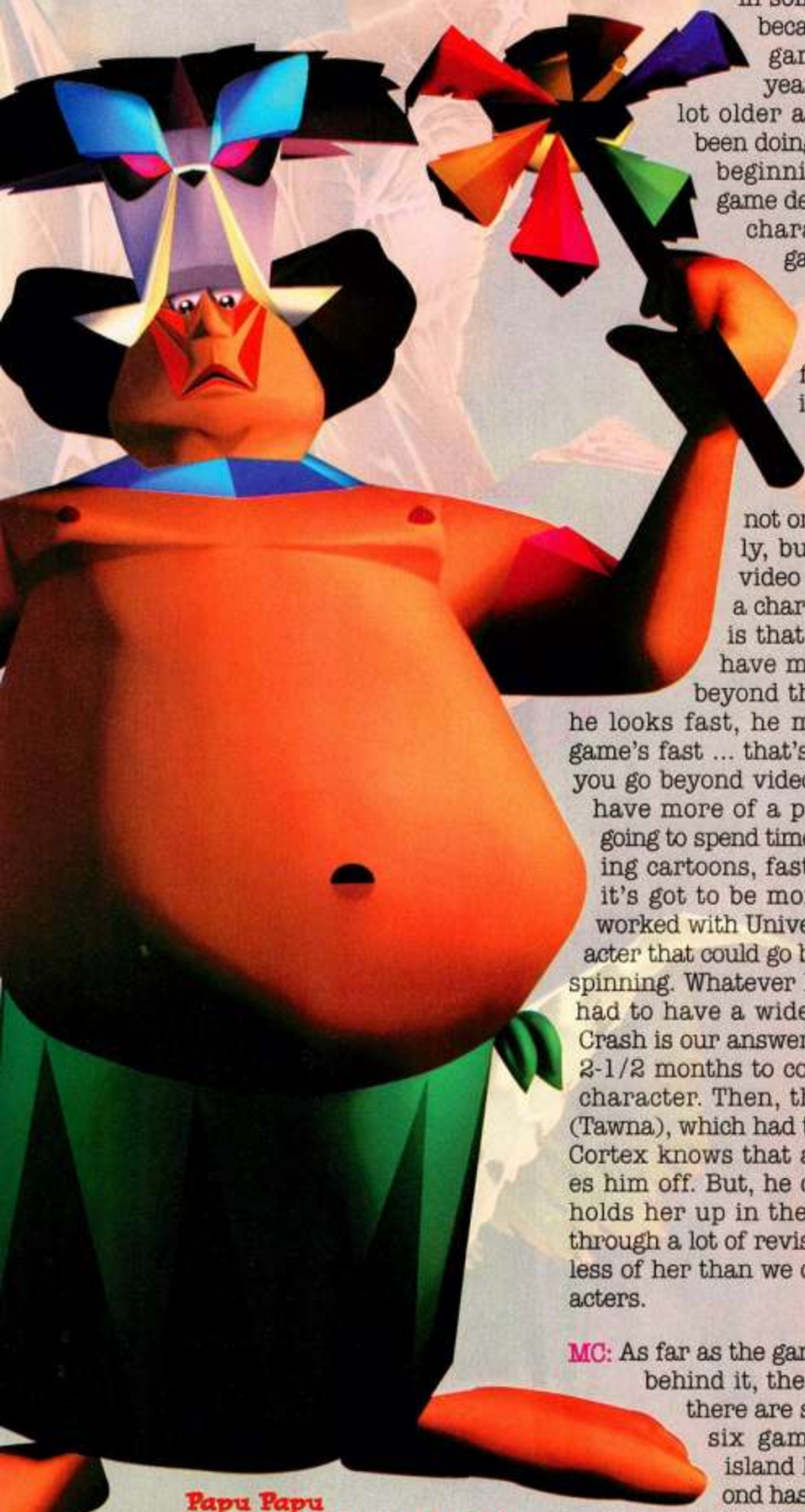
DP: We've talked about the origins of, and technology behind, Crash. Now, we'd like to talk to you about the game itself and the story behind Crash and the other characters that inhabit his world.

JR: I don't exactly remember the order we went in when we were creating the characters, but I know that Crash came last, he was finalized last ... he was the hardest. The one that we had the most fun with, early-on, was Cortex, because, in a lot of ways, he has to drive the game. We had a very bizarre approach to the whole thing, we felt he was a genius. He was a maniac. He was going to do the thing he was going to do, but we felt we had to make a character that looked and felt like he understood that he was in a video game doing the things he was doing — more like a chess master, answering to somebody; "I'm insane, I'm ugly, people throw me out of the world, what am I going to do? ... go out and create an army of animals!" It is cliché and that's something I think really bugs him. In fact, early plans were that he was going to turn to the screen and

"Indiana" Crash?

do asides and stuff and then we decided not to do cut scenes, since we thought it broke the action. But, we were going to have him actually turn to the screen and say; "Oh, here he comes, there's nothing I can do, why even bother, go get him" ... you know, stuff like that. Cortex comes from a desire to create a character that was extremely emotional — he knows himself, he knows the situation he's in and yet he still finds himself living and the life he leads is very, very emotional.

Crash had to be designed both from the front and the back. We brought in people from the cartoon studios here. We brought in some cartoon animators because we figured video games are now 15 - 20 years old. Cartoons are a lot older and the studios have been doing characters since the beginning, whereas video game designers weren't doing characters so much as gameplay. So, we figured the people that you could mine for knowledge are going to be from the cartoon industry. We brought them in to help us and we created a character who was not only video game friendly, but also friendly past video games. If you create a character whose sole trait is that he's fast, he doesn't have much of a personality beyond that. You look at him, he looks fast, he moves fast, then the game's fast ... that's a pitfall. Because, if you go beyond video games, you have to have more of a personality. If you're going to spend time with Saturday morning cartoons, fast stuff doesn't cut it; it's got to be more than that. So, we worked with Universal to create a character that could go beyond fast, or beyond spinning. Whatever he was to become, he had to have a wide range of emotions. Crash is our answer, and it took the team 2-1/2 months to come up with the final character. Then, there's the girlfriend (Tawna), which had to be in there, as well. Cortex knows that and that's what pisses him off. But, he does his duty and he holds her up in the castle. Tawna went through a lot of revisions, so we have a lot less of her than we do of any of the characters.



Papu Papu
(from the Latin; Buttikus Crackus)

MC: As far as the game goes, and the story behind it, there are three islands, there are six bosses and twenty six game rounds. The first island has one boss, the second has two and the third has three. What you are seeing (in the pre-release software given to PSExtreme for this feature) is the first 60% of the final product; not too much is changing there. We have designed the game so that the player can quickly accumulate quite a few lives. The lives are set up to assist your flow through the game when you're playing it for the first time. Of course, you can go back at any time after a restart and replay old rounds and get the lives out of those rounds. If your interest is in getting 99 lives, you can do that. In terms of gameplay balance, the number of lives that an expert player can accumulate is moot to me. Just as an example; in the Super Mario series, you could go to the first round, play it, get three lives, and do that until you had 99 of them and proceed again. Is this an impediment to tuning? Absolutely not! I think the brilliance of that series speaks for itself. So, how does one determine how many lives should be scattered throughout the game? Well, it's a question of when a fresh consumer comes to the product and is playing the game to get through it, to see what is in there, to reach the end, to get to that ending — how many lives are necessary to establish game balance, to make it fun? The second issue is the replay value, which, in Crash, has to do with collecting gems. You get gems by completing a round perfectly, without dying, and by breaking all of the boxes on that level. There are 26 rounds, there are 26 gems, 6 of them have color. The colored gems are on the third island ... so you go to the third island and then you come back.

DP: In terms of looking at the overall structure of the game, how long do you expect the average gamer to take to get through point A to point Z by blasting through the game and how long should it take to discover everything that's in the game?

MC: I know somebody who went from the start to the end of Donkey Kong the first time ever in 3 hours and 26 minutes. So, the question of how many hours is very dangerous; there's a lot of rhetoric floating around and I've also heard, by the same token, that Mario 64 will take 200 hours to finish. I have difficulty believing that anyone will maintain interest in a video game for 200 hours. So, I don't have an hour figure. What's important is that we don't say to the player, "you're done". What's important is that the player can establish when THEY are done with the game — perhaps that's when they finished the game at the end of the day, perhaps when they've gone through and finished 60% of the game, perhaps it's when they've managed to accumulate half of the gems (which will take quite a bit of time). I suspect there are a great number of people who will not finish the product.

JR: It's very difficult, these days, to bal-

(MOST OF) THE NAUGHTY DOGS

Jason Rubin | Andy Gavin | Dave Baggett | Bob Rafei | Taylor Kurosaki | Justin Monast | Charlotte Francis

ance games, because there are a lot of people coming in who have never played a video game before. Or, if they have, they've played driving/fighting games, 'cause that's all that's out there right now. At the same time, you've got a lot of people who have gone from Atari 2600s; these people can pick up a game and, no matter what it is, they are going to finish it in a few hours. That's the 3 hour and 26 minute guy. He's beaten everything, you can't throw tricks at him. He's seen it. If he hasn't seen it, it's either not possible or he can figure it out right then and there.

DP: In closing, how did the relationship between Universal and Naughty Dog come about and what is the nature of the relationship?

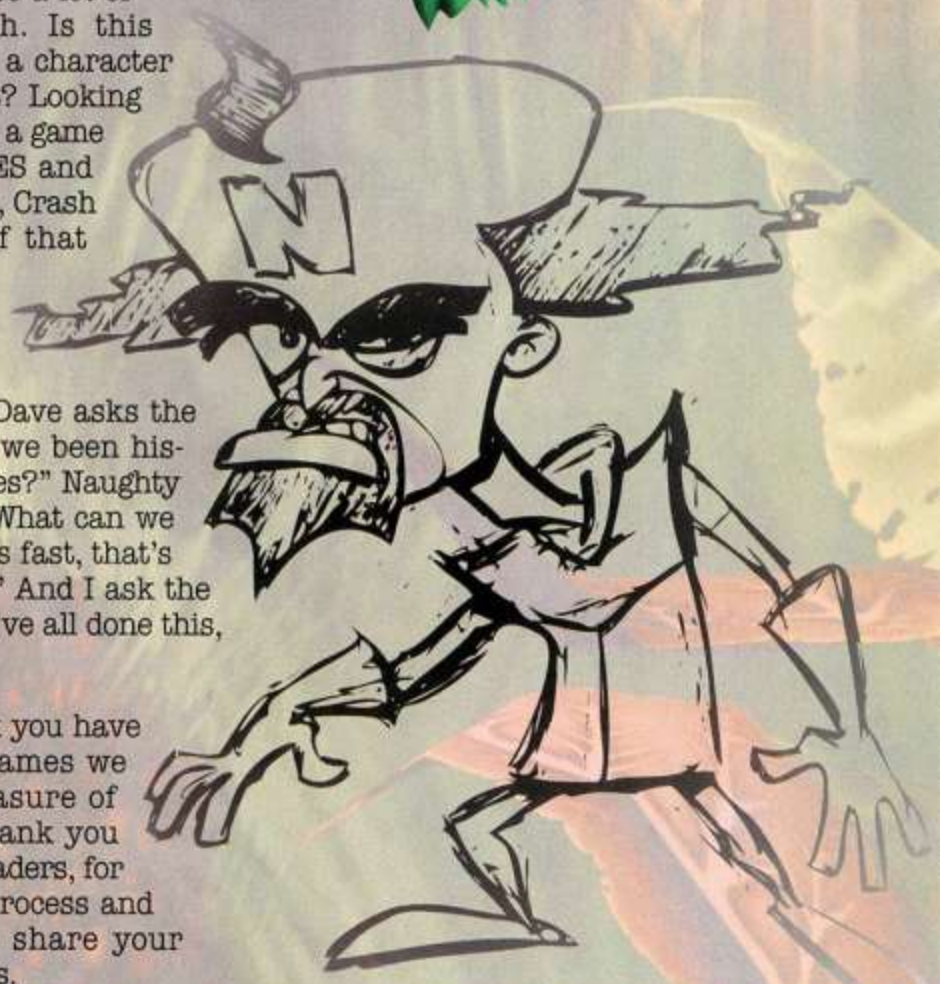
MC: Universal Interactive Studios started in 1994. The first two products were external, kind of "no touch" deals, for Jurassic Park Interactive and The Way of the Warrior. The Way of the Warrior was a very easy deal to make. I didn't make it but lines of people were waiting to buy it. So, Universal signed a deal for the product with Andy & Jason. They also talked Andy & Jason into coming out here for a housekeeping deal, which is a Hollywood thing. Jason had already spent some good time in Newport Beach, so he knew about California and wanted to come back. We basically told them: "here is an area to work, we'd like to first look at your products, we'd like an opportunity to pick them up if they're something we're interested in." In the summer of '94 I was the first product development person hired at Universal and I immediately realized that Andy & Jason were extremely talented. There is no question in my mind that Naughty Dog is the best team at getting stuff done that I have ever worked with. Sony can attest to how dramatic the change is, and the improvement has been, in the product since we all hooked up, which I think was just three months ago. Structurally, I am executive producer. David Siller, who joined the company in September of 1994, and who we are very happy to have, is Crash's producer.

DP: We have known David for a few years and we can see a lot of his influence in Crash. Is this assumption valid, from a character development standpoint? Looking back at Aero the Acrobat, a game David produced for SNES and Genesis while at Sunsoft, Crash seems to have some of that same kind of appeal.

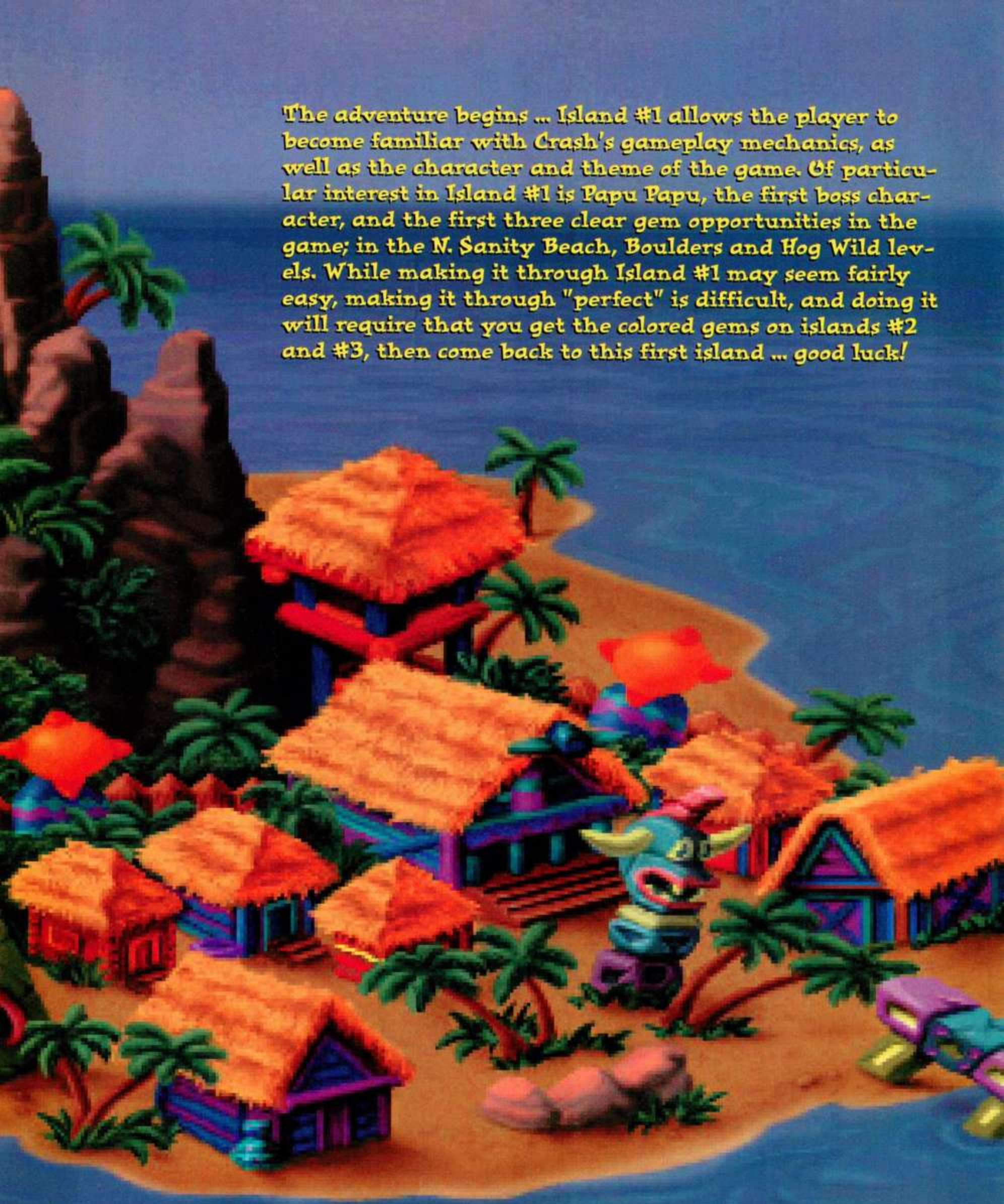
MC: In terms of roles on the project, this is an oversimplification but, Dave asks the question: "Where have we been historically with these games?" Naughty Dog asks the question: What can we do that's beautiful, that's fast, that's interactive, that's new?" And I ask the question: "Now that you've all done this, what do we have?"

DP: In the end, we think you have one of the best video games we have ever had the pleasure of playing. We'd like to thank you both, on behalf of our readers, for your dedication to the process and for taking the time to share your insights and experiences.

Aku Aku



Island 1



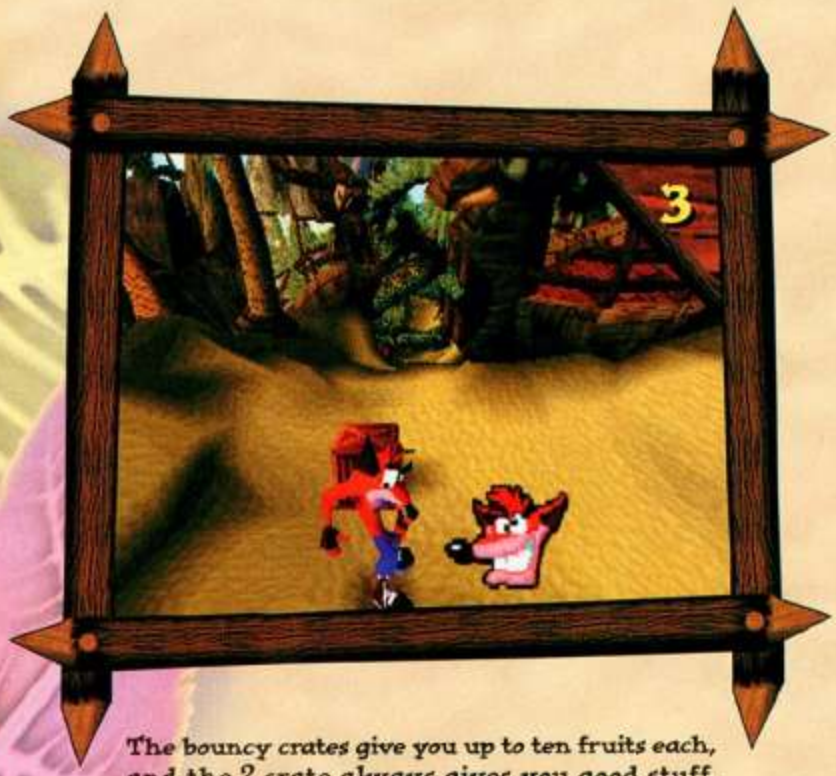
The adventure begins ... Island #1 allows the player to become familiar with Crash's gameplay mechanics, as well as the character and theme of the game. Of particular interest in Island #1 is Papu Papu, the first boss character, and the first three clear gem opportunities in the game; in the N. Sanity Beach, Boulders and Hog Wild levels. While making it through Island #1 may seem fairly easy, making it through "perfect" is difficult, and doing it will require that you get the colored gems on islands #2 and #3, then come back to this first island ... good luck!

N. Sanity Beach

Checkpoints: 1
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

After you wash up on the beach, you're immediately faced with three crates. Two of them are what we'll call "bouncy" crates for the remainder of this here book; you can recognize a bouncy crate by the vertical stripes on the front. The third crate is a mystery crate, so noted by the "?" mark.

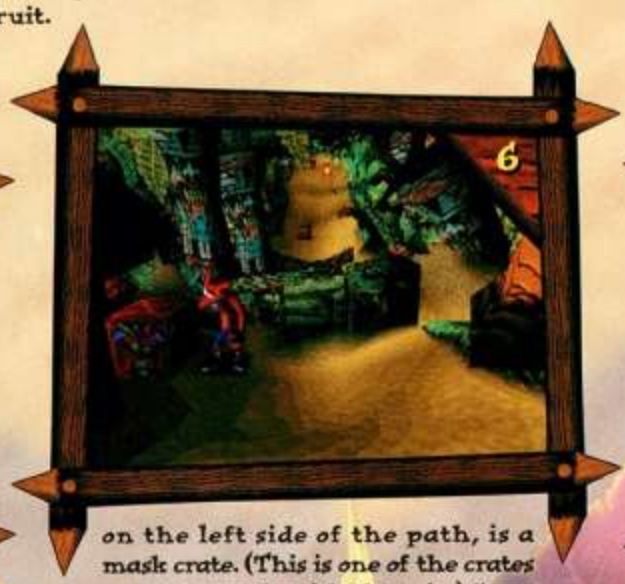
Now, instead of using your spin move to destructively smash the crates open, be smart and jump on them instead.



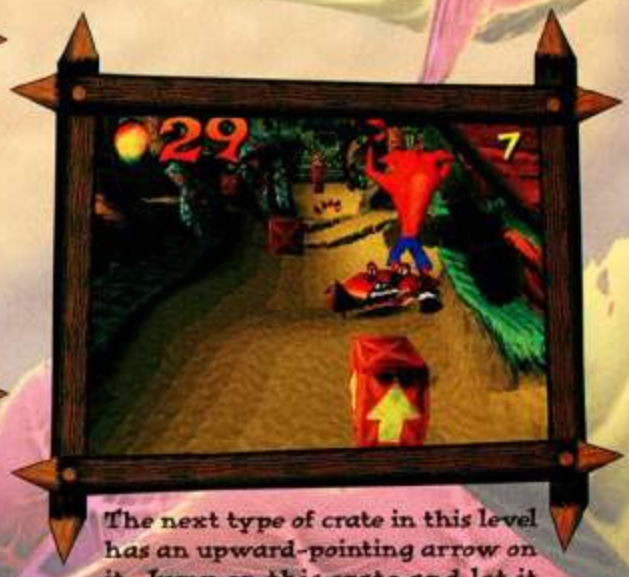
The bouncy crates give you up to ten fruits each, and the ? crate always gives you good stuff. In this case, an extra life. If you smash open a bouncy crate, you don't get ANY fruit.

Past a slow-moving crab

and a small pit,

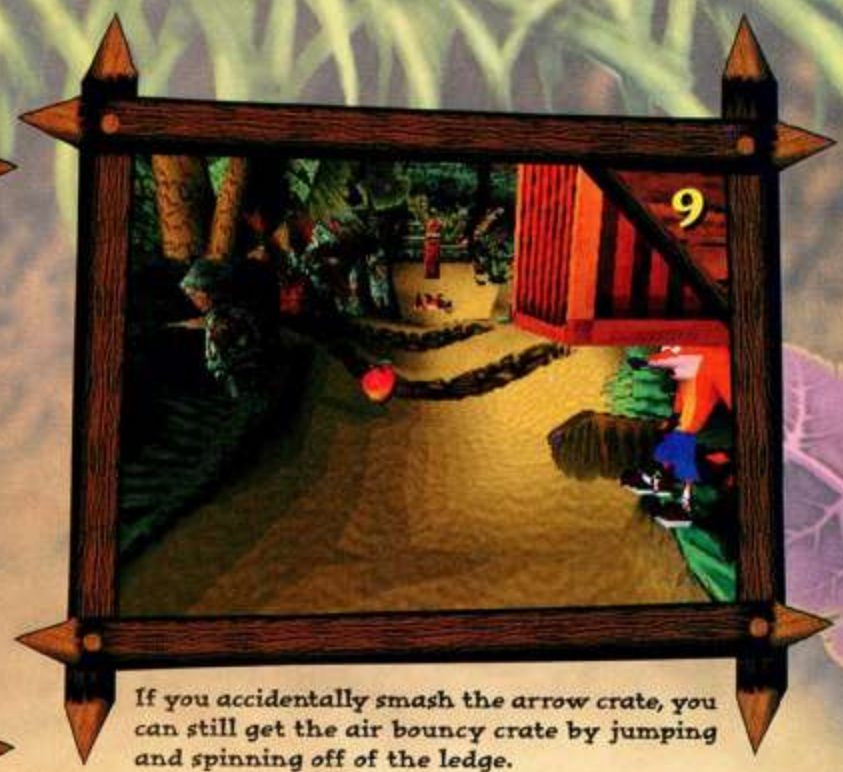


on the left side of the path, is a mask crate. (This is one of the crates you can smash with the spin.) Open it and take the mask inside. Now you can get hit once by an enemy without dying (the mask disappears when you get whacked, of course).



The next type of crate in this level has an upward-pointing arrow on it. Jump on this crate and let it repeatedly fling you into the bouncy crate in the air, earning you another ten fruits.

Bash the arrow crate after the bouncy crate disappears.



If you accidentally smash the arrow crate, you can still get the air bouncy crate by jumping and spinning off of the ledge.

There's a stack of two crates just before the stairs. Jump on the higher crate (a normal one) and then on the bouncy crate below.

A second mask crate is on the stairs. Open it and take the mask inside. Now the mask circling you is golden to show that you can be hit twice.

As you climb the stairs — there's an extra life along the way — you find a metallic crate. This crate can't be moved and can't be broken — it's just there to distract ya.

The first checkpoint crate (labeled with a C) is at the top of the stairs. If you croak before finishing the level, you'll return here.

If you didn't get hit by an enemy up to this point, the mask crate just past the checkpoint is your third.

Picking up a third mask makes you invincible for about twenty seconds, so sprint forward and smash the enemies and crates while laughing insanely. You'll get all the items inside the crates you hit.

Don't miss the single crate slyly placed behind a wall, on the right side of the path. (It's the stone wall before the "wall" of eight crates.)

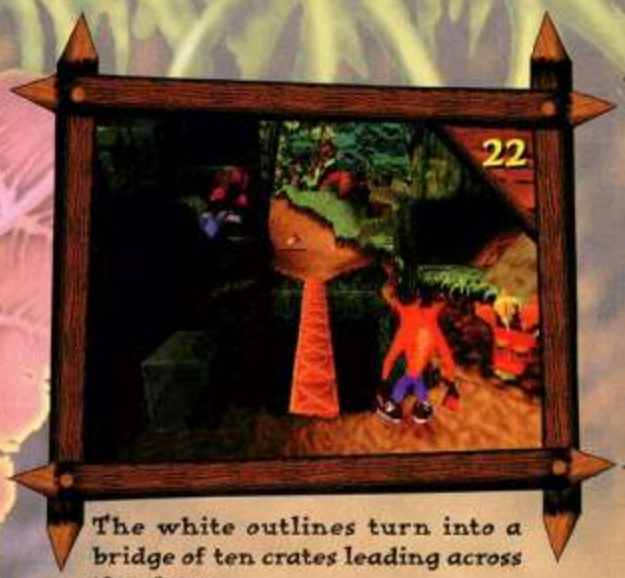
You'll come to a fork in the path, with trails leading left and right. Take the left path first.

All that's on this path are a turtle

and two crates.

After opening the second crate, walk downward and back to the fork, then take the right path.

Jump over the pit (it's a tricky jump) and hit the "!" crate.



The white outlines turn into a bridge of ten crates leading across the chasm.

Slight problem, though: If you want to finish the level with a "Perfect" — and we know you do — you have to smash each of the ten crates. Stand on the first crate, jump into the air, and move slightly forward as you smash each crate. Move too slowly and you fall; move too quickly and you miss crates. Hold down the jump button as you bounce to give yourself maximum height on each bounce.

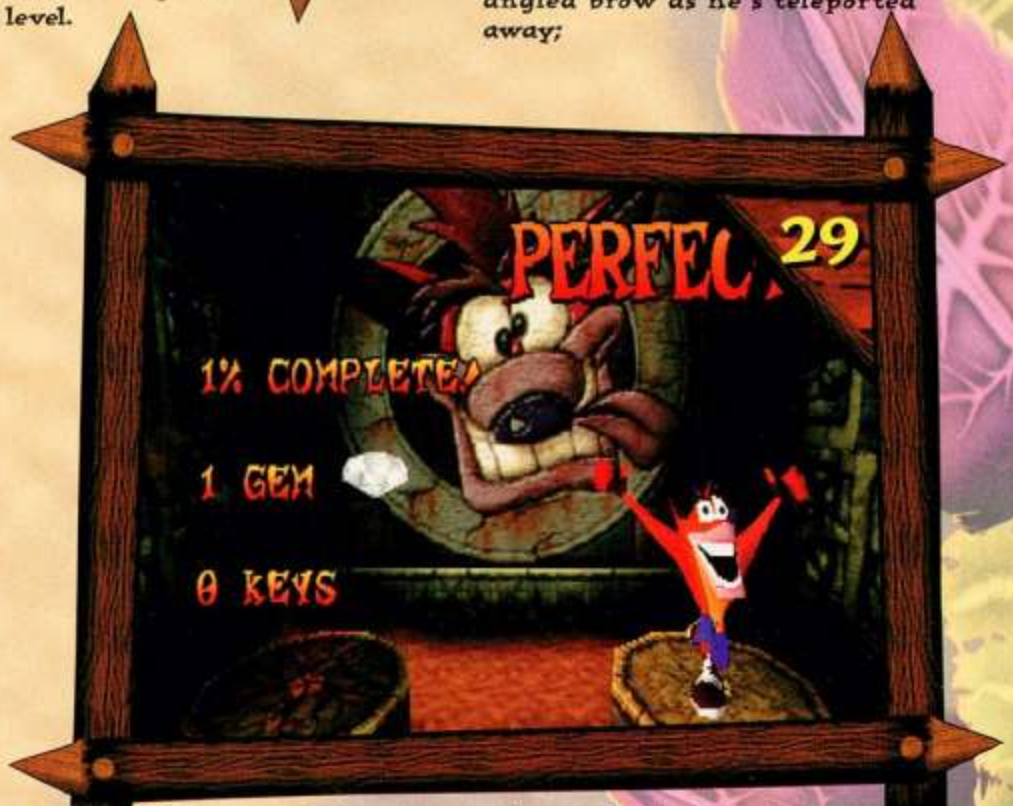
Jump over the final pit,

open the ? crate,

and jump onto the stone platform to finish the level.

If you lost at least one life, Crash wipes the sweat off his polygon-angled brow as he's teleported away;

if you got through the level without dying, Crash busts out a mighty grin and jumps into the air.



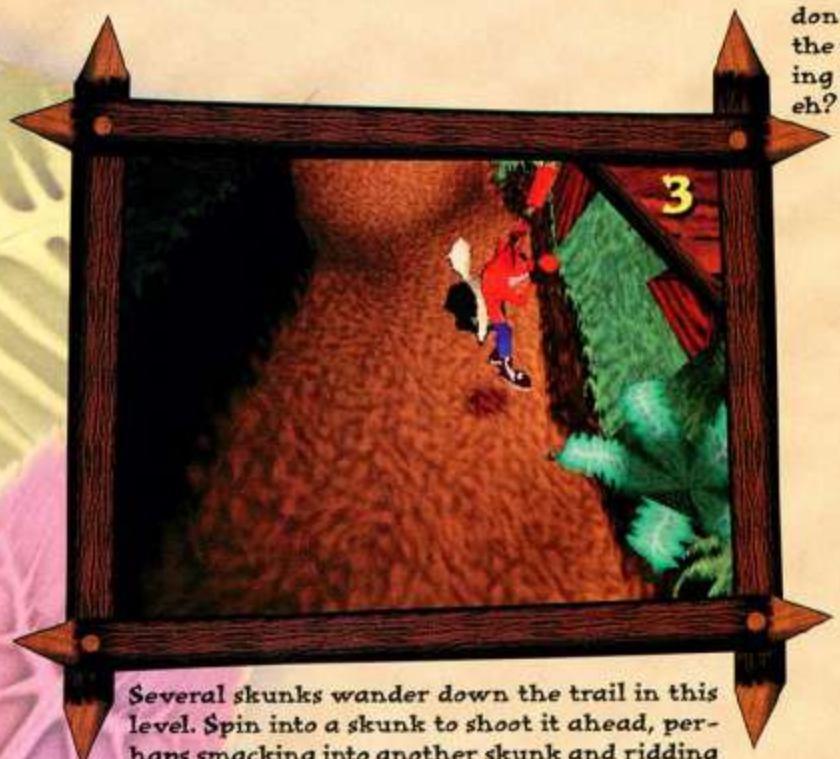
If you smashed every crate in the level, including the ten crates in the bridge, you get a "Perfect" rating and earn the first of the game's 26 clear gems. Only 25 to go (d'ohh)! (It's important to note that, if you want to get the "perfect" rating, you can not do it if you've died after passing the first checkpoint in a level. If you die along the way, hit the 'start' button, return to the island map screen and re-enter the level.) If you earned the clear gem, you will now be 1% complete in the game.

Jungle Rollers

Checkpoints: 1
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Green

There's a new type of crate at the start of the level: the TNT crate. TNT crates explode as soon as you spin into them, or, if you simply bounce on them, count down and explode after three seconds. Since the mask and TNT crates are next to each other, you'd assume that you should take the mask and then blow up the TNT. But we all knows what happens when you assume, don't we? Since you can't score a "Perfect" in this level yet — you don't have the green gem — take the mask and AVOID the TNT, leaving it for when you return. Clever, eh?

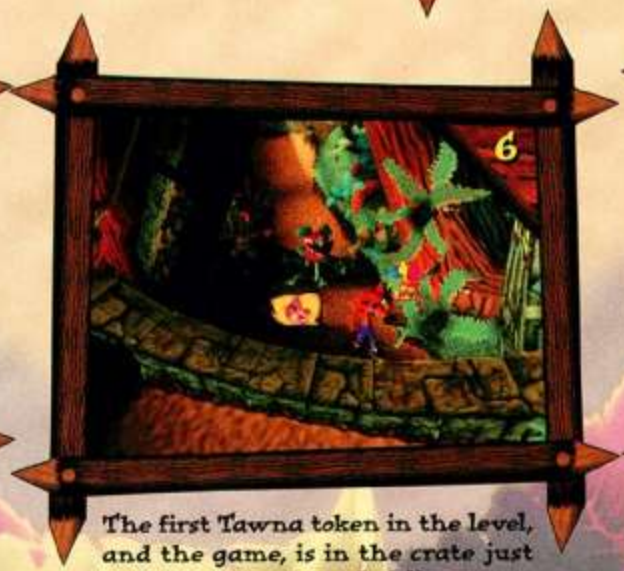
(If you already have a sparkling mask, grab the third mask and hit the TNT, since you're invincible.)



Several skunks wander down the trail in this level. Spin into a skunk to shoot it ahead, perhaps smacking into another skunk and ridding the world of not one, but two of the foul-smelling beasties. Try not to hit crates, though.

The first "jungle roller" is a stone wheel that rolls back and forth on a low wall.

Jump over the wall when the wheel is on one side or the other. (This tip sponsored by the makers of Duh Beer — for beer lovers who need to be told the obvious.)

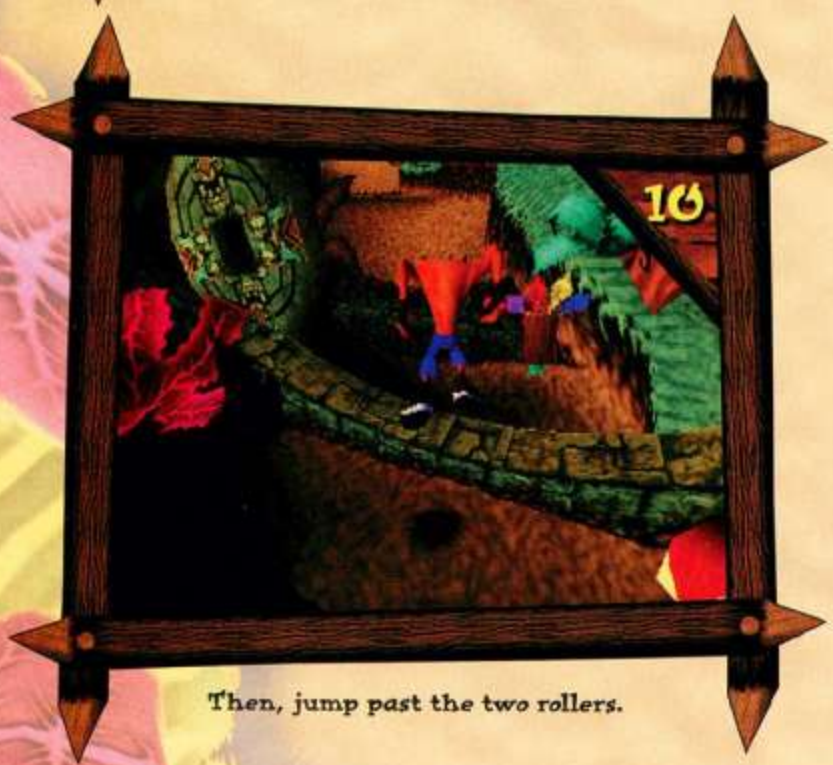


The first Tawna token in the level, and the game, is in the crate just after the stone wheel. Collect three Tawna tokens and you're whisked away to a bonus round where you can collect extra lives and save the game.

After the first Tawna token is another new enemy, the snapping flower. Jump and spin into it, but don't get too close before jumping, or it reaches out and chomps your fuzzy behind.

The next two wheels are harder to jump over, since they're placed close to pits.

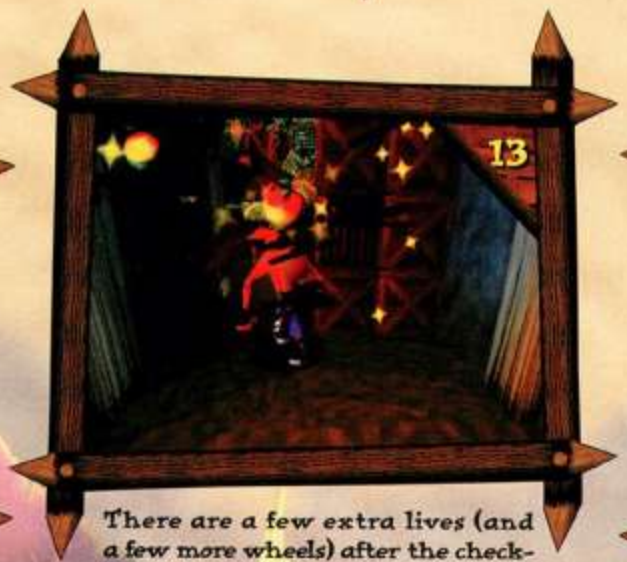
Take your time and don't miss the mask crate in between the two.



Then, jump past the two rollers.

As you approach the checkpoint crate, notice the small floating green gem.

When you get close to the gem, it disappears. This subtle clue tells you that you can't get to the hidden area above the checkpoint until you've obtained the green gem. In other words, you can't score a "Perfect" on this level, because you can't get to the crates up there.



There are a few extra lives (and a few more wheels) after the checkpoint.

Grab 'em and forge ahead to the second Tawna token.

You will come across a free life between two TNT crates.

Secure this life at your own risk! Do not attempt unless you have protection in the form of the Witch Doctor mask. Tap the jump button, and immediately press the spin button. If done correctly, the spin attack will not touch the TNT.

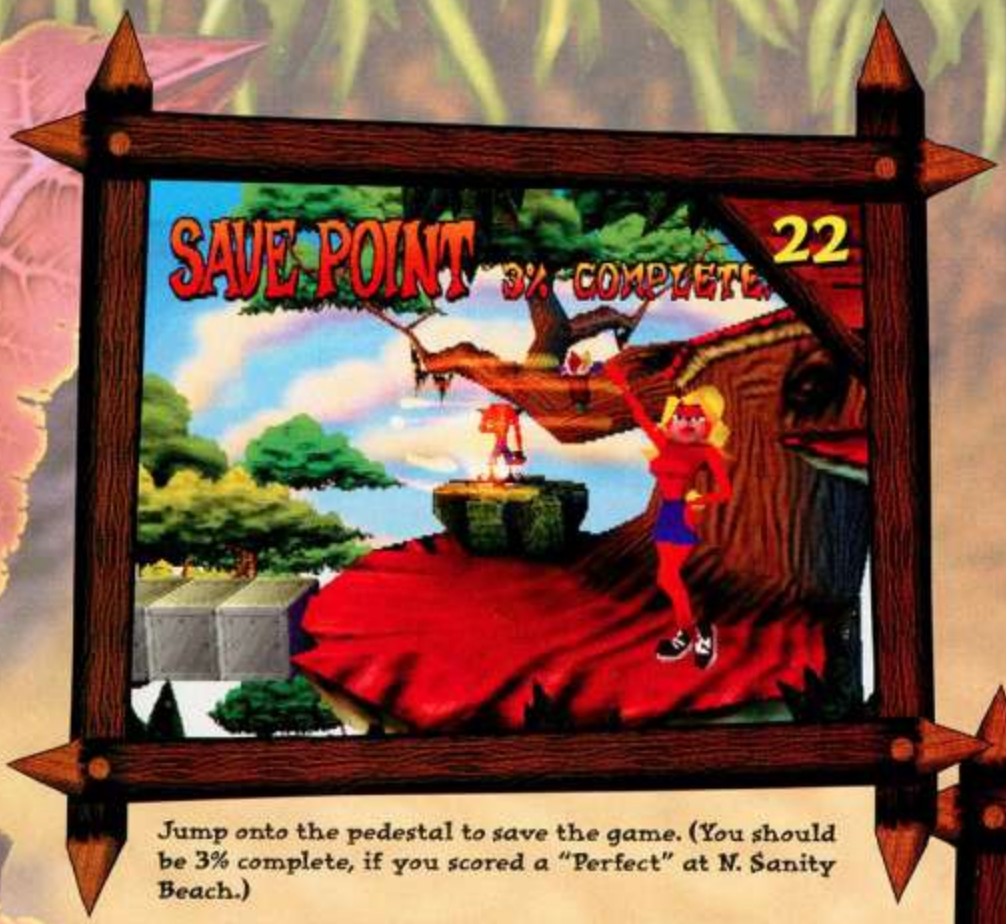
Next up is a group of five crates, one with a free life.

The third Tawna crate takes you to the very first bonus round.

This particular round is super-de-duper easy: go to the right, break the single bouncy crate,

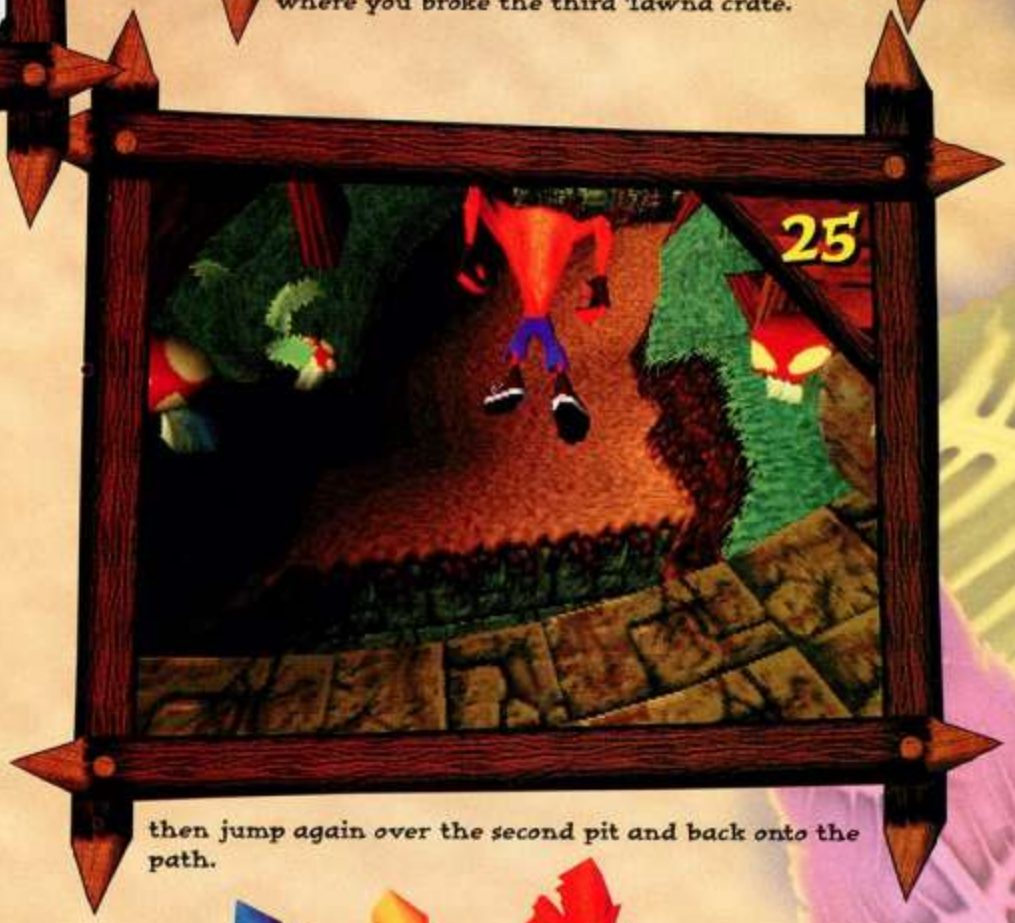
then jump over the hole and break the group of crates.

Lovely Tawna — not the real Tawna, but merely a pleasant mirage — waits for you on the far right side.



Jump onto the pedestal to save the game. (You should be 3% complete, if you scored a "Perfect" at N. Sanity Beach.)

You appear back in Jungle Rollers at the spot where you broke the third Tawna crate.



then jump again over the second pit and back onto the path.

There's a tricky obstacle after an extra-life crate: two wheels going back and forth on a wall with pits on both sides. Wait for the wheels to cross in the middle, then jump over the first pit onto the wall,

Even if you finish the level without dying, you still won't get a "Perfect," because you'll have missed three crates. Gotta come back here after snagging the green gem!

The Great Gate

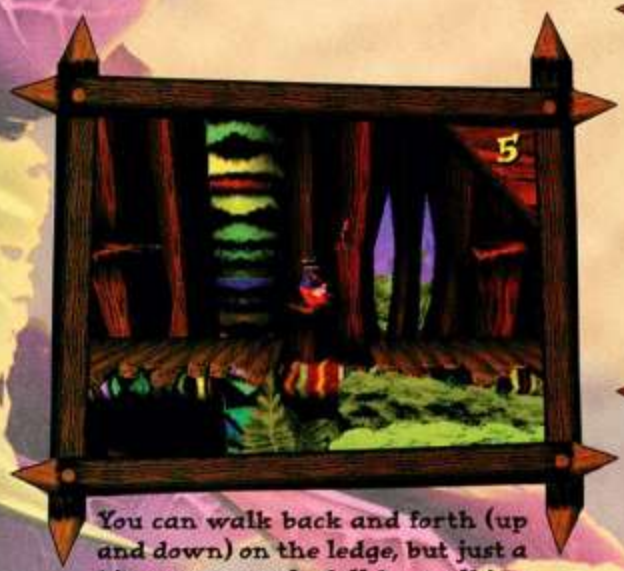
Checkpoints: 1
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Yellow

This level utilizes a pleasant long-range view of the action. Open the crates on the ground

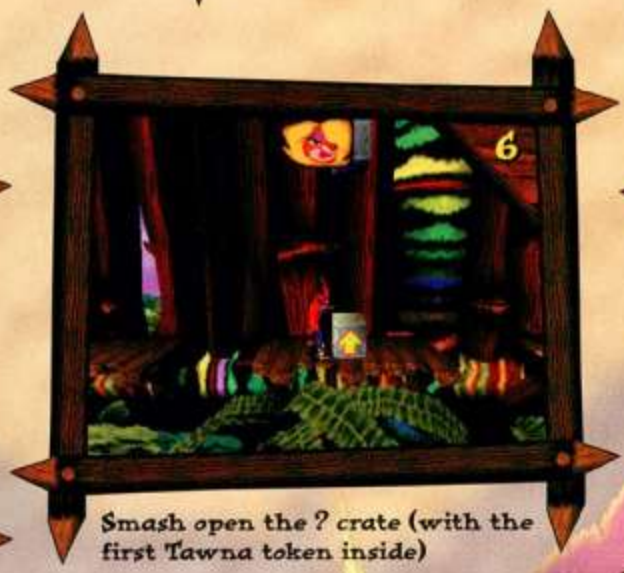
and bounce up the arrow crates

to the ledge above.

Hold down the jump button to bounce higher off an arrow crate.



You can walk back and forth (up and down) on the ledge, but just a bit; you can only fall by walking or jumping into one of the holes BETWEEN the ledges.



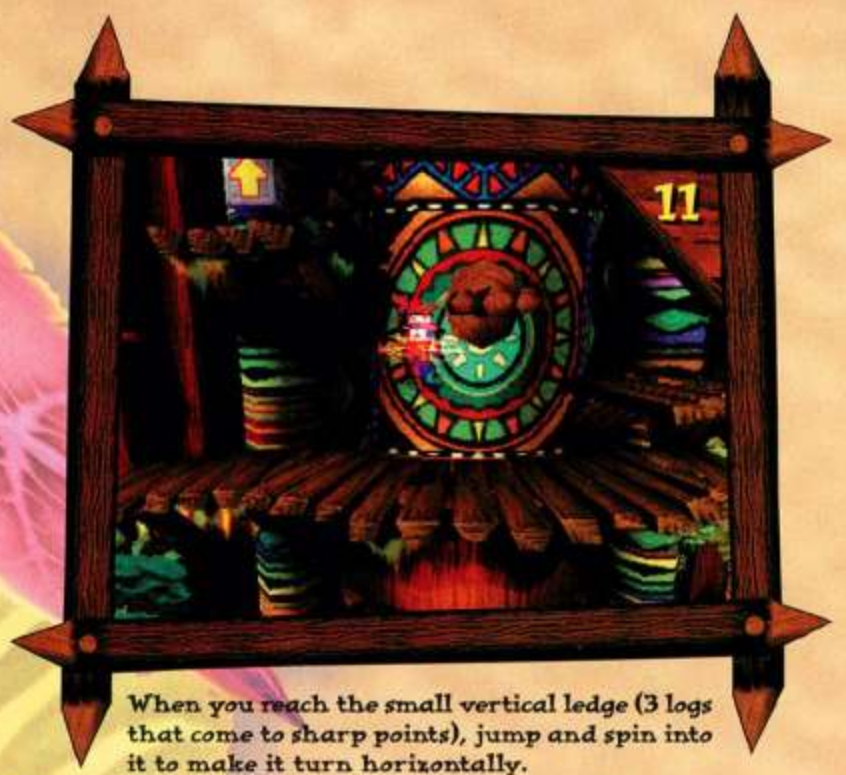
Smash open the ? crate (with the first Tawna token inside)

and quickly jump over the arrow crate as the metal crate bounces into the air. If you jump onto the bouncing box, it will take you up to a hidden extra life.

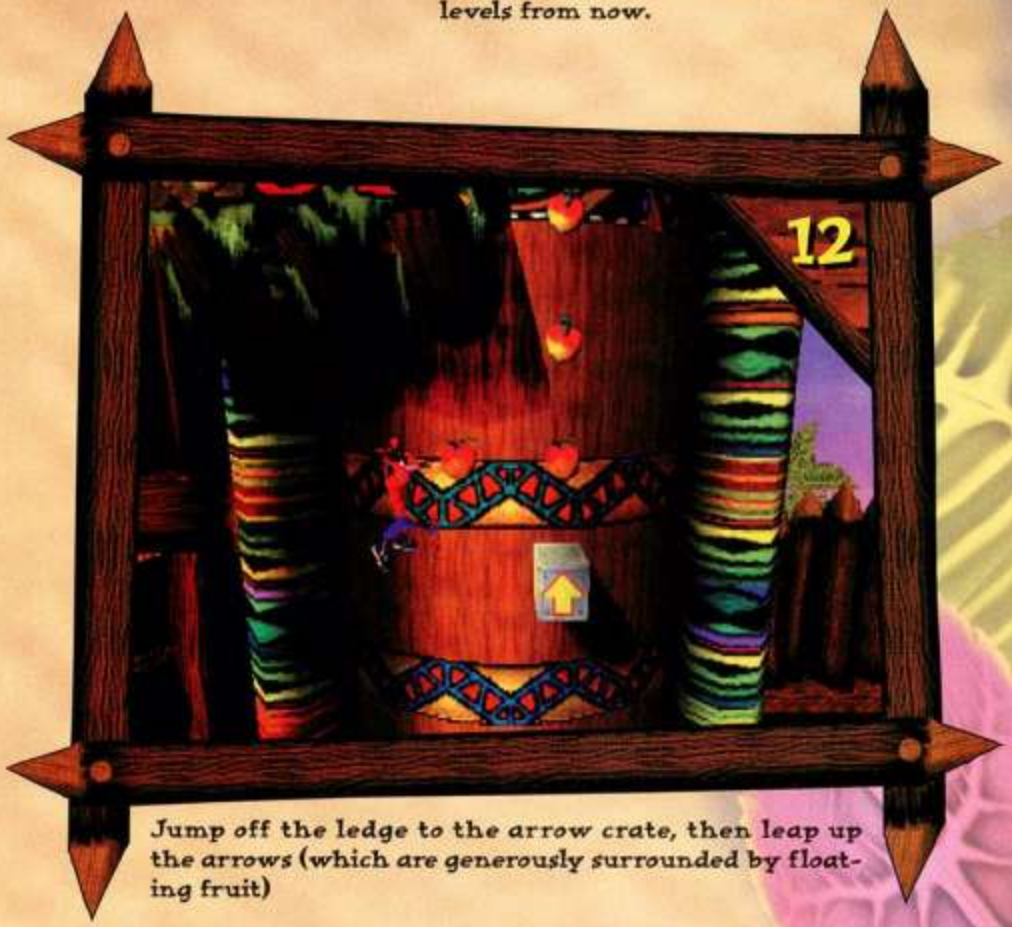
Don't get smushed.

Then, you will encounter the next enemy in the game, the monkey. To dispatch monkeys, wait until they're beating their chests and nail 'em with the ol' spinner.

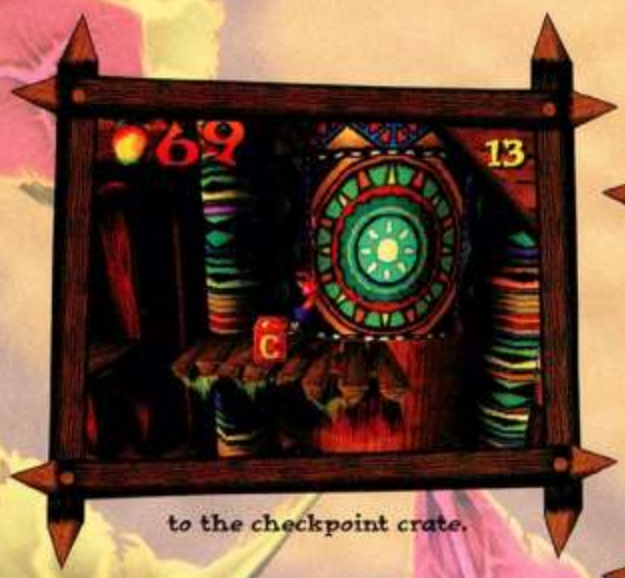
Bounce off the two crates to get the extra life in the air. A pathetically easy maneuver, you sneer, but don't worry — you'll have all the challenge you could want a few levels from now.



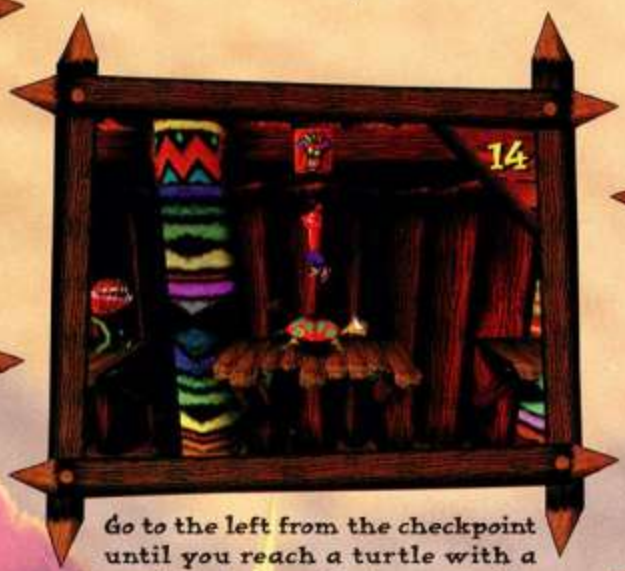
When you reach the small vertical ledge (3 logs that come to sharp points), jump and spin into it to make it turn horizontally.



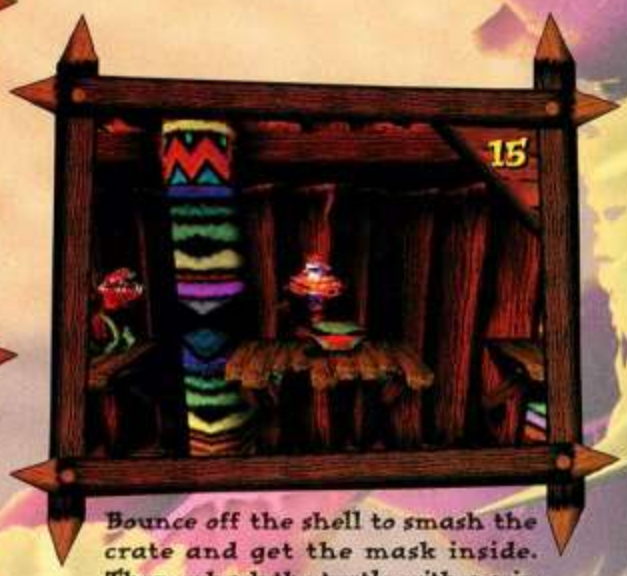
Jump off the ledge to the arrow crate, then leap up the arrows (which are generously surrounded by floating fruit)



to the checkpoint crate.

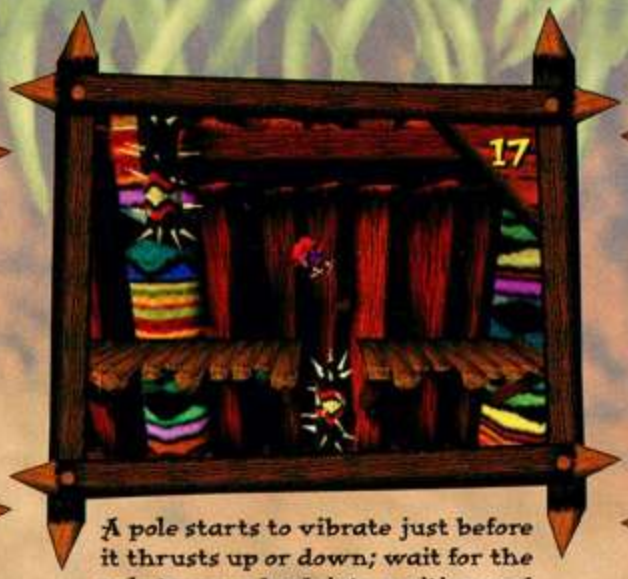


Go to the left from the checkpoint until you reach a turtle with a mask crate above it. Jump onto the turtle, but DON'T spin; if you just bounce on the turtle, he withdraws into his shell.



Bounce off the shell to smash the crate and get the mask inside. Then, whack the turtle with a spin move (if you must).

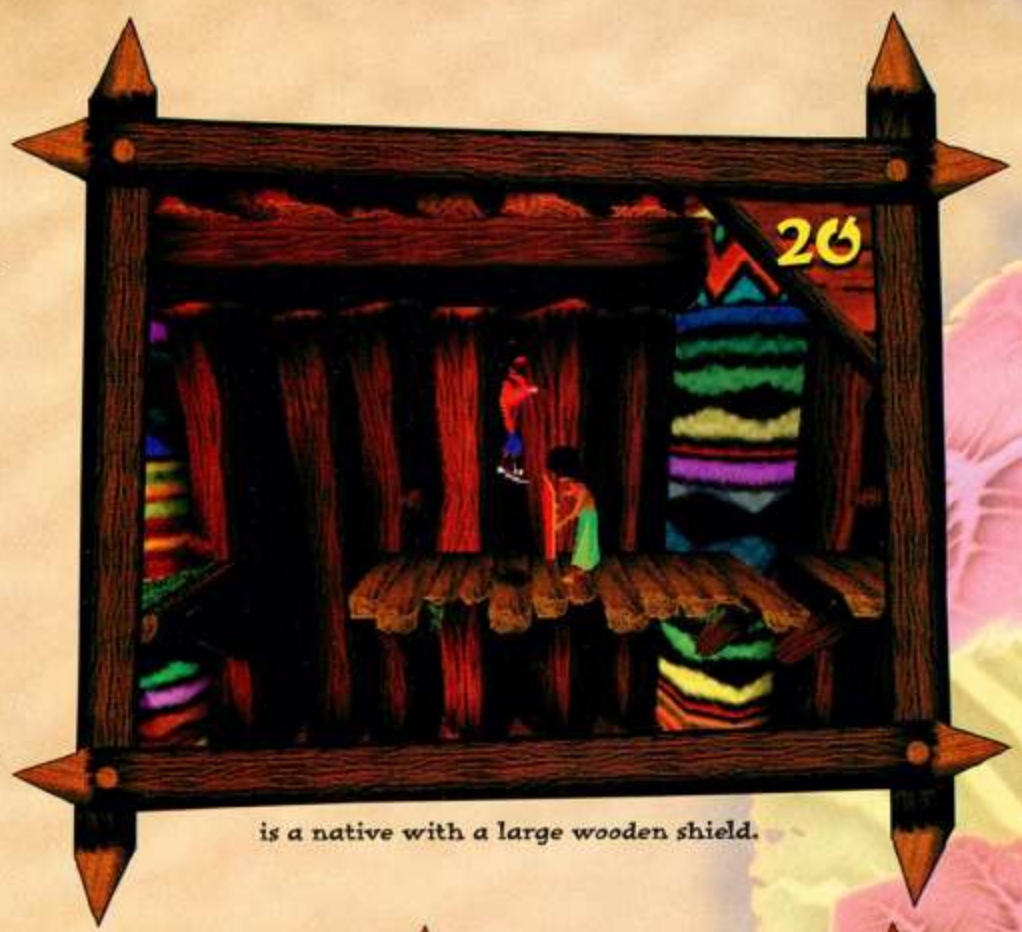
Continue left and you stumble into large black spike-covered poles that thrust into your path.



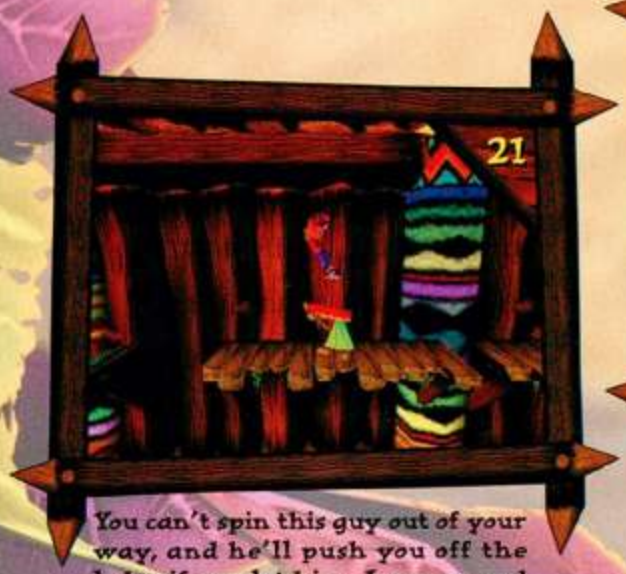
A pole starts to vibrate just before it thrusts up or down; wait for the pole to creep back into position and then jump over it (if it's in the ground)

or run under it.

Just to the left of the second Tawna crate



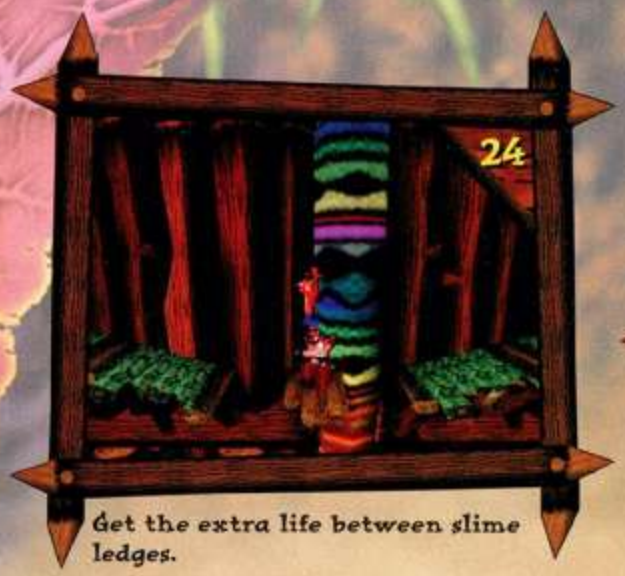
is a native with a large wooden shield.



You can't spin this guy out of your way, and he'll push you off the ledge if you let him. Jump up and onto his head (he raises his shield)

and spin to knock him away.

Just to the left of the native is a slimy green platform; when you stand still, you slide down the slime to the left. Not a problem on the first platform, but a BIG problem on the second and third platform, since you'll fall if you don't jump to counteract the sliding.



Get the extra life between slime ledges.

Next, we are introduced to a new obstacle, the flame ledge.

The key to these is timing. A small flicker will occur just before the big flame hits. The best time to move is just after the big flame dies down.

The third Tawna token is in the middle of these poles.

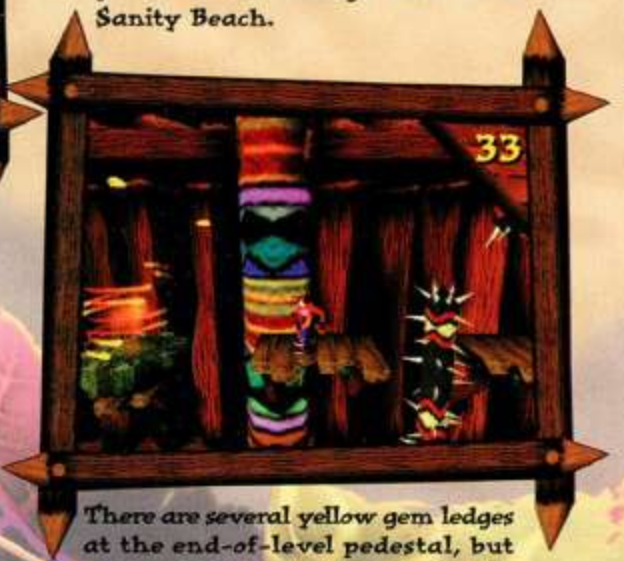
In the bonus round, jump between the two bouncy crates, then hit the TNT crate and get away before it blows up.

Use the arrow crate to activate the ! crate,

There are also three crates in the ledge that you need to break, one at a time, (plus the two in the air) just like the bridge back at N. Sanity Beach.

triggering the bridge. After you're done jumping, break the arrow crate ... of course!

Two extra lives and the babe-alicious Tawna are at the end of the bonus round. You should be 7% complete at this point.

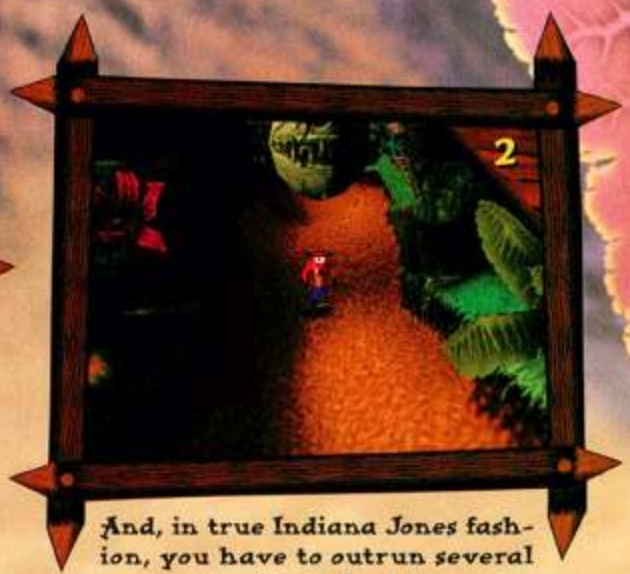


There are several yellow gem ledges at the end-of-level pedestal, but you can't jump on 'em yet—no yellow gem. Ah, well.

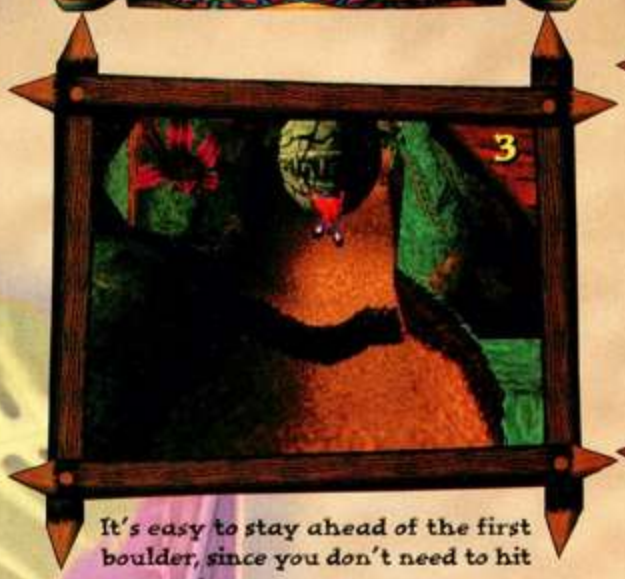
Boulders

Checkpoints: 1
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

In this level, you run "out of" the screen, as indicated by the large fruit arrow.

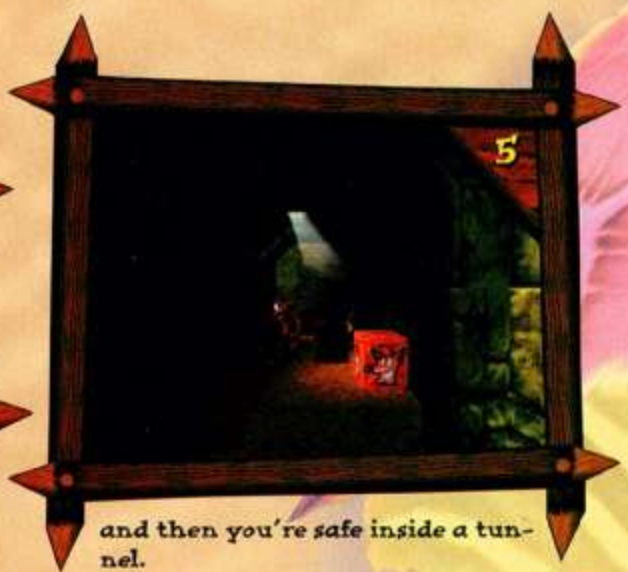


And, in true Indiana Jones fashion, you have to outrun several massive boulders along the way.

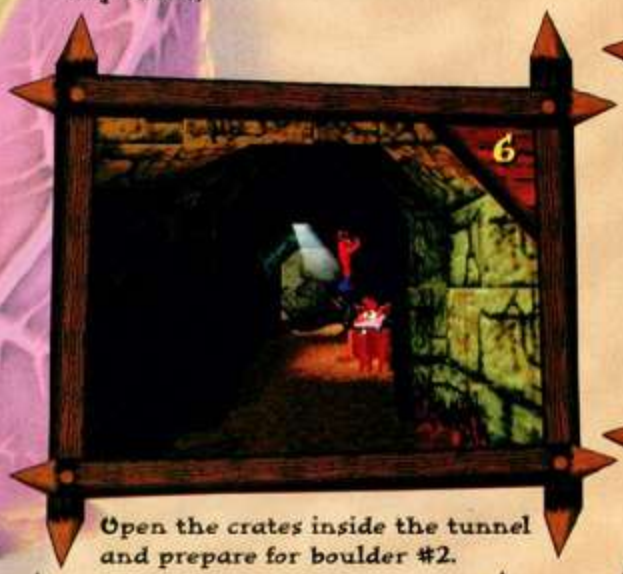


It's easy to stay ahead of the first boulder, since you don't need to hit any crates;

there are only two pits to jump,



and then you're safe inside a tunnel.

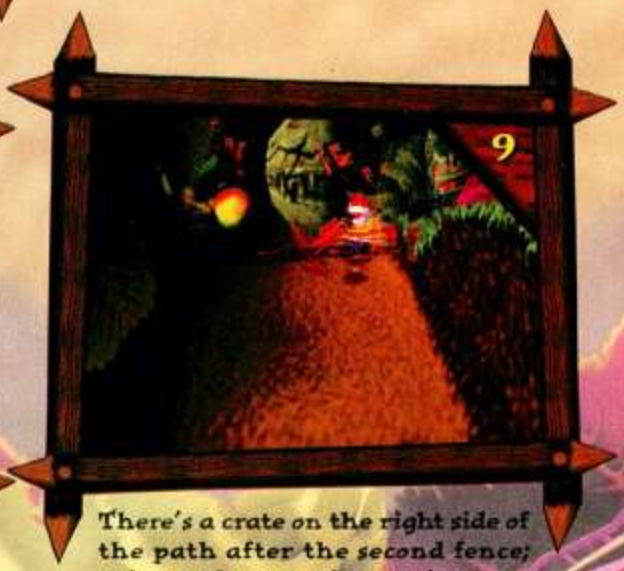


Open the crates inside the tunnel and prepare for boulder #2.

First, you need to jump over five closely spaced pits,

There's a second crate on the left side of the path after the fourth fence; this jump is harder to time, so make sure you clear the fence before you spin,

then you need to jump over five short wooden fences.



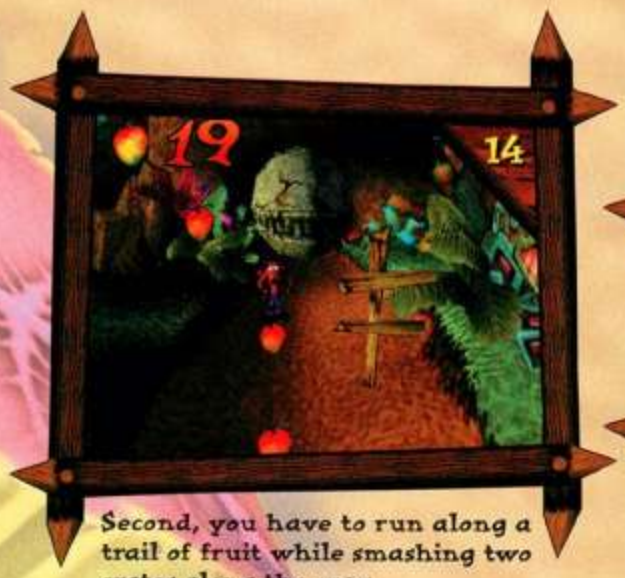
There's a crate on the right side of the path after the second fence; spin at the top of your jump to break the crate as you land.

or you'll become the world's butt-ugliest pancake.

Hit the checkpoint crate in the tunnel and take a deep breath; here comes the third and final boulder.

First, you have to jump over several pits with small green ledges in the middle of each; tough, but not TOO tough.

The first crate is on the left side (away from the fruit path)



Second, you have to run along a trail of fruit while smashing two crates along the way.

Don't stay in the middle of the path, or you'll run into a wooden fence and get, like, killed or something.

and the second is on the right side.

After the fruit path is another series of pit jumps;

make it through these and you reach the end-of-level pedestal.

If you made it through "perfect", the second clear gem is yours! (You should be 9% complete at this point.)

Upstream

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Yellow

This level uses yet another viewpoint of the action; this time, a tasty angled-overhead view. Move down and open the mask crate before starting the long trek upward.

The first "ledge" you have to use to jump across the water is a lily pad;

you can only stand on this for a short period of time before it sinks.

Also, you will want to avoid the jumping fish in this level, they'll send Crash to a watery grave every time!

The second "ledge" is a floating leaf that moves up and down in the current.

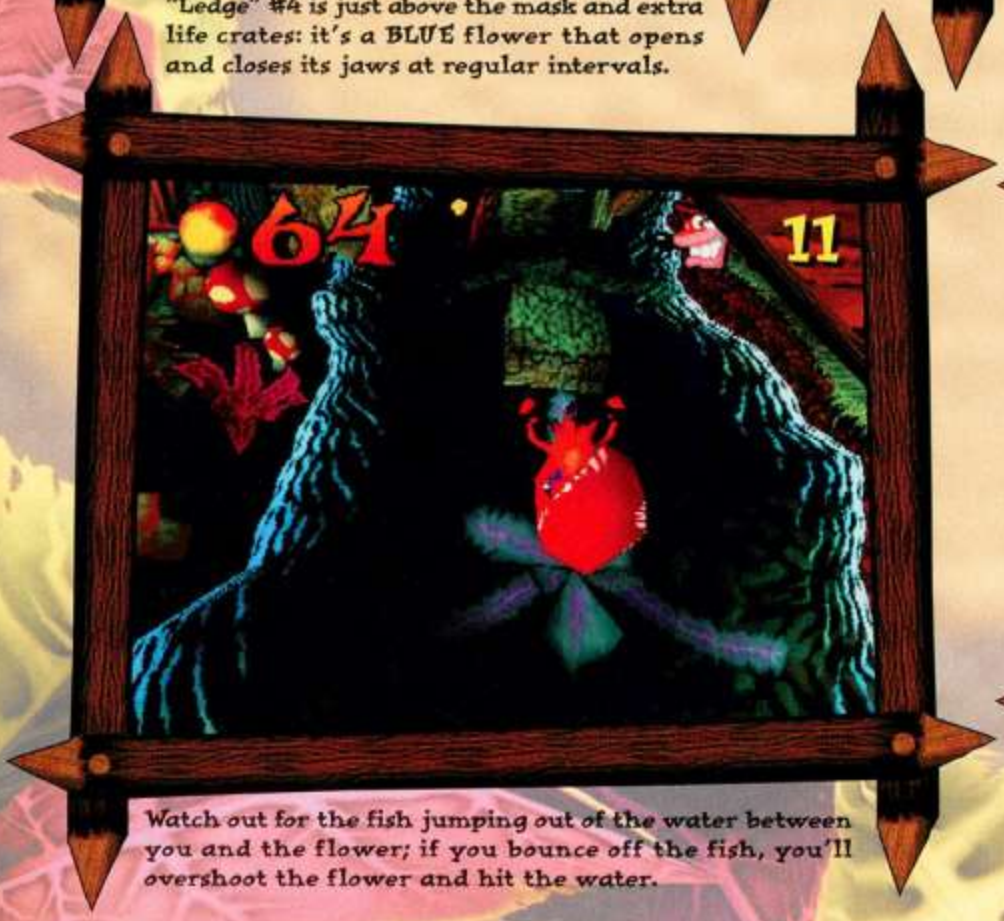
You can usually jump straight up onto the leaf, but, if your jump is badly timed, you might have to steer left or right. (You can stay on floating leaves as long as you like.)

The third type of "ledge" is just above the TNT and extra life crates: a green flower that bites you if you stand on it for more than a moment.

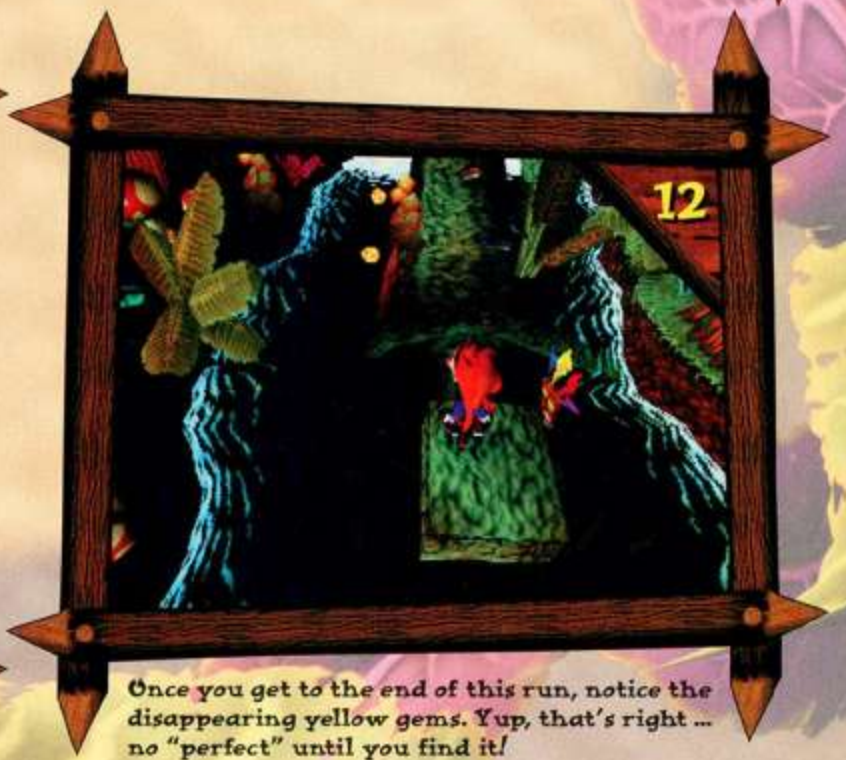
Quickly jump onto, and off of, it. Or, suffer the consequences.

"Ledge" #4 is just above the mask and extra life crates: it's a BLUE flower that opens and closes its jaws at regular intervals.

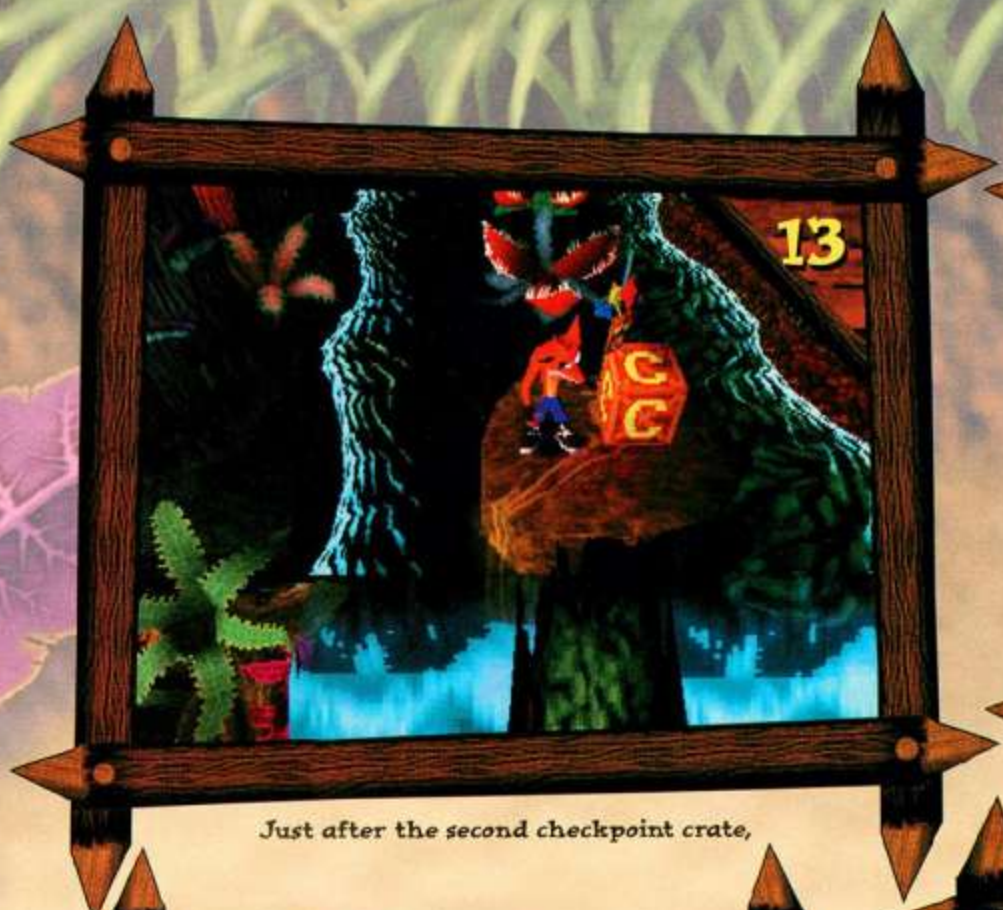
Wait until its jaws are just starting to open, then jump onto (and off) it.



Watch out for the fish jumping out of the water between you and the flower; if you bounce off the fish, you'll overshoot the flower and hit the water.

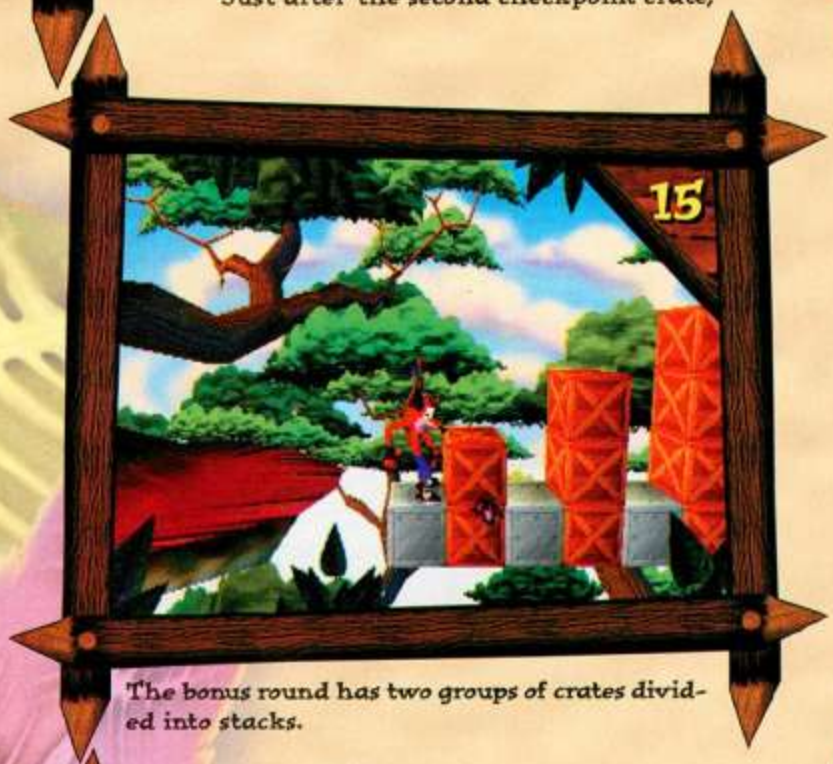


Once you get to the end of this run, notice the disappearing yellow gems. Yup, that's right ... no "perfect" until you find it!



Just after the second checkpoint crate,

you'll find the third Tawna token.



The bonus round has two groups of crates divided into stacks.

The trick is to break down the higher stacks first.

Get all the stacks flattened to the lowest level, then bounce off the crates one at a time as you move to the right.

There are two extra lives at the end. At the save point, you should be 13% complete.

The final section of this level has you jumping sideways twice onto floating leaves.

Take your time jumping across the blue flower

just before the end-of-level pedestal.

Notice the second set of floating yellow gems you can't jump onto yet. Grrr.

Papu Papu
Boss

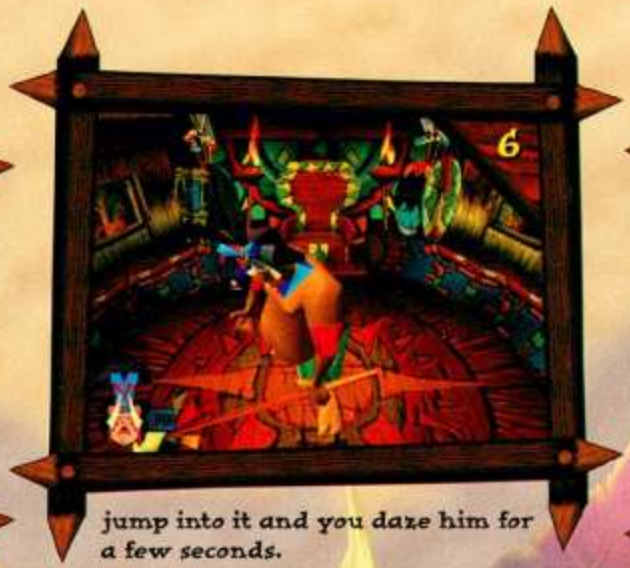
Papu Papu might look tough, but don't be intimidated by his disturbingly large belly

or his even more disturbingly large butt-crack.

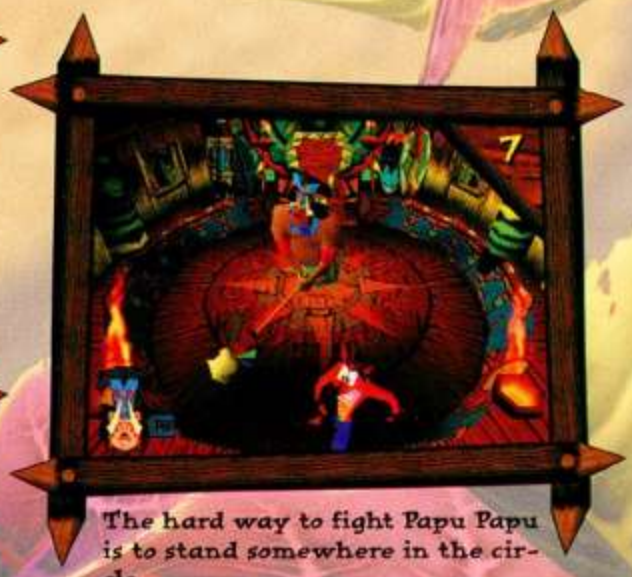
His attack pattern is very simple and predictable: he slowly rotates his giant staff in a circle twice,

then smashes it down wherever you happen to be standing.

His weak spot is his head;



jump into it and you daze him for a few seconds.



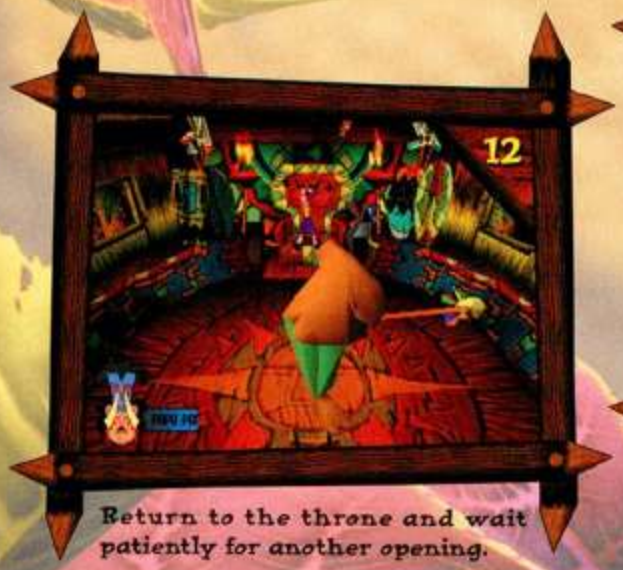
The hard way to fight Papu Papu is to stand somewhere in the circle,

jumping over the staff and avoiding it when he smashes it down. But we want somethin' nice and easy, don't we?

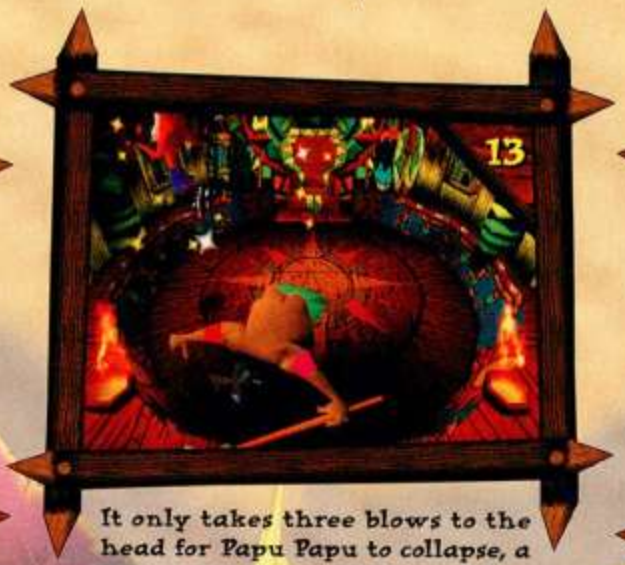
Dang straight. (show Crash art w/bubble coming out that says "dang straight") So, here's the easy way: stand on Papu Papu's throne

and wait for him to rotate away from you — the staff pointing downward on the screen —

then jump and whack him in the head.



Return to the throne and wait patiently for another opening.



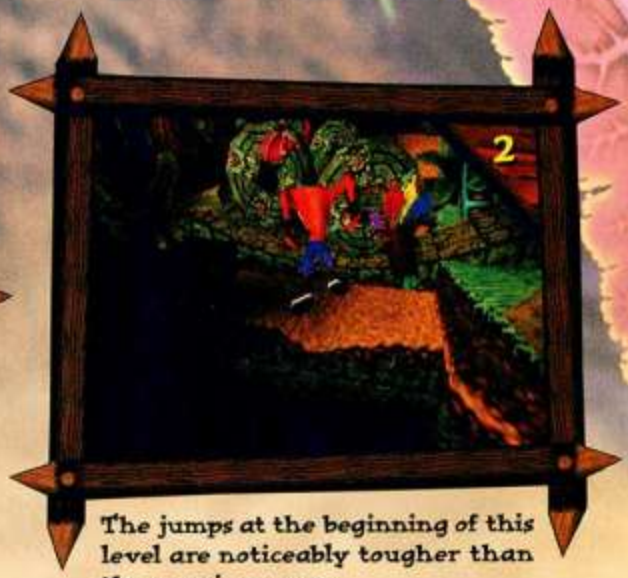
It only takes three blows to the head for Papu Papu to collapse, a beaten chieftain, onto his poi-fattened gut.

Make sure that you are out of his way when he bites it, or you will be one smashed Crash!

Rolling Stones

Checkpoints: 3
Bonus Rounds: Tawna, N. Brio
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Blue

Get movin' and scoop up the first Tawna token.



The jumps at the beginning of this level are noticeably tougher than the previous ones.

The stone wheels now almost always have pits in front of or behind them,

and the pits are BIG; you have to make well-timed jumps to clear them.

Jump on this arrow crate

to break through the bouncy crate and claim the first N. Brio token.

The first checkpoint crate doesn't come a sec too soon.

Past the first checkpoint, and after this set of wheels

is a "checkerboard" of regular and TNT crates.

Break the regular crates without setting off the TNT.

Start with the crates on the right, then jump to the crates on the left, and hit the crate in the center last.

The upper-left crate has the second N. Brio token inside.

Past the second checkpoint is a pit with a moving ledge inside it. Jump from the path onto the ledge,

then jump onto the wall,

and jump again over the pit. Definitely one of the hardest maneuvers yet.

The jumps get even nastier as you go on, forcing you to jump from a moving ledge onto a wall and onto another moving ledge!

The key is to avoid moving left and right as much as you can; if you time your jumps properly, you should be able to jump almost straight up, with just a little adjustment left or right.

Grab the second Tawna token.

Just above a mask crate is a new type of ledge; a "sinking" ledge that drops into the pit if you stand on it too long.

Quickly jump to the sinking ledge as the wheels start rolling at each other,

then onto the wall between the wheels,

then make a third jump across the pit.

The third Tawna token is just after the first sinking ledge,

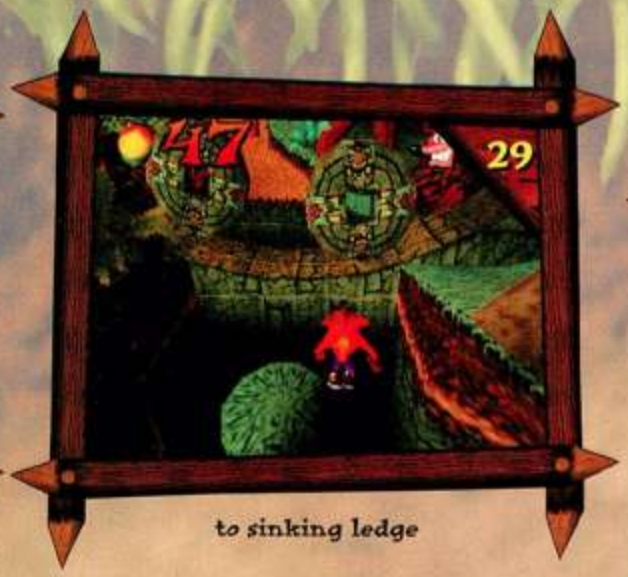
taking you to the bonus round. This one's harder than the ones before, but the key, as always, is to take your time. Move slowly from left or right, smashing every crate before moving to the next stack.

There aren't any extra lives at the end of the round, but you can save your game (and you should be about 15% done).

As you continue forward, you'll notice a pit with two blue gem ledges inside it. You don't have the blue gem yet, so you ain't getting a "Perfect" on this level, but you'll be back. Oh, yes, you'll be back.

The final series of jumps before the end of the level is absolutely brutal: sinking ledge

to wall



to sinking ledge

to wall

to MOVING ledge.

Take a little time on the sinking ledges if you can't jump to the wall without being crushed.

The third N. Brio token at the end of the level takes you to the bonus round.

This one's tougher than the Tawna bonus rounds, as it's filled with TNT crates that'll kill you if they hit you.

It's also more rewarding than the Tawna levels, giving you the chance to score up to SIX extra lives. Alas, you can't save the game when you finish the round. Bummer.

Hog Wild

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

This is a level where memorization is the key — in other words, you get to play it and die over and over again before you figure out how to beat it. But, here are steering patterns for each segment of the level anyway. (We don't need to tell you that you also need to smack into all the crates along the way, right?)

From the start to the first checkpoint: jump over three pits,

jump over two poles,

steer left and right around the poles.

From the first checkpoint to the second checkpoint: jump over the pit,

left around the native,

right around the native,

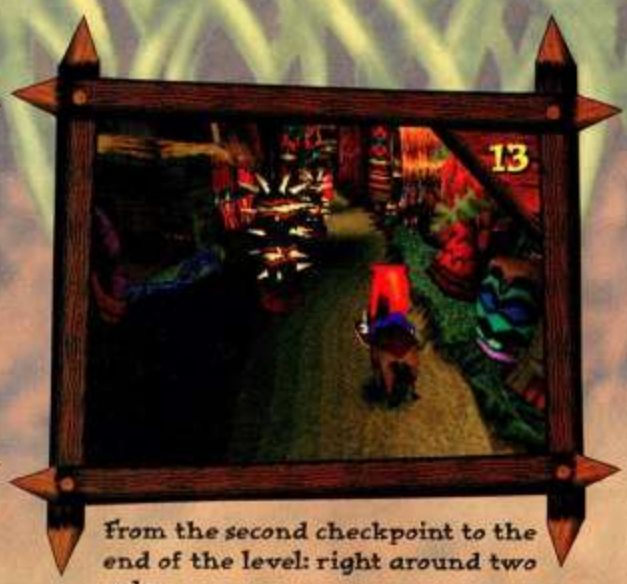
left and right around the poles,

jump off the drum,

jump off the drum,

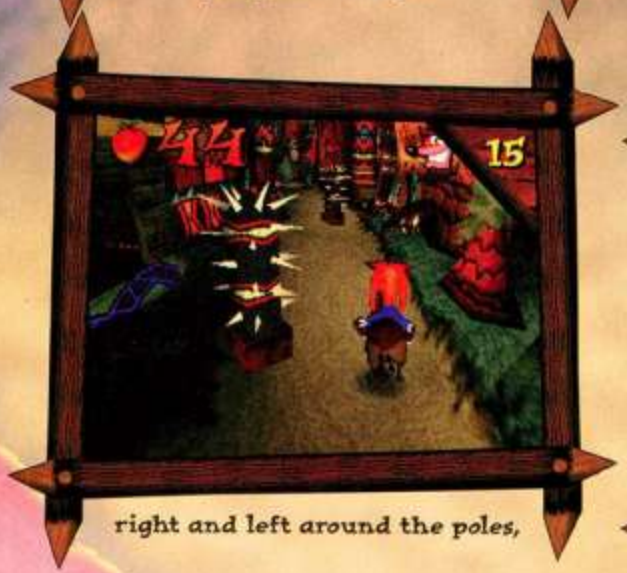
right around the native,

jump over the pole.

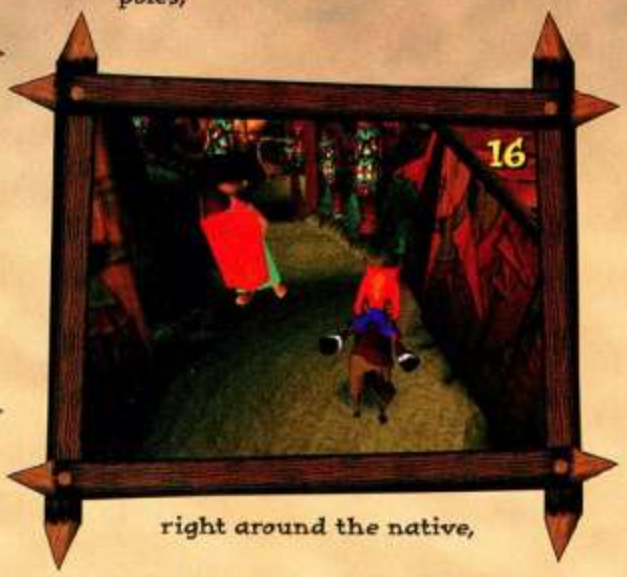


From the second checkpoint to the end of the level: right around two poles,

left around the natives,



right and left around the poles,



right around the native,

jump over the roasting pig,

right and left around the poles,

underneath the roasting pig WITHOUT jumping,

left and right around the poles,

jump over the roasting pig,

jump over the pole,

right around the native. With the clear gem, you will now have completed 17% of the game.

Native Fortress

Checkpoints: 5
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Red

This level starts out much like The Great Gate, but you soon notice the first of many differences: you need to use a high jump to get from the first arrow crate to the second

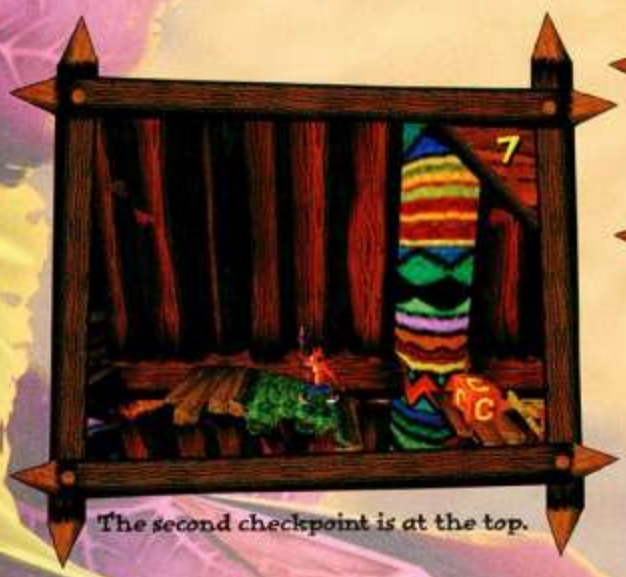
There's a turtle below the first mask crate in the level. Remember what you have learned, Grasshopper: bounce on the turtle, then hit the mask crate from below.

The first checkpoint is after a single spiky pole and a single flame.

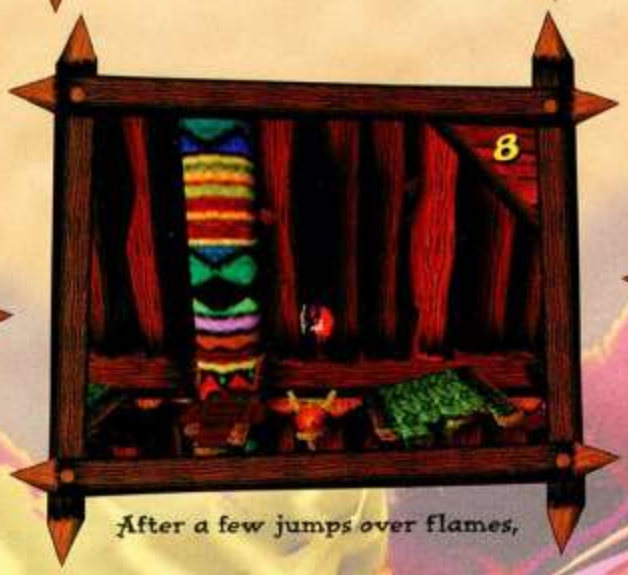
The second Tawna token is at the far left of the level, after several spiky poles and a single flame.

Bounce up the small ledges, spinning as you go to turn them horizontally,

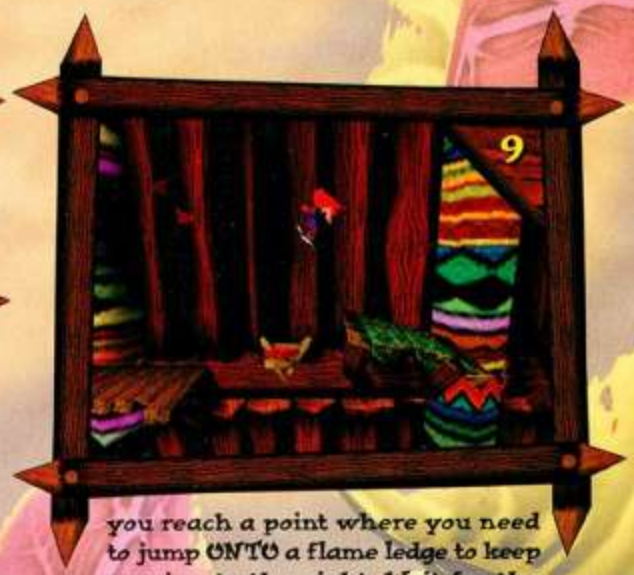
and climb up to the arrow crates.



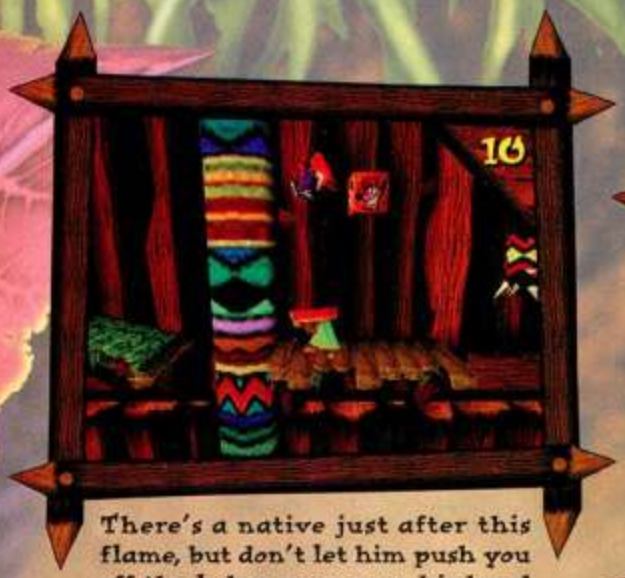
The second checkpoint is at the top.



After a few jumps over flames,



you reach a point where you need to jump ONTO a flame ledge to keep moving to the right. Wait for the flame to go out, then jump onto the ledge and steer to the right as you bounce off the ledge.



There's a native just after this flame, but don't let him push you off the ledge; pounce on his head and spin to knock him away and get the free life.

Don't be afraid of using a big jump to get over the hole with the spiky pole above it; you won't hit the pole no matter how high you jump (as long as the pole has receded).

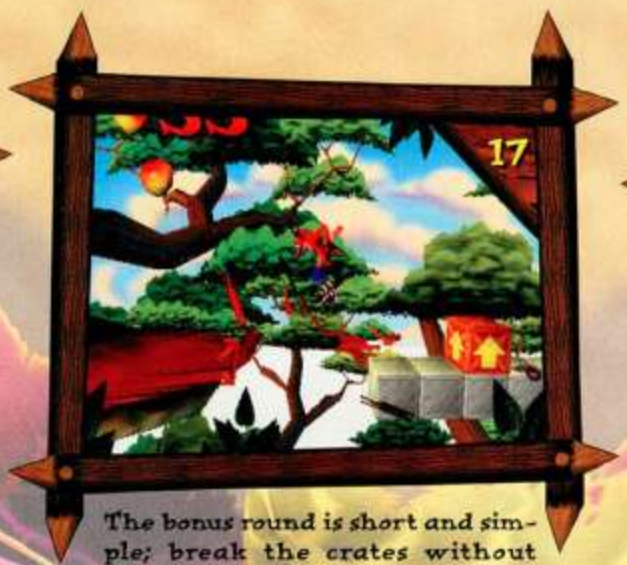
The third checkpoint crate is just to the right.

Jump and spin to drop crates down and activate the TNT crate.

Jump back to the slimy green ledge and wait for the TNT crate to explode

— then claim the extra lives.

The third Tawna token is on the far right side of the level.



The bonus round is short and simple; break the crates without falling.

There are two extra lives; the first is above the arrow crate,

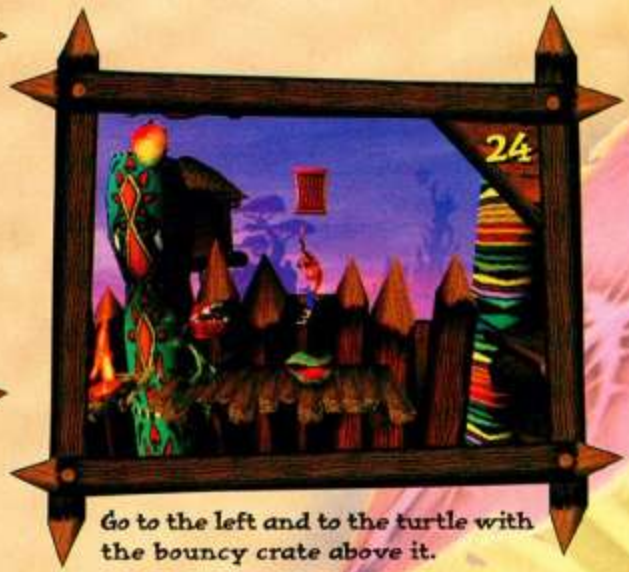
and the second is the last crate before Tawna and the save point.

If you have three clear gems, you should be at the 21% mark.

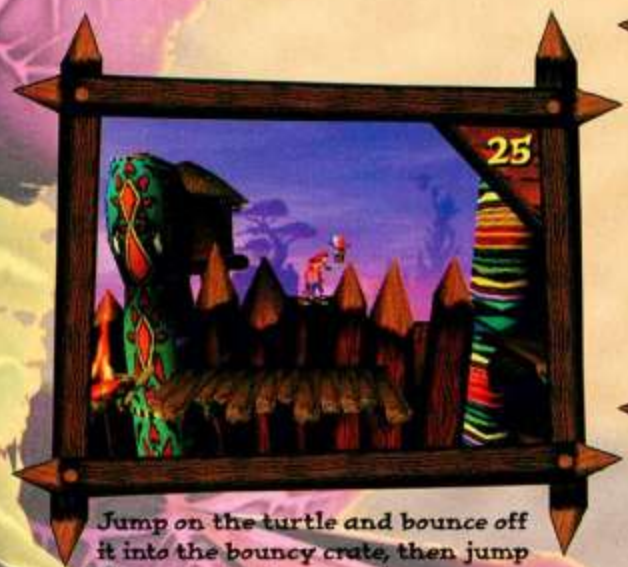
As you jump up the arrow crates after the bonus round, there are several groups of fruit in the air,

along with a mask on the left side of the screen. Grab it.

When you get to the top, you will reach the fourth checkpoint.

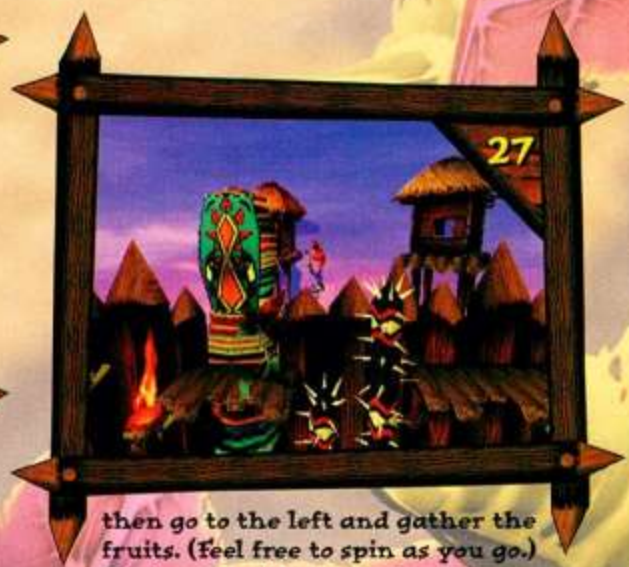


Go to the left and to the turtle with the bouncy crate above it.

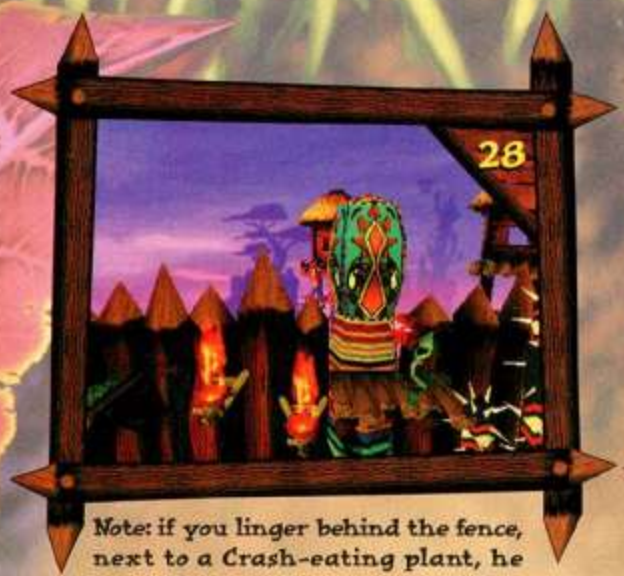


Jump on the turtle and bounce off it into the bouncy crate, then jump UP and onto the fence!

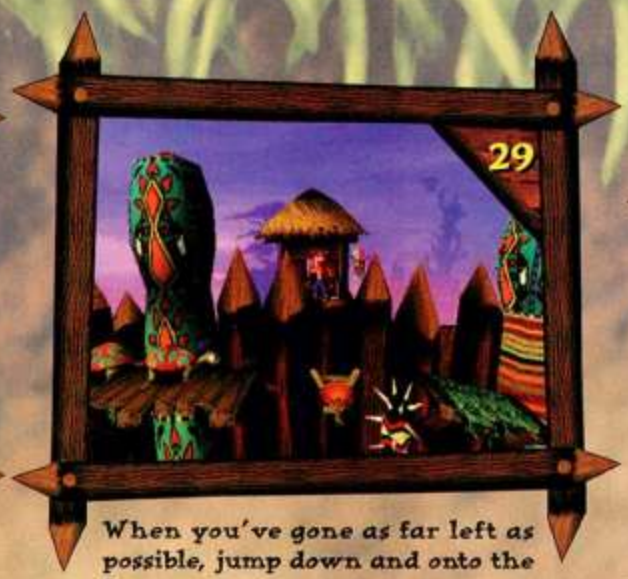
Jump up again to land BEHIND the fence,



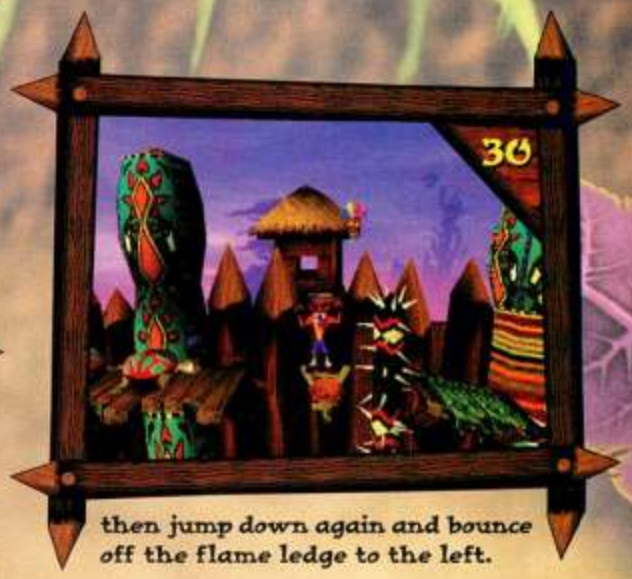
then go to the left and gather the fruits. (Feel free to spin as you go.) You're also skipping a brutal section of the level with tough jumps across spiky poles and fire.



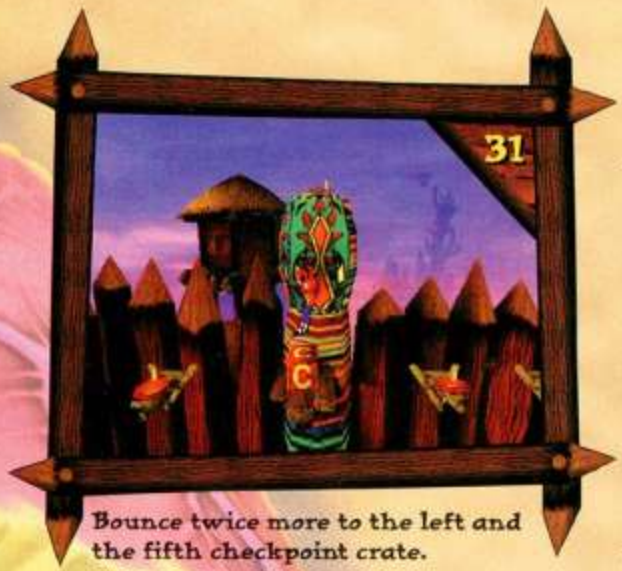
Note: if you linger behind the fence, next to a Crash-eating plant, he can still snap at you and kill you ... keep moving!



When you've gone as far left as possible, jump down and onto the fence,

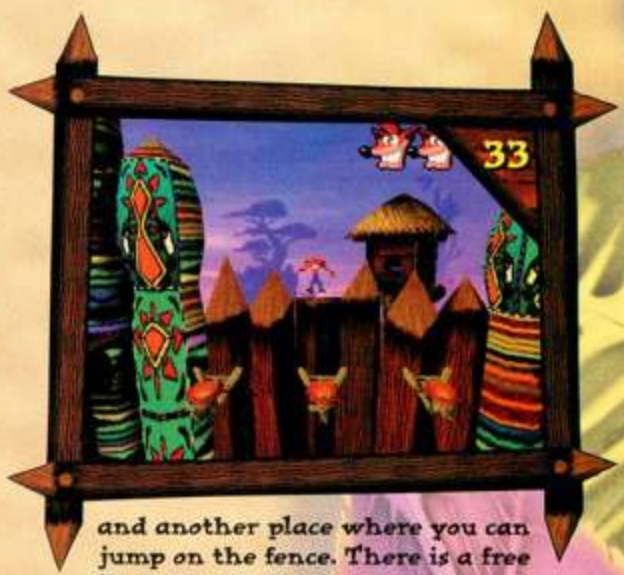


then jump down again and bounce off the flame ledge to the left.



Bounce twice more to the left and the fifth checkpoint crate.

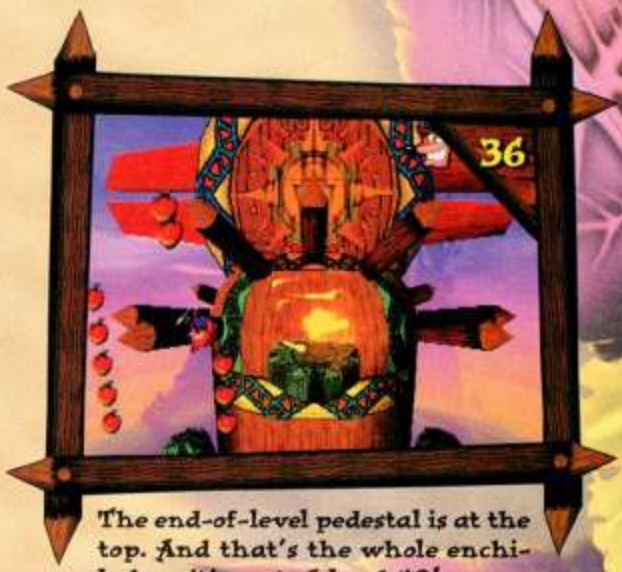
Continue left to find several red gem ledges



and another place where you can jump on the fence. There is a free life behind it. You have no red gem, so no "Perfect" for you. Yet.

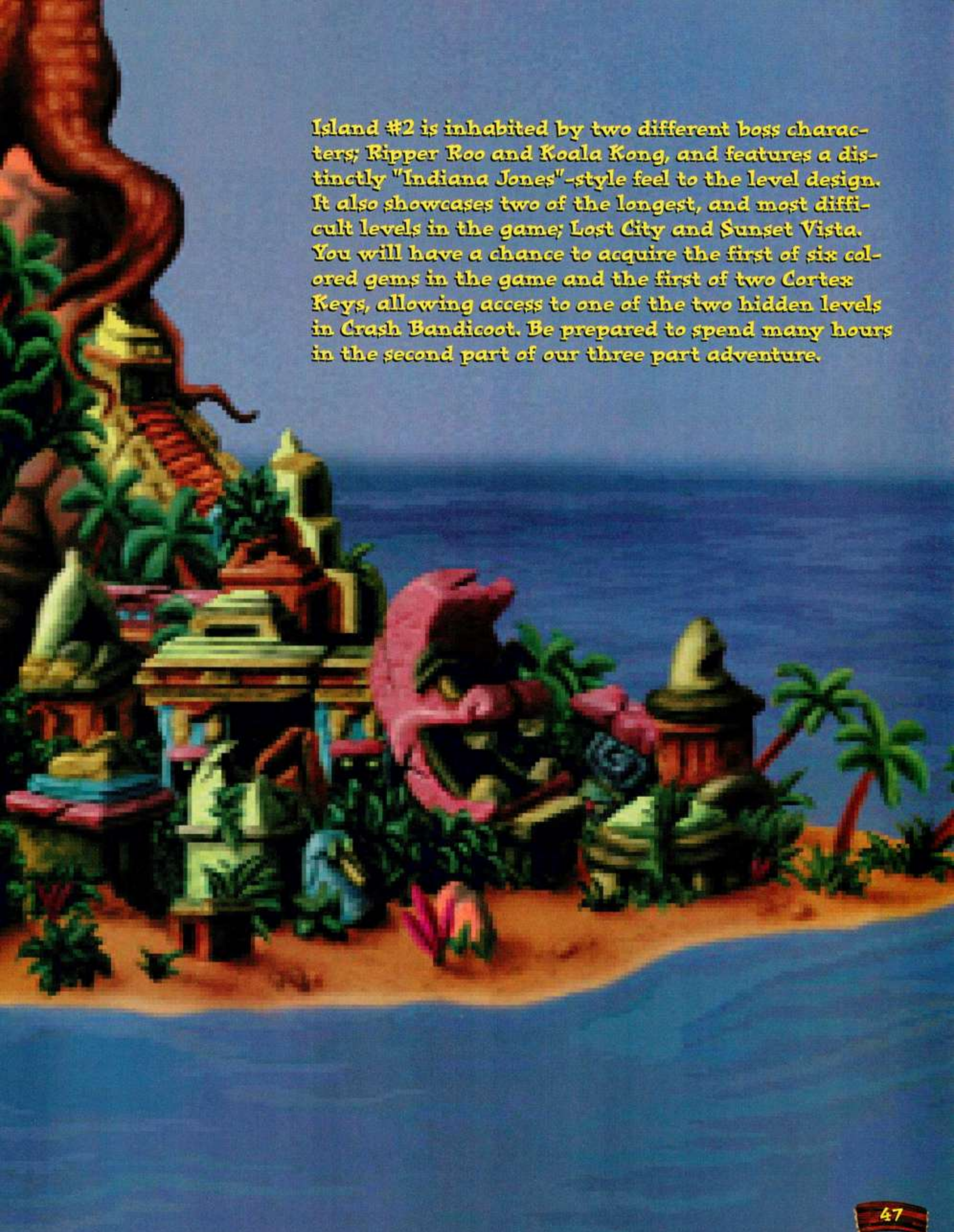
Go left to the final group of spinning ledges and arrow crates leading up to the end-of-level pedestal.

There's lots of extra guys and fruit to be had here, although, if you miss the arrow crates, you fall WAY down and have to tediously climb back up.



The end-of-level pedestal is at the top. And that's the whole enchilada ... it's on to Island #2!

Island 2



Island #2 is inhabited by two different boss characters; Ripper Roo and Koala Kong, and features a distinctly "Indiana Jones"-style feel to the level design. It also showcases two of the longest, and most difficult levels in the game; Lost City and Sunset Vista. You will have a chance to acquire the first of six colored gems in the game and the first of two Cortex Keys, allowing access to one of the two hidden levels in Crash Bandicoot. Be prepared to spend many hours in the second part of our three part adventure.

Up the Creek

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

You can't walk but a few millimeters forward (a little metric reference for the European readers) before you hit mask and extra-life crates. Take them both and you shall be happy.

Jump across two floating leaves to a mossy hill.

There's a fish at the top of the hill, so watch it as you make two more jumps to a solid ledge.

Hop onto the leaf and across the blue flower to a crate with a Tawna token inside. Pretty, pretty Tawna. (Hey, you'd be gettin' weird too, if you were up playing and writing 'til 3 A.M. every night.)

Just past the first Tawna token, thar' be a monkey on a stone platform — just before the first checkpoint. Wait for him to stop moving before you jump onto the platform and knock him off.

Jump across the floating leaf and blue flower to two lily pads,

then onto a mossy hill. There's an extra-life crate at the top.

Hit this crate with your spin

instead of jumping on it, as the jump might bounce you into the water.

Now, you get to make four jumps in a row to a solid ledge. There's a fish in front of the ledge to dodge as you jump to the floating leaf.

The second leaf takes you to a monkey platform. Knock the simian freak into the drink with your spin.

There are both green and blue flowers before the second checkpoint. Wait for Mr. Blue to snap before you start jumping.

Climb up the mossy hill to find a long pathway of lily pads at the top. Run along the pad path and jump to the solid ledge.

Now, bounce off the "!" block and back to the solid ledge; this is the nastiest jump in the level.

So what didya do by hitting that "!" block? If you keep moving forward through the level, it seems like you haven't done anything. What you gotta do is jump back onto the path of lily pads and run back down to the mossy hill.

On the left side of the hill, way down on a tiny ledge, are two newly revealed crates: a TNT crate and an arrow crate. (There is also a hidden free life under the hill on the lily pads.)

Hit the TNT crate to trigger it and bounce off the arrow crate back to the hill.

The TNT goes boom and destroys both crates.

Return to the "!" block and jump across the blue flower, with a fish jumping in front of it, to crates with the second Tawna token and an extra life.

Then, jump and walk across the diagonal path of lily pads to jump over the green flower.

There are two jumping fish in the water with the next two floating leaves, so be careful with your jump timing.

Just past this is the third Tawna token, taking you to the bonus round.

This round requires excellent timing and patience, as you use the arrow crate to launch up to the higher crates and break them, one at a time.

Make your way toward the lovely Tawna, two free lives, and 26% completion.

Just past the bonus round is a free life.

The final nasties, between you and the end-of-level pedestal, are a green flower and a blue flower with a floating leaf above it. Wait for the leaf to float down the screen, just after the blue flower snaps, then jump once onto the flower, and again onto the leaf.

You're done, buddy boy — and if you got all the crates without croaking, you've scored a "Perfect" and you are 27% complete.

Ripper Roo
Boss

Ripper Roo is a crazed marsupial in serious need of Prozac, but all you can give him for his mental instability is a series of huge explosions. (Dammit, Jim, I'm a bandicoot, not a doctor!)

The layout of Ripper's level is a 3 X 3 grid of small platforms, with rushing water separating them.

TNT crates float down the screen between the platforms, pausing for a few seconds at each one before floating down to the next. While the water flows and the crates drift, Ripper jumps around the platforms in a simple, repeating pattern that changes each time he's hurt by an explosion.

Ripper's first jumping pattern is this: he leaps to the lower-left platform,

then onto the middle-center platform,

then onto the lower-right platform,

then back to the center platform, and repeats.

You start on the lower-center platform, so you can stand still and watch the pattern before you start moving. When you DO start moving, wait for the TNT crate to float next to you on the lower-center platform.

Jump on it

and then move to the lower-right platform and wait for Ripper to sizzle.

After taking his first hit, Ripper goes into his second pattern: middle-left platform,

lower-center platform,

middle-right platform,

middle-center platform, repeat.

Stay on the lower three platforms, and jump across to trigger a TNT crate ... and give RR his second ride on the rotisserie.

After taking his second hit, Ripper goes into his third pattern: top-center platform,

middle-right platform,

bottom-center platform,

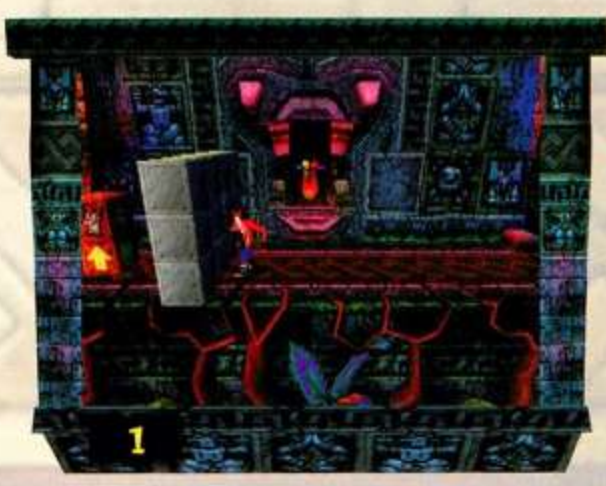
middle-left platform, repeat.

Don't worry about the Roo-man's shenanigans, just stay on the lower level. Move to the left and right to trigger a well-timed TNT crate and watch him fry

and die ... R.I.P.per Roo! ... (pun FULLY intended.)

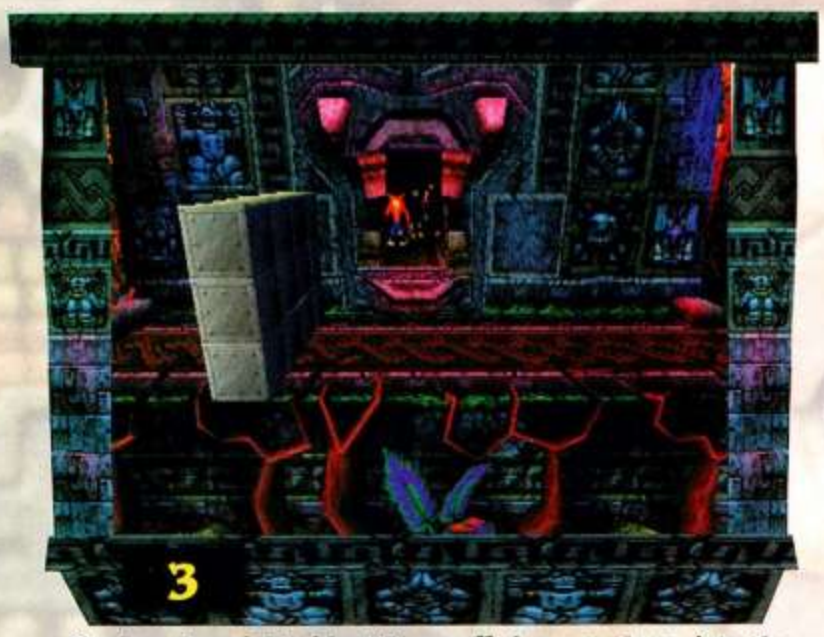
The Lost City

Checkpoints: 4
Bonus Round: Tawna, N. Brio
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Green
Gem Needed for Perfect: None



Walk left at the start to see an extra-life crate and an arrow crate behind the wall. But, how are you going to jump over it? Well, you can't, so you're going jump AROUND it.

Jump down and then curve quickly around the wall to land in front of the crates. It's not a tough jump, but you might wanna practice it on another level before trying it here. Break open both crates and jump around the wall again. (You can't use the arrow crate to bounce over the wall if you want to score a "Perfect.")



Back on the right side of the wall, jump and run into the tunnel, snagging the mask at the end. Aren't these 3-D graphics "the bomb"?

Go to the right and to a wall that slides in and out of the background.

Wait for a safe moment and sprint past it, then jump onto the crawling lizard to kill it.

Jump into the tunnel and open the three extra-life crates, then squeeze some fruits out of the bouncy crate.

Leave the tunnel and go to the right past another sliding wall until you see a floating ledge. You can only stand on this for a few seconds before it drops into the water, so quickly jump on it and again to the right.

See the bat on the ceiling?

Every five seconds or so, a group of bats flies from the right side of the screen to the left, curving up and off at the same spot as the ceiling bat. Jump and spin into the bat to knock it away, then go right and into the tunnel for fruit and a "?" crate with the first Tawna token.

Continue right to the second bat in the ceiling and wait in the area below it for the line of bats to fly past you. Jump and spin into the bat.

With both ceiling bats gone, the line of bats stops coming onto the screen. There are fruits and a bouncy crate in the next tunnel. Spin as you fly off the bouncy crate to hit a hidden "!" block. Now, go right past two sliding walls to the first checkpoint.

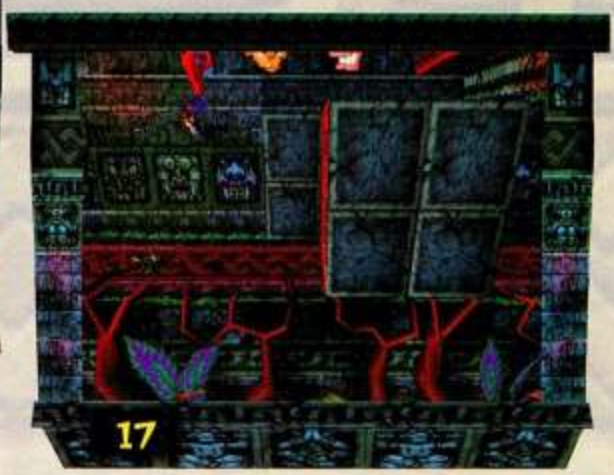
Jump down to the stump, then up to the ledge with a crate and the N. Brio token and extra life floating above. (The crate wouldn't be here if you hadn't hit the "!" block.) Bounce straight up off the crate -- hold down the jump button for extra height -- to take the N. Brio token, then steer right to take the extra life. If you miss the life, you can still jump up and get it.

Jump right across two floating ledges to an area of bats. Move right to find two ledges moving in a circle around a platform with a single fruit.

Ignore the fruit, because what you really want to do is jump from a circling ledge over to the top of the sliding walls, to grab the extra life. Fall into the hole just to the right of the walls after you grab the life.

Jump up and hit the ceiling bat. Drop into the second hole, wait for the bats to go by and jump up and run into the tunnel to take the second Tawna token. Drop down into the hole again, then jump up and bounce on the crawling lizard, wait for the bats, go right, and hit the second bat. The second checkpoint is just to the right.

There's a large jumping lizard just to the right of the second checkpoint. Wait for it to jump right, then jump across.



You need to bounce off the lizard onto the sliding walls to grab the extra life and second N. Brio token.

Past the four sliding walls are tiny ledges that slide in and out of the background wall. The first two are easy to jump onto, but the location of the third one forces you to jump up and left, then up and right, quickly. Run as far left as you can before jumping, or you hit the ledge above you and fall.

Jump up the circling ledges to the third checkpoint.

Ride up the next circling ledges and jump onto the solid ledge at the top. Collect the free life and jump to the left and bounce off the "!" block, then steer right so you don't get scorched by the torch.

Continue climbing up the small sliding ledges until you reach the top.

Go to the left to spot a red jumping lizard. This bugger is more aggressive than the green lizard, which jumps in a predictable pattern; he'll jump straight at you. Hit him with a spin or a pounce.

Walk left and run into the tunnel, then go right into the room with crates, which don't appear unless you hit the "!" block below. The third N. Brio token is in one of the crates, giving you access to the N. Brio bonus round and the fourth checkpoint.

Like other N. Brio bonus rounds, there are a bunch of extra lives to be had. A combination of well-timed TNT jumps and spin moves will get you through.

Go left to a bridge with five pieces.

When you stand on either side of the bridge, it starts to rotate in that direction until it's vertical, at which time you fall and die. Bad.

Stand in the middle of the bridge, on the center piece, and it doesn't move. Good. The moral of the story: always jump to the middle of these bridges as you cross them.

Continue left, nabbing the extra life in the air, until you reach the red lizard. Lead it to the right and onto the solid ledge before you pounce on it.

Go left and kill the ceiling bat, then wait to jump across the four sliding ledges. Jump across to the left and quickly strike the second bat. You've reached the fourth and final checkpoint.

There are two sliding walls to the left. Wait for both of them to extend, and then retract at the same time, before you run left into the space.

Now, you're faced with three walls. Use the same technique, waiting for all three walls to retract at once before you run past them. (If you're an advanced player, you can use curving jumps to leap around the walls, but it's foolishly dangerous. Better to take your time and be safe.)

The final group of two walls is the easiest to pass; jump when the right-hand wall retracts, and run left past the left-hand wall when it slides back.

Grab the free life above the platform and move toward the green lizard on the left. Wait for him to jump left, then jump onto the ledge. When he jumps back into the middle, bounce off him to hit the "?" crate in the air and collect some fruit.

Continue left to what we humbly think is one of the trickiest areas in the level. There's a ceiling bat and a crawling lizard on a low ledge. Hit the lizard with a jump, not a spin.

Wait for the bats to fly past you before you jump left onto the ledge and jump again to hit the second lizard. Jump up and left to smack the second ceiling bat, then open up the "?" crate with the third Tawna token inside.

A bonus round and a saving opportunity!

Continue left across two bridges, nabbing the free life along the way, then stand on the right edge of the platform with the green lizard. Wait for him to bounce left, then pounce onto him and run left past the sliding walls.

Getting past the second green lizard is harder. He pounces back and forth between three ledges, with a "!" block above the middle ledge. Wait for him to jump left, then jump onto the right ledge. When he jumps onto the middle ledge, bounce off him

to hit the "!" block and break open the fruit crates in the background.

Get the fruit, go left, and jump onto the end-of-level pedestal.

If you scored a "Perfect," you're given a green gem, the first colored gem in the game. Remember the level "Jungle Rollers" back on Island #1? With the green gem, you can now score a "Perfect" on it. (Refer to the "Secrets" section for more info.)

One other note; from this point forward in the guide, we will not be making note of the percentage complete at the end of bonus rounds and after you have acquired gems and keys. Once the green gem is in your possession, the game becomes less linear and you have options, in terms of how you proceed. With the green gem in tow, you could head back to Jungle Rollers, find the secret area and additional crates, and save after a "perfect" completion of the level. Or, you could continue progressing through Island #2 and beyond ... thus achieving a different path for completion.

Temple Ruins

Checkpoints: 3
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

Directly in front of you are the first and most common dangers in this level: pillars with spikes that pop in and out. Since the spikes pop out both high and low, you can't jump through them; just wait for the spikes to come out, then run through the pillars.

There are mask, arrow, and bouncy crates past these first pillars. Open them, walk left and jump across the skinny pillar and floating ledge.

A blue snake pops out of the hole on the solid ledge. Spin into it or jump on it.

If you use the spin, it flies into the pile of crates behind it. There's an extra life in one of 'em.

Continue upward through the spike pillars and jump across two floating ledges.

Hit the extra life crate, then the TNT crate, and jump left when the moving pillar is low. Wait for the pillar to rise to the top and jump left to the first checkpoint.

Whack the snake, open the crates, and jump through the spike pillars onto the moving pillar. Jump from one pillar to the next when the one you're standing on is high and the one to which you're jumping is low.

There's a steady pillar just in front of the tunnel.

Open the "?" crate for fruit and observe the bats that fly through the tunnel at regular intervals; make sure you're not jumping when these buggers are flapping at you.

Open the regular crate and run past the crushing walls as they slide open.

Wait at the end of the tunnel for the bats to take flight, then jump across the ledge to an area loaded with crates.

Look for a strange shadow in the middle of the ledge.

It's a spider that plops down to the ledge every ten seconds or so, then climbs back off the screen, and plops again.

Spin into it or pounce it, then open all the yummy crates; one has an extra life. Squeeze through the spike pillars, open the crates, and walk right onto the circular ledge.

It carries you away to a new area.

Walk right onto the ledge and wait for the torch to flame on and flame out.

Quickly jump across the torch and floating ledge. Open the crates, then walk through the spike pillars and spin into the snake. (A good technique here is to exercise a little patience; spin into the snake and pull back on the directional pad, then run through the spikes ... this tip will save you a couple of lives.)

Jump upward across the torch and pillar, then jump from the circling pillars to the second checkpoint.

From the checkpoint, jump up twice to the tunnel.

There's a mask crate between the two crushing walls.

Jump onto the floating ledge when the pillar behind it is low, then quickly jump to the pillar before it rises. Jump up again to the solid ledge. See the fruit on the left, floating in midair? Walk to the left to take it.

Don't jump -- just take a "walk of faith" and a metallic crate appears under your feet.

Keep walking to the left until you reach a big ol' pile of hidden crates, with an extra life and a bouncy crate among them.

Open them all and then break the single crates in the path as you walk back to the right.

Walk past the spike pillars and open the bouncy crate, then jump right onto the moving pillar.

Jump again across the torch and floating ledge to a pillar. Watch the circling pillars; when one of them starts shaking, it's about to sink into the darkness for a few seconds. Don't be on one when this happens, for you would lose a life.

Jump to the right,

then downward, onto the center, stable platform

to reach the third checkpoint.

Kill the not even remotely itsy-bitsy spider and open the crates below it.

Walk onto the circular ledge and it carries you to a new area.

Walk forward onto the ledge and wait for the torch to go out

before you leap up twice to a ledge with an extra life crate.

Now, you have to cross a huge group of circling pillars.

Keep in mind that they shake just before sinking. There's a solid pillar in the middle that you can stand on for a breather.

You should be able to jump straight up to get all the way across, but be ready to steer in mid-air, just in case.

Your reward for getting through here is three extra life crates on the ledge.

Jump up two moving pillars to the final tunnel

and open the "?" crate for an extra life.

Move past the crushing wall, then the two crushing walls placed back-to-back.

Start moving forward when the first wall opens to give yourself plenty of time. Wait for the bats to cruise through the tunnel before you jump to the end-of-level pedestal.

If you were "perfect," collect the Clear Gem and you are golden!

Road to Nowhere

Checkpoints: 4
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Red

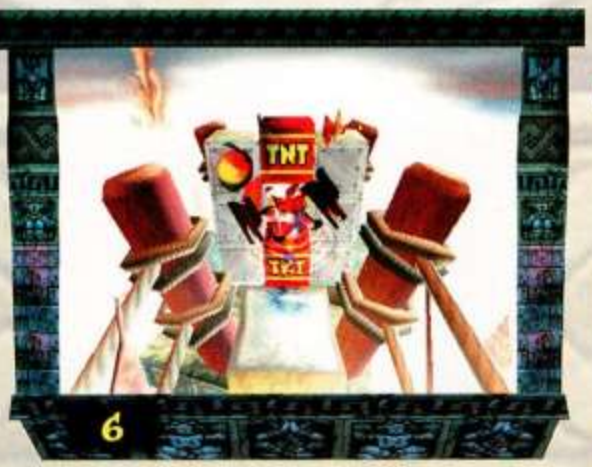
Open the mask and bouncy crates at the start of the level and psyche yourself up for a major-league test of your jumping abilities. You're going to shed lives like Oprah sheds pounds, until you get the feel for leaping.

The first two types of bridge planks are right at the start. The light wood planks are "solid" planks; you can stand on these forever if you want and they'll stay perfectly still.

The dark wood planks are NOT solid;

these feeble things plunge off the screen only a second after you touch them, meaning you have to jump on and off them very quickly.

After the first bridge section is a "wall" of two TNT crates and a "?" crate.



Jump and spin as you're falling from the jump to break open the middle crate

-- it's very important to spin as you're falling, not as you're jumping! -- and you'll smack open the middle crate without hitting either TNT.

Jump over the crates, and prepare for the second bridge section. The third type of plank is a cracked plank that collapses practically the moment you touch it. You can land and jump off the edges of these planks, but it's best to avoid them completely. (There's nowhere in this level you have to land on a cracked plank.)

Keep jumping upward until you reach the first checkpoint and the first Tawna token.

Wait for the ugly critter to run at you, then jump over him as you start leaping across the next section of bridge.

There's a warthog running back and forth on the bridge above the first checkpoint.

At the end of this section is the next new type of plank, an icy plank that causes you to slip downward. Jump quickly from the icy planks to the solid ledge (with three crates.)

Leap across the next bridge section with single dark planks (the most precise jumping yet)

to the second checkpoint and two free lives.

Continue upward, past the warthog

to the next solid ledge with two crates, including the second Tawna token,

then trudge ahead to the third checkpoint.

Take your time, watch for Crash's shadow to guide your jumps,

and stop on the light planks to catch your breath.

There are plenty more dark planks between the third and fourth checkpoints.

We wish we could be more help, but with a jump-intensive level like this, there ain't much we CAN say. All we can do is show you what we did, and show you where we ended up ... Checkpoint 4!

The area between the fourth checkpoint and the third Tawna token has an extra life in a "?" crate,

and a warthog

near the fifth checkpoint and the third Tawna token, leading to the bonus round.

This bonus round is one of the easiest that you've come across in awhile. Just be patient and set off the TNT crates.

There are two free lives hanging out next to the Tawna-gram.

The final series of jumps is the nastiest. Follow the turtle to the north end of the bridge,

then pounce on him (don't spin) to make him retreat into his bouncy-yet-protective shell.

Jump high off the turtle and leap north to the next ledge. It is VERY difficult to make this jump without bouncing off the shell.

There's a second turtle shell lodged in the bridge;

bounce off it and keep going north to the end-of-level pedestal. There's a disappearing red gem, meaning you still missed a whole lotta crates, but you shall (nay ...you MUST) return.

Boulder Dash

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Pink

1

Crack open the bouncy and extra life crates at the start and walk forward through the tunnel.

2

Why, look -- it's a gigantic boulder that you'll have to out run almost perfectly to avoid getting squashed. And there are two more boulders later on in the level. (Okay, now we're just being cruel.) Remember that you can't stop running downward when a boulder's behind you -- pause for even a half-second and you're doomed.

3

The first obstacle on the first boulder course is a series of five pillars. One of the pillar jumps isn't QUITE at full strength -- it's the high pillar to the low one -- so don't jump too high.

4

After the pillars is a group of five fences with pits placed just before two of them. (The pattern is: fence, pit/fence, fence, pit/fence, fence.) Jump as lightly over the pits as you can

5

to give yourself time to jump over the fences on the other side.

6

Amen, it's the first checkpoint!

7

The path of the second boulder starts with jumps across six still and moving pillars,

then a maze of tall fences.

to get through the maze without hitting a fence. The final obstacle is a group of five moving pillars, then it's into the tunnel for the second checkpoint.

Follow the fruit

Open the bouncy crate before you touch the TNT crate and start running from the third and final boulder.

The final obstacle course starts with a small group of small AND tall fences; let the fruit be your guide.

Next up is a group of six pillars; keep a smooth rhythm as you leap across them. Keep running downward to hit a group of pits with tall fences on the other side; guide yourself in the air to avoid hitting the fences as you land.

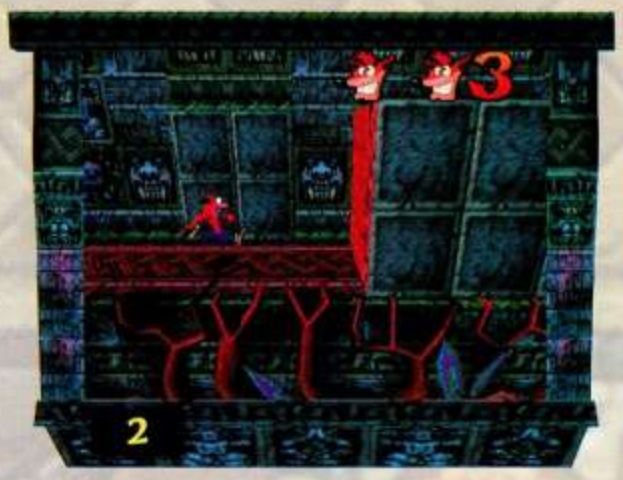
And last, but not least, is a second group of six pillars;

make it through and you reach the end-of-level pedestal. You don't have the pink gem yet, so you won't score a "Perfect." Soon, my friend.

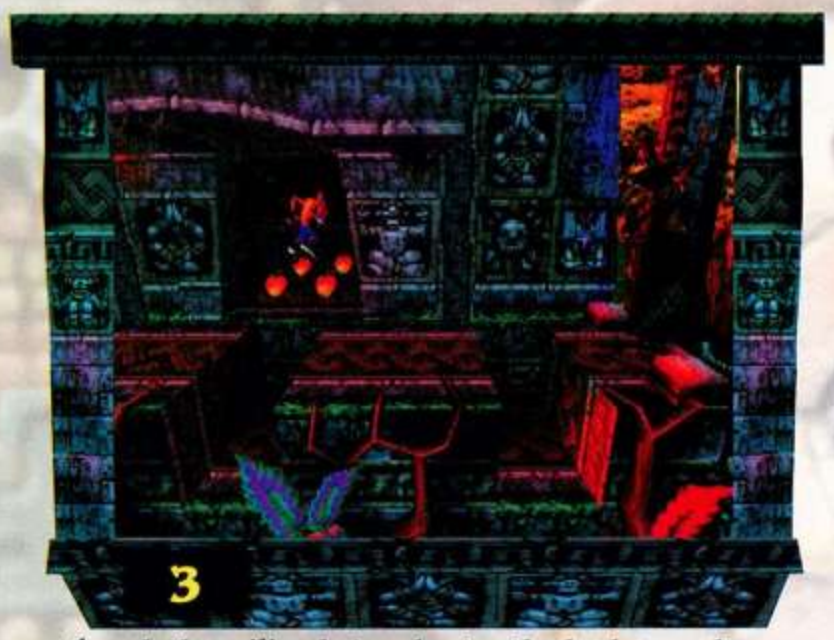
Sunset Vista

Checkpoints: 7
Bonus Rounds: Tawna, Cortex
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

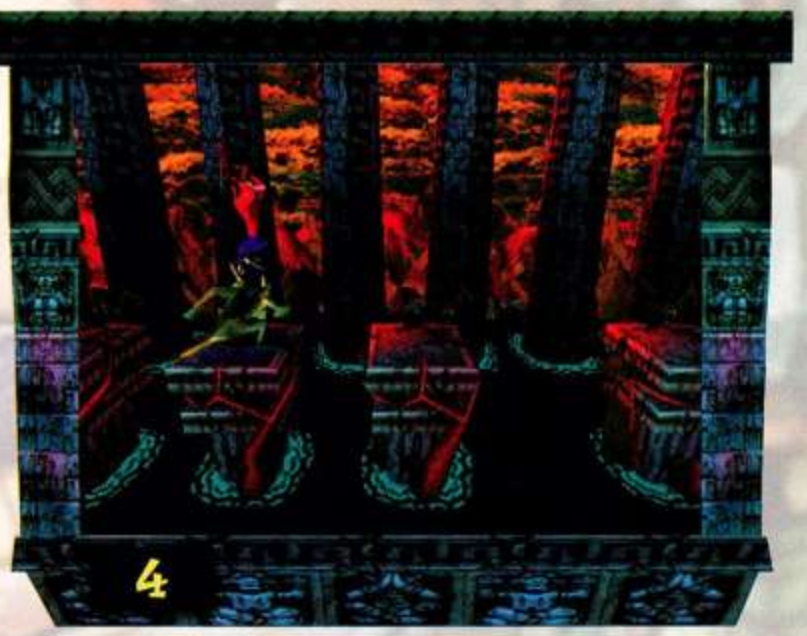
This is easily the longest and toughest level on Island #2, with SEVEN checkpoints and plenty of tricky little spots where you can die. If you earn a "Perfect" here, you kick much booty. From the start, enter the background room, pick up the fruit, and open the bouncy crate.



Walk right and jump over the torch and bridge to the solid ledge. Crack open the extra life crate and run past the sliding walls; a group of two, then a group of three.

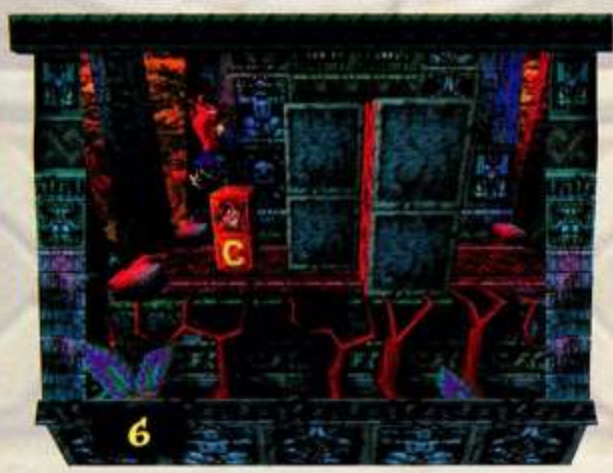


Smack the ceiling bat and enter the background room with mask and extra life crates.



Hit the second ceiling bat and continue moving to the right. Jump to the stump and to the first of the three ledges, then pounce the green lizard when he jumps to the middle ledge.

Continue to the right and spin into the bat as you jump to the stump. There are two crawling lizards to the right; pounce off them one at a time, waiting for the bats before you move to the next.



Hit the ceiling bat and jump to the right to hit the first checkpoint.

Run past the sliding walls to three circling ledges.

Jump on one and ride it to the ledge with two extra life crates.

Run past the two groups of two sliding walls to the three sliding walls. Run past them and hit the ceiling bat as you drop into the hole. Wait for the bats to soar above you, then jump right across the torch and on to the stump. Wait for another bat fly-by, then jump up, hit the ceiling bat, and pounce on the green lizard. (Wait for the lizard to jump to the right before you jump up to hit the bat.)

Just to the right of checkpoint #3 is a small pink ledge that shakes and retracts into the wall a moment after you jump on it. There's a second pink ledge as you jump upward, so watch for it.

Keep moving up the ledges until you reach a point with a torch on your left. You have to jump from the torch to the circling ledge above it, without scalding your tootsies in the process. Jump straight up as the ledge comes at you. Let the ledge carry you up almost all the way into the solid ledge, before you jump to it.

Now, continue right past the two circling ledges and the stumps. To your right are a group of ledges that alternate sliding in and out of the wall. (Don't bother with the tunnel -- there's nothing in it.) Jump across them, one ledge at a time, to the second checkpoint.

Run past the three sliding walls when all three of them slide forward and then back. Jump and run past the two sliding walls when they both withdraw and hit the third checkpoint. Would you believe you're not even halfway done yet?

Smash the stack of three crates to find the first Tawna token.

Climb upward until you reach a room with fruit and a bouncy crate. Take them and go left to jump across two bridges. There's a thin ledge between the bridges that slides into the wall after you jump on it, so quickly get across to the second bridge.

Enter the tunnel past the second bridge and hit the fourth checkpoint.

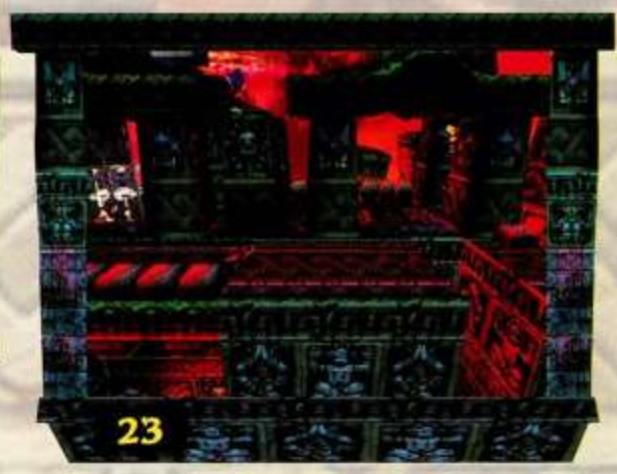
Move left to the two large sliding walls and the smaller thin ledges below them. Wait for the first wall to slide into the background with the thin ledge still sticking out, then start jumping to the left.

The first jump is a quick one, but you have a little time on the others. Keep going left, until you reach a pile of crates with two extra lives and a mask.

Jump up the small ledges and hit the bat on the right. Follow the bats to the left and quickly jump up the ledges to the torch. Leap past the torch and open the stack of three crates. (You should jump from the circling ledges to open both bouncy crates. Or, jump and time your spin to take out the middle crate first.)

Now, you have to make a tough jump to the left, onto the circling ledge without hitting the torch below. Wait for it to go out before you try the jump and, if you miss, don't panic -- and don't stand on the torch!

Walk to the right until the red lizard sees you, then lead him to the left.



Pounce off the lizard and spin into the "!" block in the air

After you make the jump, keep going up the circling ledges until you reach the fifth checkpoint.

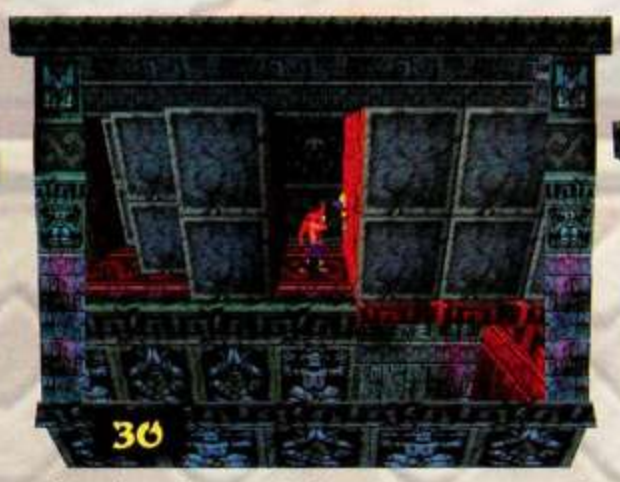
to fill in the crates in the background room. Run into the background and get the floating mask on the right, then go left and open the crates. One of them has the first Cortex token.

Return to the foreground and walk right to the three sliding walls. Wait for the pattern where all the walls come out, then the left wall slides back,

then the right two slide back. Don't fall for the other pattern, where the left wall slides back, then shoots out again. Hit the ceiling bat on the other side of the walls.

Jump down to the pillar and wait for the bats, then jump across the torch and stone platform to the next pillar. Wait for mo' bats, then jump right and whack the second bat.

Now, take a deep breath as you prepare to run past FOUR sliding walls.



There's a tiny gap before the next group of sliding walls. Take a quick pause in the gap, then sprint to the right across the thin ledges, which collapse behind you.

When you reach the other side, bounce off the two crates to grab the extra life and second Cortex token floating above the sliding walls. (Wait for the walls on the left to slide out before you bounce up the crates.)

Leap to the right and smash the mask and extra life crates, then tag the sixth checkpoint.

The second Tawna token is in the "?" crate just past the checkpoint.

Jump right again to an area with a giant sliding wall and two thin ledges below it. Wait for the large wall to slide back and the thin ledge to slide forward, then run to the right and jump before the big wall returns. Run into the background and open the three crates (one has an extra life.)

Return to the foreground and jump from the thin ledge to one of the circling ledges.

Jump right onto the second group of circlers, then jump into the background tunnel and take the extra life.

Ooh, but there's more; run to the left and open the crate with the third Cortex token!

This bonus round is short and evil, because it's loaded with TNT crates. One wrong move and you lose the round -- which means you need to play through the level all over again to collect the Cortex tokens for another try. Here's how you do it: from the start, jump to the right, onto the metallic crates, then jump right again onto the TNT crate.

Move to the far right, until you stop bouncing, then jump and smash the crate,

so you can jump onto the stack and across to the next batch of TNT. This time, the stack of plain crates on the right is higher, so you quickly need to jump and smash until you can jump to safety.

A final jump to the right and you're rewarded with one of the game's two keys! Good work, my friend!

Play through the round and save the game, even though you just saved it when you got the key. (Rule #1 of video games: you can never save too much.)

Jump down and right to the next ledge and jump across the torch, then go right to get the third Tawna token. We like bonus rounds!

Jump up the sliding ledges until you hit the seventh and final checkpoint. (It really is the last one, I swear.)

Jump up a second group of sliding ledges -- which move faster, so be quicker with your jumps -- to a stack of three crates, two of them bouncy crates. Pop 'em open by jumping on them from the ledge to the right.

Move right 'til you spot a red lizard on the small ledges. Lead him to the left as far as you can, then pounce on him.

Go to the right and open the eight crates in the background room (several of which have tasty extra lives)

before you leap onto the end-of-level pedestal and, with your no-doubt-about-it, slick, "perfect" round, you are awarded yet another clear gem. With the key you snagged, you can now access the secret level "Whole Hog," next to Boulder Dash. But we won't tell you 'bout that just yet; look at the "Secrets" section for a walk-through.

Koala Kong
Boss

Koala Kong is one buff dude, and all of that working out has left him looking like Ahhrnold, with a temper as nasty as his pec's are protruding.

After giving you a quick look at his derriere, thankfully, unlike his partner in crime, Papu Papu, covered south of the equator.

KK starts heaving HUGE chunks of coal in your direction.

He will throw three of them at you, before really struggling to pickup and walk with the fourth.

The trick here is to execute well-timed jumps over the first three, at the same time avoiding the TNT crates.

(Or, if you have a cheating heart, it's also possible to break the first three coal chunks with a well-timed spin -- just before they hit you.)

The fourth coal ball will come to rest, after jumping to avoid it.

Walk into the screen, toward the coal and use your spin attack to send it hurling toward the Kongster.

Timing is essential here, as a miss-timed shot will hit one of the passing mine carts, resulting in no damage to the big guy!

After the first hit, Koala repeats the same pattern, so giving him his second coal-a-gram is a piece of cake.

Hitting him a third time becomes a little more difficult, as more TNT crates come your way, as well as more mine carts in the background.

The fourth and final blow is no more difficult than the second or third, but it does require better timing on your part. Focus on delivering this one like Santa to a baaaad boy -- give him the high, hard one, right down the middle between the two mine carts.

Now, you can chuckle quietly to yourself, as Koala Kong drops to his, admittedly huge, knees... and Cortex hears you rap, rap, rappin' on his door -- as you set off for Island #3!

Island 3

The last of the three islands finds us inching ever closer to Cortex's lair, and that much closer to bringing an end to his plan for world domination. Most of the colored gems are found on Island #3, as well as three boss characters; Pinstripe Potoroo, N. Brio and Cortex himself. Also featured are the second Cortex Key and hidden level, and the branch level allowing access to the "perfect" ending. Getting through the third island "perfect" is very, very tough, with Jaws of Darkness and Slippery Climb standing out as the most difficult levels. Beat Island #3 and prepare yourself for a few trips back to all of those levels on islands 1-2 that you couldn't "perfect."

Heavy Machinery

Checkpoints: 1
Bonus Rounds: Tawna, N. Brio
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

Jump to the right to meet your very first "enemy": a flying camera that bobs up and down while constantly pointing at you. (Hey, when you're as beautiful as Crash, you're used to it.) You can't jump on the camera, but you can spin into it.

Go to the right, past two more cameras, to meet the next new bad guy: a short, squat, three-wheeled robot. You can jump on, or spin, into the three-wheelers.

Jump over the red pipe and bounce off the arrow crate to grab the floating mask. (Smash the arrow crate before you continue.)

Continue to the right and you bump into an ice-cold blue pipe.

It won't hurt you if you stand on it or touch it. But the next pipe, the scorching hot red pipe, WILL hurt you if you so much as graze against it.

There's yet another new baddie just to your right: a spherical spiky robot that hovers in the air. You can't bounce into OR spin into these robots; you can only avoid them.

Jump over the spiky robot when it dips downward and go right to a stack of three crates. Smash the middle crate with a jumping spin

and jump to the right before the TNT crate goes boom. Open the "?" crate for the first Tawna token.

Continue to the right, until you reach a pit with two spiky robots floating inside it.

That's a wee bit suspicious, ain't it? Jump high and fall BETWEEN the spiky robots onto a hidden ledge.

Walk to the left and pop open three crates with a mask, the first N. Brio token, and an extra life.

Continue walking left, onto the circular ledge and it carries you back up.

Go to the right and jump over the pit with the robots. Keep going until you reach a "?" crate with the second N. Brio token.

Make a couple of big jumps to the right and you reach a conveyor belt that slowly rolls to the right. Break open the bouncy and arrow crates, then ride the belt to the right and smash open the second bouncy/arrow crate combo.

Go to the right and the second belt. Spin to hit the flying camera as you land. This time, the belts carry you over pipes with enemies between them.

Go slowly and jump one pipe at a time. Jump onto the circular ledge at the end of the belts and grab the floating extra life as you float down to the next area.

Run left and jump over the two spiky robots to another conveyor. This one has a spiky robot in the middle, with red pipes on either side; jump the first pipe when the robot is moving up, then leap the second pipe before he comes back down.

Jump across three floating ledges and open the "?" crate for the second Tawna token. Continue left to the first checkpoint.

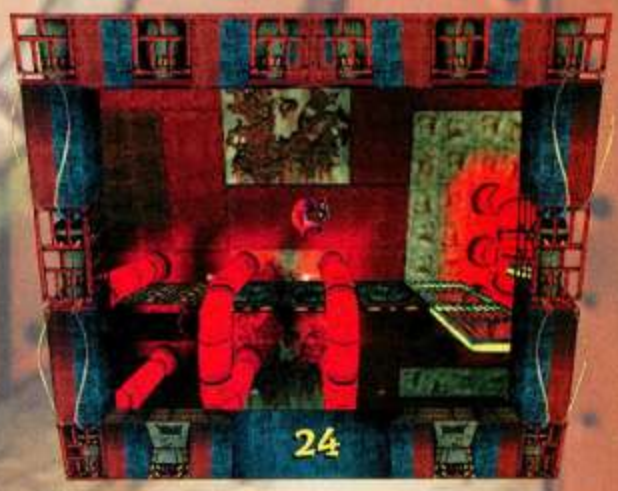
To the left of the checkpoint is a steaming pipe in the ledge.

You can stand on a steam pipe as long as it's not billowing steam. (Might seem obvious, but we always like to make sure we mention these things.)

Go left past three steam pipes, and then a single pipe, to find an extra life crate. Walk onto the circular ledge and it carries you across to a "?" crate with the third Tawna token.

This bonus round is simple crate-smashing. At the section in the middle, with the stack of three crates, make sure you don't get so "deep" that you can't keep bouncing to the right.

Bounce all the way to the right and save the game.



Walk down the stairs to the left and leap the red pipes over the conveyor belt. There's a steam pipe just before the circular ledge at the end of the belt. Let the ledge carry you down to the next area.

Go to the right and pounce on the three-wheeler. Walk down the stairs and bounce off the three-wheeler to get the mask crate in the air.

Ride down the circular ledge and walk right across two floating ledges. Walk onto the red ledge

and you're catapulted upward into a huge stack of crates. Smash all of them; there's a mask crate at the top.

Walk to the right, across two more floating ledges, and jump over the pipes and belts. There's a final group of five steam pipes just before the circular ledge.

Ride up to the next ledge, which floats to the right, between two blue and two red pipes. Leap the pipes and ride across another floating ledge to the far right.

There are two circular ledges and a "?" crate on the right side. Open the "?" crate for the third N. Brio token.

This bonus round is delightfully easy; just bounce to the right, across the rows of crates and hit the "!" crates along the way. (Be sure to hold the jump button for maximum height.)

They lead to the right, then back to the left, and back to the right again, with a hefty stack of extra life crates at the end. (Ignore the runaway mine carts in the background -- they are there just to mess you up.)

Back in the level, jump to the lower circular ledge and let it carry you downward.

Run to the right and bounce up the red ledges; break the extra life crate on the left as you move upward.

There are three more extra life crates in the air just below the end-of-level pedestal.

You should be able to notch a "Perfect" on this level in three or four tries at the most. No lie.

Cortex Power

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Blue

Walk into the building and pounce on the three-wheeler robots.

Leap over the red and the blue electric pillars. These pillars are like the pipes in the previous level: you can touch the blue, but you can't touch the red.

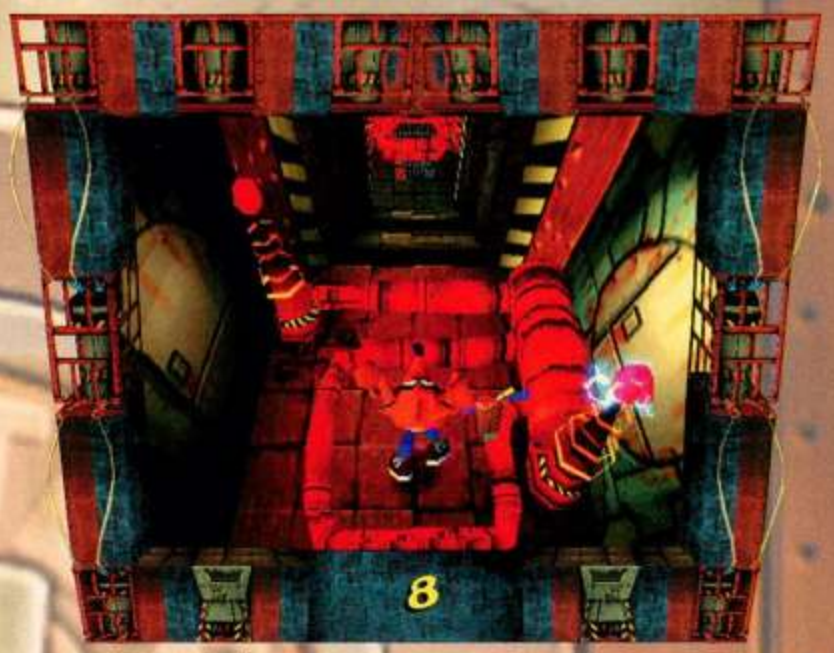
And you CAN be zapped by the electric beam that shoots between the pillars about every four seconds.

Walk through the door, leap the red and blue pillars, and jump onto the three-wheeler. (Don't spin into it or you destroy the bouncy crate.)

Open the mask and bouncy crates, then jump over the blue pillar. You can go left or right from here;

take the right path and open the extra life crate, then make several jumps over the green slime.

Leap the red and blue pillars, then jump the slime and hit the first checkpoint.



There's a red cable on the floor above the first checkpoint; jump into the middle of it, then jump through the pillars.

Walk down the hill and jump through a second pillar where you have to land in the middle. Jump past it and open the mask crate.

You're at another left/right branch;

go to the right and up the stairs, to a long room with a psychotic gangster shooting at you with his tommy gun.

Hide behind the left wall and wait for Psycho Boy to laugh, then run behind the right wall and let him shoot again.

Spin into him while he's chuckling. Hit the "!" block, then smash the extra life and regular crates on the left. Climb back down the stairs while the TNT crates blow up behind you. Now, go down the left branch.

Jump through the two spiky robots when they both move toward the walls of the tunnel, steering around either side.

Leap the slime and smash the two extra life crates on either side of the blue pipe. Go up and hit the second checkpoint.

Jump up past the first spiky robot and ride the moving platform to a second robot, and a tricky jump; wait 'til it moves to the right, then jump and steer around it as the platform you're standing on moves up and down.

You land on a sinking ledge, so quickly jump up again and go through the door.

Dispose of the three-wheeler and run past the two short shockers on the floor. Open the extra life crate and run past another three short shockers.

Make a diagonal jump over the red pipe next to the slime pit, then jump over the two red pipes.

They're close together, but you can pause in the gap between them.

Keep going upward and break the bouncy/arrow crate combo. Walk through the door to find a long bridge of crates.

If you didn't hit the "!" block earlier, there are only two crates in the middle of the slime. Bounce across the crates one at a time -- just like you did way back in N.Sanity Beach -- and go through the door to the end-of-level pedestal.

Break open the four bouncy crates in the corners of the room

before you jump onto the pedestal to finish. You won't score a "Perfect" because you don't have the blue gem, but you'll score it just two levels from now, so turn that frown upside-down.

Generator Room

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Orange
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

You start next to a stack of three crates, with a bouncy crate at the bottom. Bust 'em all and start moving forward.

The next stack of crates has a "?" crate in the middle and TNT at the bottom; break the "?" and jump forward across the ledges as the TNT explodes. (Spin to strike the cameras circling the ledges.)

At the stack of four crates, break the crate above the arrow, then jump over the arrow as the TNT bounces.

Jump onto the floating ledge and jump again, hitting the camera with a spin. Make a third jump to the floating ledge and walk up to the "!" block.

Smack it and watch the bridge in the upper-right corner of the screen fill up with crates. Walk back onto the floating ledge and jump to the right.

Open the "?" crate for the first Tawna token and jump upward twice to the bridge.

Walk to the right and onto a huge floating ledge with five crates on it; two of them contain extra lives.

Open all the crates and pick up the fruit, but get back onto the bridge before the ledge falls. (It shakes just a bit before plunging off the screen.)

Break the crates in the bridge as you move back to the left. Jump upward twice, pickup a free life, and hit the first checkpoint.

Jump left twice and open the "?" crate for the second Tawna token. Make three more tough jumps to the left, using your spin to hit the cameras.

Face upward and jump onto the ledge moving up and down; jump when it's low, then jump to the second ledge and spin as you land to hit the camera.

Make two more jumps across two more up/down ledges. Open the "?" crate for the third Tawna token. Bonus time, baby!

By this point, your jumping skills are such that this should be the easiest bonus round yet. Just bounce to the right, smashing each crate as you go.

A few of the crates have extra lives. Save your game and admire your playing skills while the level reloads.

Walk to the right and get the mask out of the crate. Now, you have to make five tough jumps to the right: first, a series of four up/down ledges, then a floating ledge. There are spiky robots between the third and fourth up/down ledges to make your jumps just a bit harder.

Make it all the way across and smack open the stack of four crates, with a bouncy crate second from the top.

Walk down onto the circular ledge and it carries you downward. Jump to the solid ledge, then walk left onto the next circular ledge.

This one carries you to a ledge being circled by two cameras.

Hit them with your spin and walk left onto the next circular ledge. This one goes slightly down and left. Now, jump left onto the up/down ledge, then upward to the second checkpoint.

Jump across the gap (being patrolled by a spiky robot) and break through the wall of crates.

Jump across the floating ledge with spiky robots in front of and behind it, which is a tricky task; you'll probably take a hit.

Now, jump right up the staircase of floating ledges to the circular ledge at the top. It floats to the right.

Walk off the ledge, up to the stack of three crates, hit the middle crate, and jump down and right as the TNT blows up real good. Walk down the ramp, while watching out for the cameras, and take the fruit at the bottom, then jump left onto the circular ledge.

The ledge carries you to the left. Jump over the red pipe and land back on the ledge -- not easy.

Walk up onto the next ledge. Now, you have to jump over blue pipes twice,

then jump on a flat ledge — to a circular ledge.

Stay on the circular ledge as it takes you to the exit door. Open the three extra life crates,

go through the door, and stomp on that pedestal.

If you played flawlessly, you're rewarded with an orange gem; this lets you score "Perfect" on the Upstream level.

Toxic Waste

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Blue
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

There are two arrow/bouncy crate combos at the start.

Smash them both and then worry about the barrel-rolling gangster in front of you.

Let him throw a barrel, then leap over it and spin into him.

Jump onto the ramp and take the mask at the top. (The mask is originally in a crate, but when you hit the gangster, you smash the crate open.)

Climb up the next ramp, jumping the barrels along the way. (You might find it easier to jump straight up over a barrel instead of running forward as you jump.)

At the top are two stacks of three crates. The stack on the left has two extra lives, and the "?" crate on the right has the first Tawna token.

Climb the next ramp and hit the gangster at the top.

Climb the next ramp and hit the first checkpoint.

There's an arrow/bouncy crate combo just after the first checkpoint. Crack them both and climb the next ramp.

There are an extra life and the second Tawna token in the two "?" crates at the top.

Climb the next ramp and spin into the gangster.

Climb the next ramp and open the extra life crate.

Start up the next ramp and you'll see (and hear) a bouncing barrel headed at you. (The pattern is two regular barrels, one bouncing barrel, two regular barrels, etc.)

The barrels always bounce in the same places on the screen, so stand in the "safe" spots and let them fly over your head.

At the top of the ramp are two crates, one of them TNT; trigger it and climb the next ramp. (Watch out for the small gap at the bottom of the ramp.) Spin into the gangster at the top, but wait for him to throw a bouncing barrel

before you attack.

Climb the next ramp and hit the second checkpoint. Open the bouncy crate and climb the next ramp.

Now, the only barrels coming your way are bouncing, so your placement on the screen is crucial.

At the top of the ramp is a stack of five crates,

with an extra life sandwiched between TNT; hit the life and then hit the "?" crate just ahead for the third Tawna token.

Note: A helpful hint here is to simply avoid the bouncing barrels completely -- by jumping and landing next to the five crates, breaking them, and then make a mid-air move to land on the third Tawna token.

There's plenty of TNT in this bonus round, so open the crates and get over to the right before it blows you up.

Open the two extra life crates and save the game.

Climb up the final ramp. Stop at each small ledge along the way to let the barrels bounce over you,

then make a final crazy dash to spin into the gangster. The end-of-level pedestal is just behind him.

If you completed this level without losing a life, you get the blue gem, which is crucial for scoring "Perfect" on several other levels.

Pinstripe Potoroo Boss

Pinstripe Potoroo is a crazed weasel

with a big gun,

and he knows how to use it.

Stay in the far left or far right corner, opposite him, behind the chair, as he shoots,

then jump and bounce off his head as he moves toward your corner.

Until you score three hits on him, that's his "pattern": he shoots on one side of the room, runs to the other side, and shoots again. He always fires in your direction, but if you stay behind the chairs in the lower-left or lower-right corners, he won't hit you.

It's when you start running as he's shooting that he can nail you.

After taking three hits, Pinstripe starts jumping onto the table in the middle of the room and starts shooting.

After taking to the floor for a second volley of shots, Pinstripe's gun jams, and he struggles with the gun for a few seconds to get it working again.

Jump and hit him in the head while he's doing this.

Don't jump too late or you'll be hit by the stray bullets that Pinstripe fires as he's un-jamming the gun.

After five hits, Pinstripe's gun jams only when he's standing on the table, not on the sides of the room, so you have to jump and hit him there.

After taking six hits, Pinstripe shoots and breaks the windows, then he croaks.

The High Road

Checkpoints: 4
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

Take the floating extra lives and walk downward. See the fruit dangling in mid-air?

Walk toward it and two planks appear under your feet.

Now make a huge downward jump from the lower plank to land on another two hidden planks.

Keep jumping down onto a third and fourth group of hidden planks; the fourth group is connected to a ledge with four "?" crates. Two of them are extra lives. Return to the starting point and start heading across the bridge.

Jump upward across the bridge,

watching out for the warthog

and the slippery ice planks.

You reach a wall of crates;

break the crate and jump over the arrow crate when the steel crate is bouncing into the air.

Past the wall is a series of four turtles that you have to use to keep jumping ahead. Bounce on each turtle to make it pull into its shell, then jump high off the shell and ahead to the next turtle.

After the fourth turtle -- which is cruelly placed on a dark plank

-- is the first checkpoint and the first Tawna token.

There are more turtles (and a single turtle shell) between the first and second checkpoints, several of 'em on dark, or broken, planks.

If you don't have a solid jumping technique by now, you ain't never going to beat this level. Remember the basics: watch for your shadow, and start flying ahead to the next turtle the moment you bounce off the shell.

The second Tawna token is in a "?" crate next to the second checkpoint.

Between the second and third checkpoints is a single turtle and two cute li'l warthogs ...

right at checkpoint #3. No prob, Bob. No sweat, Chet. No hassle, uh, Rassell. (we think we'll stop now.)

The jumps between the third and fourth checkpoints are mostly across dark planks,

with a single shell about halfway through.

After you reach the fourth checkpoint,

hit the "?" crate in the stack of three crates,

then jump on the metal crate and jump straight into the air to smash a "?" crate off the top of the screen. There's an extra life inside.

After a series of tough shell jumps,

you will find the third Tawna token.

In the bonus round, hop along the bottom crates until you reach the arrow crate on the right, which shoots you upward to the higher crates.

Save your game and check out your sky-rocketing completion percentage.

There's a final brutal series of shell jumps between you and the end-of-level pedestal.

Make it to the end without dying and you'll earn a "Perfect." If you missed a single crate, it was probably the one hidden above the TNT checkpoint (Shot 22); that's the one WE kept missing (and missing, and missing.)

Slippery Climb

Checkpoints: 1
Bonus Round: N. Brio
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Red
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

Run into the background doors and open the crates,

then go to the left and climb up the brown stairs. These stairs pop in and out of the ledge every few seconds; if you're on the stairs when they close, you slide off them. Not a problem here, but a large problem later in the level, when you'll fall to your doom if you slide.

Jump left onto the moving ledge, but don't jump left to the next ledge until your ledge is at the far left and the next ledge is just starting to move right. It's tricky timing that'll probably take you a few lives to get used to.

On the second ledge, jump into the background door and smash the two crates, (with an extra life) then walk into the foreground and drop onto the ledge, when it's below the door.

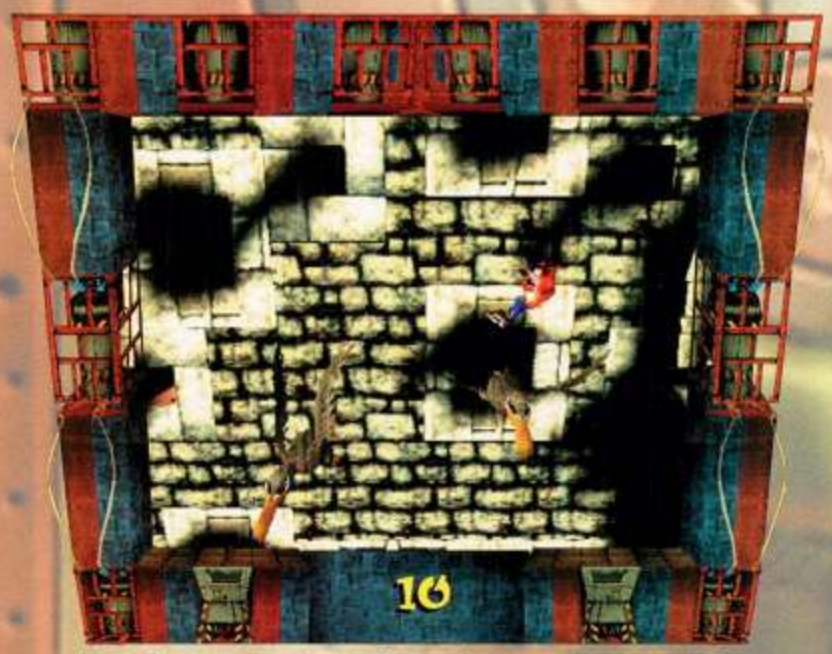
Jump left across two more moving ledges to a small ledge with a jailed creature trying to grab you with its arm. Spin into the arm to knock it away. Jump left across two sliding ledges and enter the background door for two crates.

Now, go left and jump over to the circling ledges. On the left is a giant bird that slowly flies up and down. Jump off the bird (which croaks when you bounce off it) to the circling ledges. The higher the bird is when you hit it, the higher your jump.

Jump left across a second bird to more circlers. When the ledge you're on reaches the top of the screen, jump straight up and steer yourself into the background door.

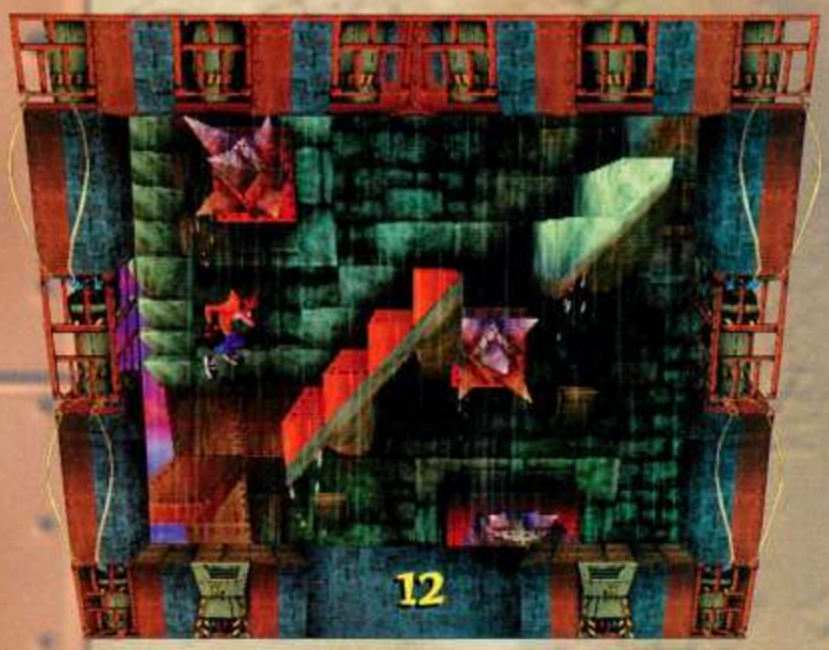
Break the two crates and then walk out of the door when a ledge is below and just to the left.

Bounce left across a bird and break the two crates inside the door; one of them has the first N. Brio token.



Jump left across three sliding ledges, then spin into the two prisoners' arms. Bounce left on the bird and break the two door crates, then bounce left across two birds and open two more door crates. (The lower crate is bouncy.)

Wait for the stairs on the left to pop open, then climb up them to the ledge.



It carries you up to a second set of stairs; wait for the stairs to open before you jump across them.

Climb up and right and break the two crates. Jump left from the sliding ledge to the bird to the ledge moving up and down, while watching out for the spikes below; a tough little series of jumps.

Jump to the solid ledge at the top, then go up and right when the sliding ledge comes out *AND* the stairs pop out.

Quickly jump up a series of five sliding ledges, then ride up the next ledge and go left. Pop open the bouncy crate, then climb up and hit the first checkpoint. Not at all easy!

Jump onto the up/down ledge, then jump across to the circling ledges connected by a log. These ledges have a strange movement pattern; the key is to watch the pattern and know where the ledges are going to move BEFORE you jump.

Climb up two more ledges to an up/down ledge, then quickly go to the right (up the stairs) and spin into the scientist lobbing explosive flasks above your head.

Wait for the stairs to open, then go right onto the next circling ledges.

Next, bounce off the bird and land on the solid ledge. Keep going to the right, bouncing from the bird to the circling ledges -- until you reach the door with two crates. (The second N. Brio token is in one of the crates and a free life is in the other.)

Keep going to the right (we're close to the end, we promise) and spin through the three arm-grabbers.

Jump across two birds and break the crates in the door; one of them is a mask, and the other is the third N. Brio token.

This tough bonus round has you bouncing off arrow crates and avoiding the TNT crates above them, hitting extra life crates as you bound to the right. There are easier ways to get extra lives, sure, but that's missing the point -- this bonus round is a test of your playing abilities, a way to show off your ever-increasing skills. (Unless you die right away, in which case you suck.)

From here, keep jumping to the right across the ledges and birds, smashing crates inside doors as you go. When you reach a group of three birds, you're almost finished.

There's a flask-throwing scientist guarding the end-of-level pedestal.

Spin into him, then open the four extra life crates and finish the level.

If you scored a "Perfect," you also scored the red gem; head back to the Native Fortress for a clear gem.

Lights Out

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Purple
Gem Needed for Perfect: Yellow

It's dark and spooky in this level -- how the heck are you going to make it through if you can't see anything?!

Get a grip on yourself and pop open the mask crate; suddenly, your path is lit up by the floating mask. Neat!

There is, of course, a catch -- actually, two. The first catch is that the mask's light starts to fade after a while, so you have to find another mask crate before you're left fumbling in the dark.

The second catch is that, if you're hit by an enemy, you lose the mask, which means you can't see, which further means you're in deep caca. Now then. With the glowing mask shining brightly behind you, start moving forward, making the jumps across the platforms.

Don't waste time on each jump, since your mask is constantly growing weaker; keep running and jumping. Pretend you're playing one of the levels with a boulder behind you -- that oughta speed you up. After a series of jumps, you'll find the next mask crate.

In the next series of jumps, you have to leap across green floating ledges that fall a few seconds after you land on them.

Marvelous. Keep running and jumping forward to the next mask crate and the first checkpoint.

In the next series of jumps, you have to leap across brown floating ledges that move back and forth. Mis-time a jump and you'll miss the brown ledge and fall. Most uncool.

Continue ahead to the next mask crate, with an extra life crate next to it.

The next series of jumps has both green AND brown ledges, just because level designers love to throw new challenges your way. Hey, it's their job. Jump ahead to the mask crate with an extra life crate next to it.

The next series of jumps throws a new enemy at you: several red-eyed rats that crawl in groups along the ledges. (They look kinda like the skunks back on Island #1.)

You can spin into them

or bounce on them -- your choice.

Keep going ahead to the next mask crate and the second checkpoint.

More rats and more tough jumps lie ahead; forge ahead to the next mask crate (with an extra life crate next to it).

Jump ahead, but stop just before the strip of bricks on the ground.

A huge blade swings back and forth above the strip, and--big surprise -- it'll hurt you if it hits you.

Keep going ahead past a second blade (above the pit), then a group of two blades. Grab the floating mask to light up your life.

Continue ahead to jump past more blades and rats.

There's one very tricky jump with a green ledge between two blades

-- stand on the ledge just long enough for the blade in front of you to move, then quickly jump before you fall.

You might run out of light just before the end-of-level pedestal, which has THREE blades in front of it, with green ledges between them. Don't panic; just take each jump carefully. Assuming you have the yellow gem in your possession (doubtful, since you have to get it in The Lab, the next-to-last level in the game), you can earn a "Perfect" here and you're given the pink gem. Ain't it purty? Use it to clear the Boulder Dash level back on Island #1.

Jaws of Darkness

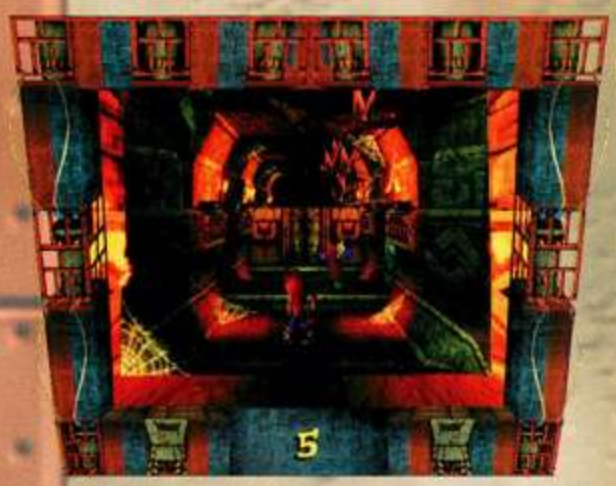
Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: Tawna, Cortex
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: Blue

Break the two crates (one is bouncy) and go right. Kill the snake in the hole and jump across two floating ledges.

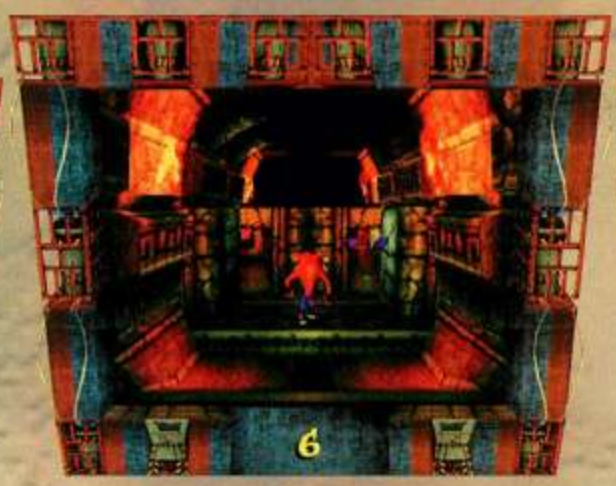
Kill the spider and jump across the pillars; some of them move up and down -- but you've handled that dozens of times before this level -- and one of them is a torch, something else you've dealt with.

Keep going right to reach a group of circling pillars. Jump upward from the pillars to a long row of crates; one of them has a mask.

Kill the snake in the hole and run past the spike pillars. Now you have to jump past a torch and a floating ledge to the tunnel entrance.



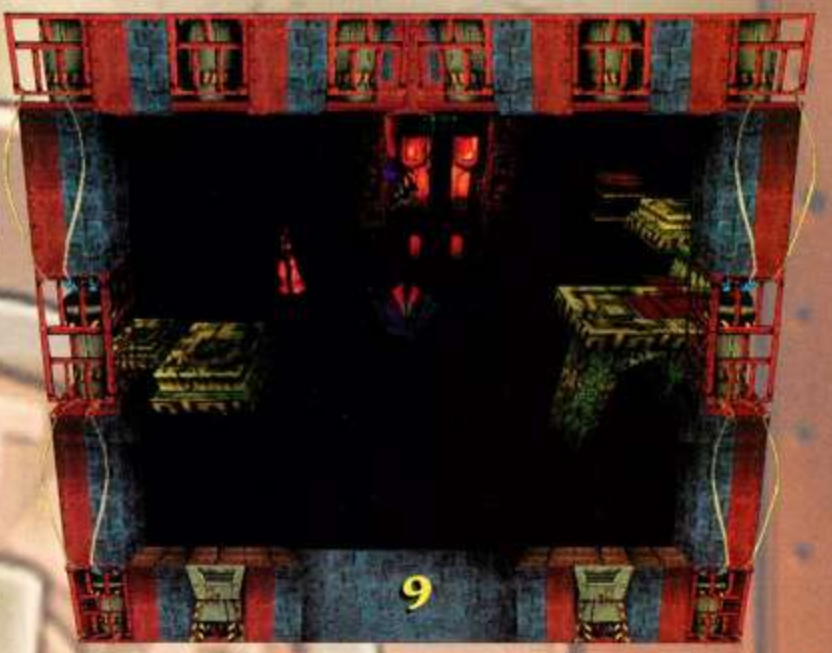
Open the extra life crate and start going through. Remember to watch out for the bats.



It's easy to get past the first crushing wall, but the group of two crushers is trickier. As soon as the first crusher slides open, start running forward so that you immediately run through the second crusher.

Now that you're through the tunnel, jump across two up/down pillars and let the two circular ledges carry you to a pillar.

Jump downward along the pillars while pausing so that you don't jump into the spikes. Then leap from the torch to a floating ledge to the first checkpoint. Hit the "?" crate in the stack of three crates for the first Cortex token.



Walk left and bounce off the spider to a floating ledge, then a stack of three crates. One of them is the first Tawna token.

Jump upward to a very quick-moving group of circling pillars. Jump up and left on the pillars, then kill the snake in the hole. At this point, if you already obtained the blue gem from Toxic Waste, refer to the "Secrets" section for access to the secret area of this level.

Jump left and open the crate, then jump up through the spike pillars. Bounce upward off the spider and run through the second group of spike pillars.

Jump up to the tunnel entrance and break open the bouncy crate before you move inside. (Don't start bouncing on the crate until the bats fly past you.) There are two pairs of crushing walls in the tunnel; get past them both and jump up to the second checkpoint.

Jump up two up/down pillars to a circular ledge that carries you upward. Run through the spike pillars, but don't spin into the snake above them; pounce him instead.

If you spin into him, you blow up the pile of crates on the next ledge, and with it the second Cortex token inside the "?" crate.

From the second token, jump left and up along the ledges until you reach one with a fruit to its left. Immediately walk to the left. Looks like you're going to walk into oblivion, but a ledge appears under your feet.

Keep walking left without stopping--because the ledges fall behind you--until you reach a ledge. Jump down past the spike pillars and open the crates. One of them has the third Cortex token.

This bonus round is simple as long as you don't panic. Bounce across the crates to the TNT crate. Land on it

and wait for it to count down to one, then jump across to the two "?" crates and bounce on them as the TNT explodes, which triggers the "!" block, which creates a bridge below you.

Land on the bridge and walk right.

Bounce across the crates and land on the second TNT crate.

This time, when the count reaches one, bounce off the crate to the right, then bounce back to the left and land on the "!" crate.

Now jump to the right along the crates and get the key from Cortex. You now have access to the second secret level, Fumbling In The Dark. Neat!

Jump down through the spike pillars, then walk to the right without stopping; another bridge of ledges appears beneath you.

From here, jump up and right along the platforms to the next group of crates.

Open the "?" crate with the second Tawna token and break the arrow/bouncy crate combo. Jump north along several up/down pillars to a "?" crate with the third Tawna token.

This bonus round has several stacks of crates with a TNT crate at the bottom and several regular crates above it.

The trick is to bust through the regular crates and jump to the right before the TNT goes off. Not tough at all. There are several extra life crates in the stacks. Get to the far right for two more extra life crates and save the game.

The final tunnel has two crushing walls, followed by three crushing walls. Get through the triple play and leap to the end-of-level pedestal. If you don't have the blue gem in tow, no clear gem for you ... try again later!

Castle Machinery

Checkpoints: 2
Bonus Round: None
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Clear
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

Walk to the right and drop down the hole.

Go left and jump past the three-wheelers, cameras, and blue pipes. Nothing you haven't seen before.

There are two spiky robots hovering next to the floating ledge; wait for the left robot to start moving up, then run to the left and jump across the ledges.

Climb the stairs and walk onto the circular ledge. It carries you straight up into the air.

Walk left onto the next ledge before you get smushed into the red pipe above you.

Walk left again onto a third circular ledge, then jump to the right when you reach the top, and open the mask crate.

Now you have to negotiate a series of conveyor belts. The first belt takes you to the right past a few pipes (blue and red);

then you fall down through smaller and smaller belts, with red pipes on both sides and flying cameras in your path.

Spin through them and work your way to the bottom, then walk right, and hit the first checkpoint.

Jump right onto the circular ledge, which zooms straight up. Walk right onto the next ledge before you touch the red pipes. Jump left to the next ledge, then jump right to the third ledge.

Jump up and left to the fourth ledge; if you wait to walk onto it, you'll still hit the red pipes.

Walk forward onto the fifth ledge,

which carries you up to a solid platform with extra life and mask crates.

Go left along the steam pipes,

then climb down the staircase of floating ledges. Fall to the left and to the next area.

Jump right over the red pipes, and bounce off the three-wheeler robot to clear the group of four pipes.

Walk onto the red ledge to shoot up and collect a bunch of fruit.

Continue on to the second red ledge, which shoots you up to six bouncy crates. (Hold the jump button as you soar off the red ledge to get enough height to reach the crates.)

Fall down to the right, and jump over the red ledge at the bottom so you aren't catapulted into the red pipes.

Walk right and climb the steps onto the four red ledges. They shoot you up to a floor on the right.

Walk to the right, and bounce over the three-wheelers;

continue to the right, and go down the stairs to the second checkpoint.

Get through the two conveyor belts with red pipes (and a single spiky robot). You end up in a spot with a huge row of crates to your right, and several extra life crates below them.

Here's the hard part: break the highest crates in the middle first,

then bounce back to the left, and start bouncing from left to right, breaking crates as you go. If you don't hit those high crates first, you won't be able to bounce all the way across without falling -- and you won't score a "Perfect" if you skip any crates.

Walk right onto the conveyor belt, and scoot past the two spiky robots, jumping to the right onto the circular ledge.

It carries you up to a small solid ledge. Wait for a large ledge to float down on your left. Jump on it, and spin into the flying cameras as you float upward.

At the top, go left, and jump over the red pipes. When you reach the steam pipes, go across them one at a time, waiting for the steam before hopping to the next pipe.

There are a few final obstacles: circular ledges that float under red pipes. Jump the pipes -- and bounce off the three-wheeler on one of them -- as you float to the left and to the end-of-level pedestal. Perfection! And, a clear gem to boot!

Nitrus Brio
Boss

His name is Dr. Nitrus Brio, and he has two screws in his head. Momma always said it wasn't a good idea to mess with someone that has screws in his head. Then again, Momma hasn't seen the bandicoot babe you're trying to rescue. Let's rock!

Here's the 411 on N. Brio. For starters, you can't try a direct attack: when you get close, he holds up the beakers in his hands,

and if you try to spin or jump into him, he smashes the beakers together, injuring you in the explosion.

Instead, at the start of the battle, run to the very bottom of the room. Brio starts out by throwing a single green beaker at you;

it smashes into the ground and spawns a green pool of slime.

The slime will bounce three times, then it will lie still -- wait for this to happen, jump on the slime and the ol' Brio-spank-ometer drops a notch.

Now, our friend N. throws a red beaker

directly at you; this one explodes when it hits the ground, so run and jump either left or right as he tosses it to dodge the blast.

Brio tosses two green beakers, which turn into two green blobs; bounce on them both. Then he throws three red beakers; avoid them, Grasshopper. Brio throws three green beakers; kill all three blobs.

This really annoys Brio, who lobs a whopping six red beakers at you. Keep moving from one side to the other, and jump in the opposite direction when you reach either side of the screen.

Tired of attacking you with his gelatinous minions (the big-word way of saying "green blobs"), Brio mixes his beakers and drinks the combined potion.

This turns him into a very large, very ugly, and very green monster.

Stay at the bottom of the screen, in the middle, and wait for a brick to fall from the ceiling. Jump on the brick,

then jump into Brio's head when he gets close. This hurts him and knocks him back.

Jump into his head three times and you're a winner. Momma said knock you OUT!

The Lab

Checkpoints: 1
Bonus Round: Tawna
Gem Awarded for Perfect: Yellow
Gem Needed for Perfect: None

This is the final "real" level in the game, and it's a doozy. Hit the "!" crate to open the door -- something you'll be doing a lot as you proceed.

Walk ahead, and hit the "!" crate to open the next door, but wait until the trap in the floor is open. This way, the trap closes as the door opens. The entire level is filled with timing "puzzles" like this one.

Hit the "?" crate for the first Tawna token and run past the electric pillars; they shoot three beams, pause, and shoot again. (Guess when you should run between them?)

Hit both the "!" crates at once to close the trap and open the door at the same time. (Stand near one of the crates, spin, and move toward the other crate to hit them both.)

Hit the "?" crate for the second Tawna token, hit the "!" crate to close the trap door, and run ahead. Jump over the gap and you land on a long ledge. A yellow blob appears at the end of the ledge; jump into the air, and land on the blob to squish it. Jump across the gap, hit the "!" crate, and jump through the door (and the electric pillars).

Now you're in a room with two piles of crates.

Open the first pile, which has a "!" crate inside it.

then open the second pile, which has a TNT crate, so you definitely shouldn't spin into it (doh!). When the TNT blows, hit the "!" crate, and run through the door.

Open the extra life crate, jump the gap, and hit the "?" crate for the third Tawna token.

The final bonus round in the game is one of the easiest.

Jump through it, and save your game.

Hit the "!" crate, and jump through the door. See the bespectacled scientist on the other side of the gap?

He has electric hands that crackle with energy every few seconds.

There are two ways to get past him. The first is to jump across the gap right after his hands crackle, and spin into him. This knocks him back a bit, and it takes him a moment to shake off the blow.

Wait for him to barely finish recovering, then spin into him a second time. Hit him a third time with your spin to knock him off the ledge and hear his pitiful scream.

Very satisfying, but difficult to do without getting shocked. An easier but wimpier technique is to jump AROUND the scientist, curving out to the left and then back to the right to land behind him. Jump too late, though, and he'll nuke ya anyway. If you DO get hit, just keep going forward and leave him behind, instead of trying to kill him. However you scoot past the dude, jump to the two "!" crates and hit them both, then run through the door.

Hit the "!" crate, and run across the closed trap door. A yellow blob appears in the next room;

hit the "!" crate as you walk forward, then jump and land on the yellow blob as you walk through the door.

Jump the gap, hit both "!" crates, and walk through the door. Jump the gap, spin into the flask-tossing scientist, and hit the first and only checkpoint.

Hit the "!" crate and jump through the door. Run across the trap door, hit the "!" crate--which is sometimes buried underneath TNT crates -- and go through the next door.

If the "!" crate does have TNT around it, you need to trigger one of the crates, then jump down and right or left onto the narrow ledge until it blows. Walk through the door, and take the extra life.

Hit the "!" crate to walk across the closed trap door and spin into (or jump around) the shocker scientist.

Jump over the gap, hit the two "!" crates, and go through the door. In the next room, there's a "!" crate in between several electric pillars, and a yellow blob at the opposite end of the room. Get to the "!" crate and bounce onto the blob; as long as you're next to the crate, no more blobs will attack. Hit the "!" and jump through the door. Open the extra life crates, hit the "!" crate, and run through the next door.

Run straight ahead, and wait for the trap door to close, then jump on it, and run ahead. Hit the "!" crate, and go through the final door.

All that's between you and the end-of-level pedestal are three TNT crates.

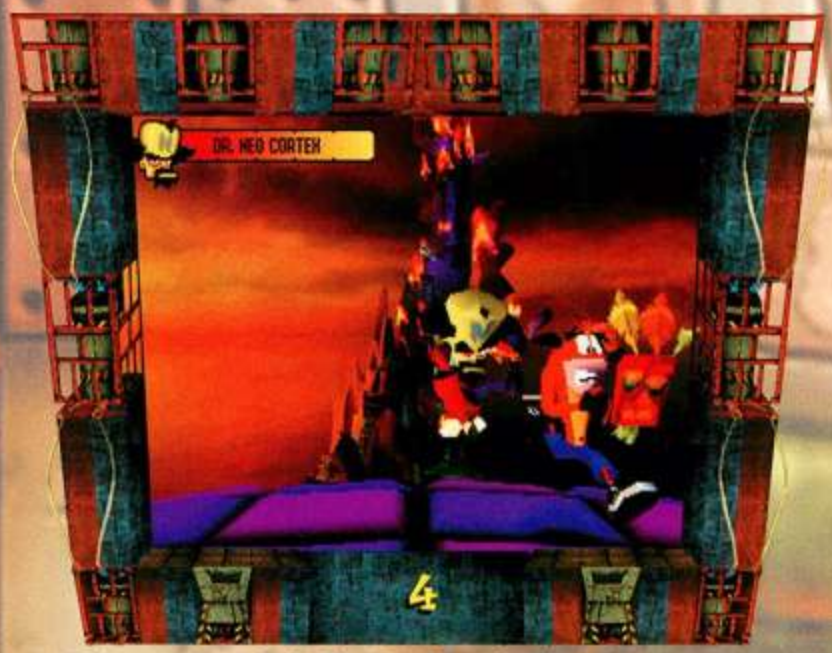
Bounce off the second TNT crate to the third TNT crate and up to the pedestal.

If you notched a "Perfect," you got the sixth and final colored gem -- this one's yellow. Now cruise to The Great Gate, and whack every crate. (I'm a bad poet, and I certainly know it.) Or, better still, move to Lights Out and snag that purple gem.

The Great Hall/ Dr. Neo Cortex Boss

To get the special ending, you have to jump across a huge chain of clear gems -- 26 in all -- to a door. Behind that door lies the special ending. But how do you reveal the clear gems? Check out the "Secrets" section in the back of this tome for the scoop.

The Great Hall doesn't even count as a level, really; it's just a branching path to the two endings. If you jump straight ahead onto the end-of-level pedestal, you'll move on to the final level and the final battle with Dr. Neo Cortex. Defeat him, and you get the regular ending.



Whoomp, here it is. The final battle. The big show down. Crash Bandicoot vs. Nutty Professor. You stand perched atop Cortex's blimp, while he flies through the sky and shoots energy bolts at you. Cortex has a different attack pattern every time you hit him, so we're going to walk you through each.

At the start of the level, when he hasn't taken any damage, Cortex fires at you with this pattern: two purple bolts, one green bolt, repeat.

Avoid the two purple bolts, and spin into the green bolt to shoot it right back at Cortex.

After taking his first hit, Cortex uses this pattern: one purple bolt, one blue bolt, one purple bolt, two blue bolts, two green bolts, repeat.

The blue bolts don't fly at you immediately; instead, they fly at you from the sides of the screen, either high or low.

You can simply walk under the high blue bolts, but you have to jump over the low blue bolts. When you hit the first green bolt, it doesn't strike Cortex immediately, but floats in the air above him.

When you hit a second green bolt, the two bolts combine and then smack into Cortex.

After taking his second hit, Cortex uses this pattern: one purple bolt, one low blue bolt, one high blue bolt, one purple bolt, one green bolt, one purple bolt, three zig-zag blue bolts, two green bolts, two purple bolts, repeat. The zig-zag bolts come at you from the sides of the screen, zig-zagging up and down, so you have to jump over them while they're low, or run under them while they're high.

You have to hit three green bolts before they form an energy ball strong enough to hit Cortex.

After taking his third hit, Cortex uses this pattern: five fast-moving purple bolts, one green bolt, repeat. You have to hit two green bolts to damage Cortex.

Hit a green bolt back into the crazy guy to knock him out of the sky and win the game. Your reward is a bear hug from Tawna

After taking his fourth hit, the nearly-dead Cortex foolishly starts firing nothing but green bolts in your direction.

and a long list of programmer credits. Cool, but not super-cool, you say? That's because you need to earn the game's special ending by playing until you find all 26 clear and colored gems. Check out the "Secrets" section at the back of this fine publication for all the de'ts.

Bonus Rounds

There are three types of bonus rounds in Crash Bandicoot: Tawna, N. Brio, and Cortex. To enter a bonus round, you have to collect three tokens during a level; each token looks like the puss of Tawna, N. Brio or Cortex, respectively.

1

A few levels have two bonus rounds, and a few levels have NO bonus rounds, but most of them have one. In each bonus round, you start on the left side,

2

and have to work your way to the right by bouncing along the crates in your path. Every type of crate in the game shows up in the bonus rounds: bouncy crates, arrow crates, TNT crates, you name it.

3

And, while you can move up and down during a bonus round, you shouldn't, because you'll fall to your death; just move left and right to stay on the crates. The Tawna bonus rounds are the easiest in the game, and the most plentiful -- you'll find Tawna tokens in roughly half of the game's levels.

4

Each Tawna round has at least two extra lives and, if you make it through the round without dying, you can save your game.

5

The N. Brio bonus rounds are more difficult than the Tawna rounds -- there are more TNT crates to deal with, and the jumps you need to make are more precise -- but the reward is more extra lives (up to six in some rounds). You don't get to save your game if you make it through without dying, though.

6

The Cortex bonus rounds -- and there are only two of them in the game -- are how you earn the game's two precious keys,

7

which unlock Crash Bandicoot's two hidden levels (see the "Hidden Levels" section for more info).

The Cortex bonus rounds are the most difficult in the game, but obviously worth the effort. If you don't get the keys, you can't open up the hidden levels, you can't earn two clear gems, and you can't get the special ending. One last note about the bonus rounds: you do NOT need to destroy all the crates in a bonus round to score a "Perfect" in a particular level. You have to destroy all the crates in the level itself, but NOT the bonus round. This game is tough, but not THAT tough!

Secrets: Gems

1

There are two types of secret items in Crash Bandicoot: gems and keys. There are 26 gems in the game, one for each and every non-boss level. To earn a gem for a level, you have to score a "Perfect" in that level. And how do you score a "Perfect"? By playing through the level from start to finish WITHOUT dying once, and by smashing ALL of the crates in the level (not including crates in bonus rounds).

2

If you play through a level without dying, but don't smash all the crates, you score a "Great" ranking;

3

then the game tells you exactly how many crates you missed, as each one smashes down upon poor Crash's noggin.

4

Most of the gems you obtain are clear gems, but six of them are colored gems: green, orange, blue, red, purple, and yellow. (A blatant rip-off of the colors in Lucky Charms cereal, but I digress.) Why are there colored gems? Because in several of the levels, there are special colored ledges that don't appear unless you have the matching colored gem.

5

A fine example is in Jungle Rollers, the second level in the game. As you approach the first checkpoint crate, you see a small green ledge floating nearby, but it disappears as you get closer.

6

When you return to this level after collecting the green gem, the small green ledge is now a huge green ledge that carries you upward to three otherwise unreachable crates -- which means you can now score a "Perfect" in the level.

7

In other words, as you collect colored gems, you have to revisit earlier levels to obtain "Perfect" scores and earn clear gems.

8

Now then. Wha'sup with the clear gems? They come into play during one of the final levels, The Great Hall. For every clear gem you collect in the game, a clear ledge appears in The Great Hall; if you get all 26 clear gems, you can make your way to a large red door, behind which is Crash Bandicoot's super-de-duper special ending sequence!

Okay, now that you understand the crazy gem thing, let's talk strategy. What follows are mini-walk-throughs for the hidden areas in levels where you need a colored gem to score a "Perfect." Refer to both this section and the regular walk-through(s) found in the specific island/level strategies.

Jungle Rollers
Green Gem

GEM(S) NEEDED TO ACHIEVE "PERFECT" LEVEL(S)

Green	Jungle Rollers, Castle Machinery
Orange	Upstream
Blue	Rolling Stones, Cortex Power, Jaws Of Darkness
Red	Native Fortress, Road To Nowhere
Purple	Boulder Dash
Yellow	The Great Gate, Lights Out

Play through the level until you reach the first checkpoint.

Jump on the large green gem

and let it carry you up to an arrow crate.

Bounce off the arrow crate and jump off the smaller green gems

to smash the three extra life crates in the air.

Finish the level to earn a "Perfect."

The Great Gate
Yellow Gem

1

Play through the level to the end-of-level pedestal and jump over the yellow gems to the left.

2

Walk to the far left and climb up the ledges, then bounce up the arrow crates. Crack the crate on the right as you bounce upward.

3

When you reach the wooden ledge at the top, go to the right -- until you reach a snapping flower next to an arrow crate.

5

Jump back into the foreground and smash the arrow crate, then continue to the right until you reach two crates. Smash the regular crate on the left and jump from the arrow crate to behind the fence.

6

Walk to the right, snagging fruit, until you hit an obstacle; do a spin to break the unseen extra life crate and keep going right for a few more fruit. Now, return all the way back to the left, jump back to the foreground, and break the arrow crate.

4

Pounce on the flower, then jump off the arrow crate and steer BEHIND the background fence to grab an extra life.

7

Bounce to the right, off the torch, and pounce on the native with a spin jump from above.

16

Break the crates on the right

8

Keep walking to the right, bouncing across torches and pouncing on natives,

9

until you reach the far right side of the level.

11

as you jump up to the end-of-level pedestal. Perfect!

Upstream Orange Gem

1

Play through the level until just before the second checkpoint crate, on the mossy hill.

4

There's an extra life crate in the middle of the row, obscured by the hill.

6

Jump right onto the orange gem

2

Walk left onto the orange gem,

3

then up, until you reach a long, horizontal, row of gems under the hill.

5

Continue through the level to the end-of-level pedestal.

7

and it carries you upward to a new area. Jump onto the second orange gem, then ride the leaves and jump across the green and blue flowers

8

to a second end-of-level pedestal.

9

Smash the crates along the way to make sure you earn a "Perfect."

Rolling Stones
Blue Gem

Play through the level until you reach a pit with a blue gem inside it.

Jump onto the ledge and it carries you down into a secret chamber.

Walk forward and open the half-dozen crates (three are extra lives).

Return down and ride back up to the main level.

Finish the level and you're perfect, baby.

Native Fortress
Red Gem

1

Play through the level, until you reach a red gem next to a torch.

2

Jump on the gem, and ride it upward.

3

Jump up the next few red gems to an arrow crate.

4

Now, bounce upward along several arrow crates, until you spot an extra life crate atop a fluffy cloud.

5

Crack the crate, and then jump to the right along the cloud "ledges,"

6

breaking two more crates as you go.

7

You'll reach an extra life crate on the far right side of the screen;

8

bounce off it, and steer back to the left to land on the cloud, instead of falling and dying.

9

Continue upward, and bounce off the arrow crate to destroy a huge stack of crates; there's an extra life in the highest crate.

10

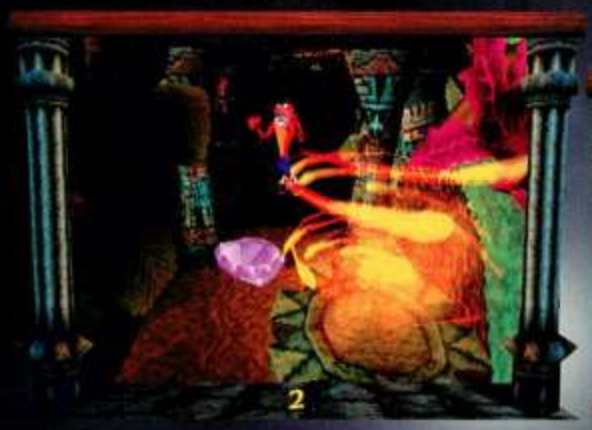
Now, return left and down to where you hopped on the first red gem.

11

Finish the level, and enjoy your hard-earned "Perfect."

Boulder Dash
Purple Gem

Play through the level until you reach the end-of-level pedestal.



Leap on the purple gem,

and it carries you down into an extremely cool underground chamber

with a wild color scheme that makes it look like it's lit up with black lights.

Walk forward, and jump over the gap,

then bounce off the two arrow crates for two extra life crates.

Jump the next gap and JUMP into the two flowers -- DO NOT SPIN!

You run the risk of destroying the arrow crate and you won't be able to access the crate above.

Then, smash all the crates, including the six extra life crates.

Jump onto the end-of-level pedestal for your sweet "Perfect."

Road to Nowhere
Red Gem

1

Play through the level until you reach a large red gem, next to the third checkpoint.

2

Jump on the gem and it carries you to the right.

3

Jump across to the right,

4

until you reach a ledge with TNT and "!" crates.

5

Walk to the far right and head-butt the TNT crate from below.

6

After it blows, walk to the left. Bounce off the plain crate and spin into the "!" crate, without hitting the TNT.

7

Now, walk right and bounce off the crate, onto the "ledge" of metallic crates.

8

Stand on the middle crate and jump straight up. Stomp the hidden "!" crate

and create a stack of four crates: three extra lives and a mask.

Break them all and return to the left. Headbutt the TNT and let it blow up both crates.

Now, jump back to the left and walk onto the red gem, which carries you back to the bridge.

When you reach the end-of-level pedestal, DON'T jump on it. Instead, ride the red gem over the pedestal.

Now, walk forward until a single plank appears under your feet.

Make a huge jump forward to land on TWO hidden planks.

Keep making huge jumps upward, until you reach a ledge with the final two crates. Two extra lives -- how kind.

Return to the pedestal and jump on it to snag your "Perfect."

Cortex Power
Blue Gem

1

Play through the level (using the path we describe earlier in the book) until you reach the two extra life crates on both sides of a blue pipe.

2

Go down from the left side of the blue pipe, jumping the slime,

3

then jumping past two spiky robots. (You can stand under them and wait for a good jump.)

4

Keep going downward to a left/right fork with a blue gem on the left.

5

Ride it forward and open the mask crate.

6

Return to the left/right fork

7

and walk back down the right-hand path to the second checkpoint.

8

Continue playing through the level, until you reach the blue pipe just before the arrow and bouncy crates near the end of the level. (If you reach the crate bridge, you've gone too far. Walk back down to the blue pipe.)

9

Walk around to the left side of the pipe and wait for the blue gem to float up to you.

10

Walk onto it and you're carried down to red and blue electric pillars.

11

Walk off, and butt-up against the blue pillar. Wait for both to go off, then jump past them.

12

Continue downward, past a small slime pool to a big pool with a spiky robot.

13

Walk on the small ledge, until you see the robot; if he's on the left, jump down, but if he's on the right, walk forward and wait for the ledge to reset itself so you can try again.

14

Continue on, jumping over the red pillar and go down to find a bridge of regular and TNT crates.

15

Destroy the bridge (triggering a TNT is the easiest method) and return forward.

16

Finish the level for that satisfying "Perfect."

Lights Out
Yellow Gem

Play through the level until you reach the second swinging blade;

there's a yellow gem in the pit. Jump on the gem and it carries you upward (dig the awesome rotation!)

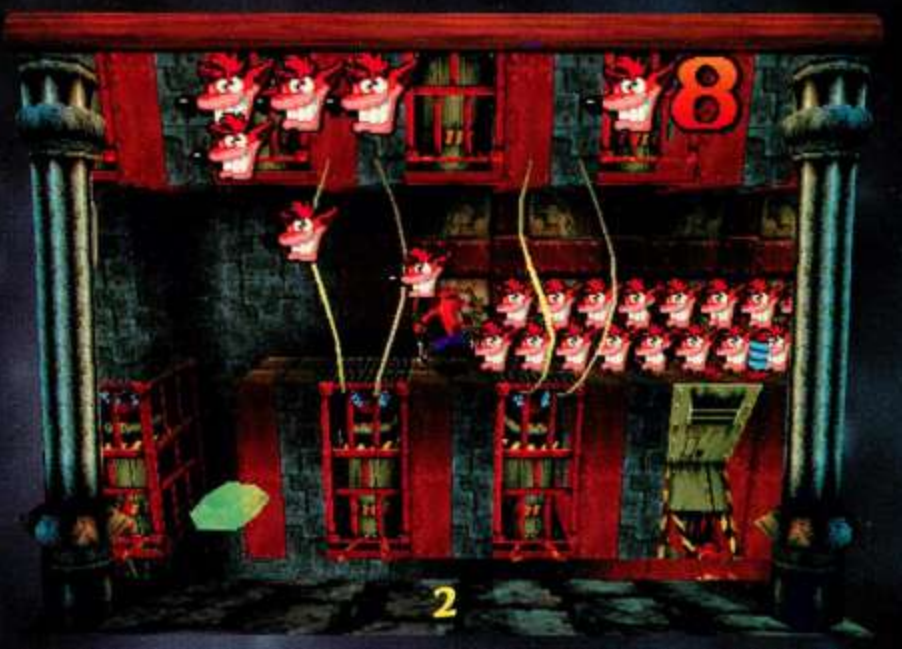
to a ledge with three crates.

Break them and hop on the end-of-level pedestal

for your "Perfect."

Castle Machinery
Green Gem

You don't need the green gem for a "Perfect" here, but what you CAN do is finish the level in a hurry and rack up almost 30 extra lives in the process. At the start of the level, simply hop onto the green gem to your left.



It takes you upward into a tunnel filled with floating extra lives.

then step on the next green gem.

Walk to the right to take all 27 of them,

Float down and jump onto the pedestal for a very easy finish, but NOT a "Perfect," since you didn't break a single crate. Remember to come back here whenever you load a saved game, so you can grab all the extra lives before you tackle any other levels.

Jaws of Darkness
Blue Gem

Play through the level, until you reach a blue gem next to a single crate.

Walk onto the gem and it floats downward to a ledge with several crates, including a mask.

Break them and the two steel crates will come together. Jump on top of them and head-butt the hidden crate above.

Jump downward across the blue gems,

to a ledge with a snake and a mask crate.

Now, jump left, across the blue gems,

to the next ledge, with a mask crate,

and then up and left to a ledge which is absolutely covered with fruit crates.

If you got all three masks coming here, you're invincible, which means you can quickly smash all the crates.

Jump forward to the next ledge, with a stack of three crates.

Break the bottom, free life, crate, then jump and break the top, free life, crate, and start jumping right on the gems before the TNT explodes.

At the next ledge, bounce up the crates to grab the extra life in the air.

Jump right to return to the level just north of where you started your blue gem "detour."

Finish the level without dying to notch up another "Perfect."

Keys

Let's move on to the keys. There are only two of these golden unlocking devices in the game, and they're earned by beating the game's two Cortex bonus rounds (see "Bonus Rounds"). The first Cortex bonus round is in the Sunset Vista level of Island #2; beat it and you earn a key that lets you enter Whole Hog, one of the game's two hidden levels.

(The key doesn't appear at Sunset Vista on the map screen; it appears at Boulder Dash, which is the level connected to Whole Hog on the map.)

The second Cortex bonus round is in the Jaws Of Darkness level on Island #3;

beat it and you earn a key to Fumbling In The Dark, on Island #3, the second hidden level.

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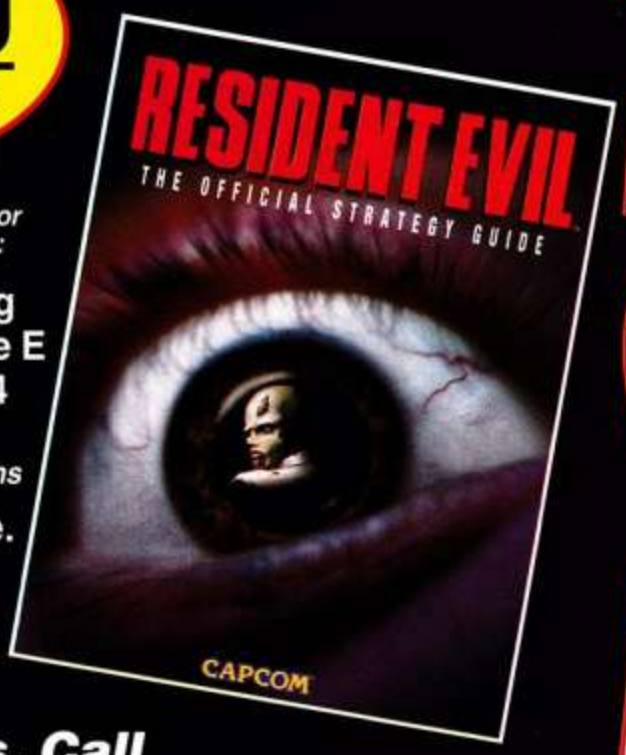

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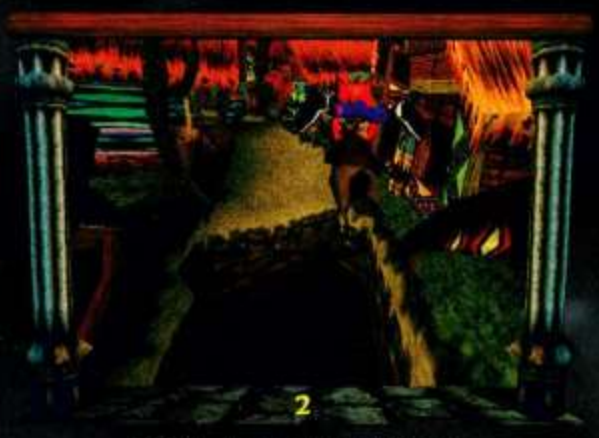
Whole Hog
Hidden Level

Crash Bandicoot has two hidden levels that you can't play until you beat two very hard bonus rounds in regular levels. (See "Secrets" for more info.) Here are walk-throughs for both, because we're nice that way.

As with Hog Wild back on Island #1, this is a level you'll need to play repeatedly before you know how to beat it. But for those of you with REALLY bad memories, here's how to steer through the level unscathed. (And don't forget to smash into every crate along the way. No "Perfect" otherwise.)

1

From the start to the first checkpoint: left, right, left, jump, right, jump, left around the native,



2

right, jump over the pit,

3

jump into the drum, jump into the drum,

4

run under the roasting pig, run under the roasting pig,

5

right, left around the native,

6

jump over the roasting pig,

7

jump into the drum,

8

hit the checkpoint.

9

From the checkpoint to the end of the level: left, left around the native,

10

jump into the drum,

12

jump into the drum,

11

right around the native,

13

run under the roasting pig,

14

jump into the drum,

15

right around the native.

16

... Perfecto!

Fumbling in the Dark
Hidden Level

1

From the start, hit the mask crate and walk downward.

2

Jump through the door into the next room, angling to the left or right side. (This is one of the tougher jumps in the level!)

3

There are three crates, with two masks and an extra life.

4

Jump diagonally, down and across, into a second room with four crates -- two extra lives and two masks.

5

Smash 'em all open, then jump back to the start and walk forward.

7

up to the first mask crate.

8

After that, it's a tasty combo of green and brown (moving) ledges until the second mask crate.

6

There are only green ledge jumps

9

Continue ahead to hit a series of swinging blades and rats.

10

There's one jump where you need to wait for a brown ledge to move towards you while the blade swings to either side.

11

There's one more jump after that before you hit the mask crate.

12

The next series of jumps is along green ledges with blades in front and in back of them.

13

Stand and wait on the green ledges as long as you can before jumping ahead.

14

You'll reach the first checkpoint.

15

Jump ahead to the next section, which has swinging blades placed between narrow ledges.

16

You'll also run into a spider, then two spiders, then a new and more aggressive spider that attacks you.

17

Jump and spin into this evil critter, then continue through several more blades to the next mask crate.

18

You'll have to bounce off spiders twice in this next section to make jumps.

20

Wait for both of them to swing, before you jump past them.

19

Between the spiders is a tricky jump with two blades swinging next to each other.

21

After the second spider is the second checkpoint.

22

Stroll ahead until your mask starts to fade. Spin into the rats to hit the mask crate ahead of you and re-light the mask.

23

Keep going forward, until you hit the final series of jumps across three spiders

24

and a green ledge to the end-of-level pedestal.

25

Man, what a nasty level! ... but we're "perfect", aren't we?

Ending: Regular

There are two endings in Crash Bandicoot: the regular ending, when you defeat Dr. Neo Cortex, and the special ending, shown when you collect all 26 gems and go through the door in The Great Hall. Assuming you've done everything as documented in this guide, you have earned the special ending. Kick back, take a load off and enjoy the fruits (pun FULLY intended) of your labor...

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

Ending: Special

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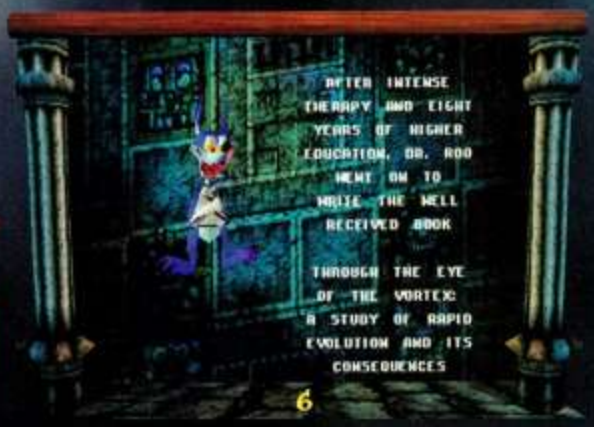

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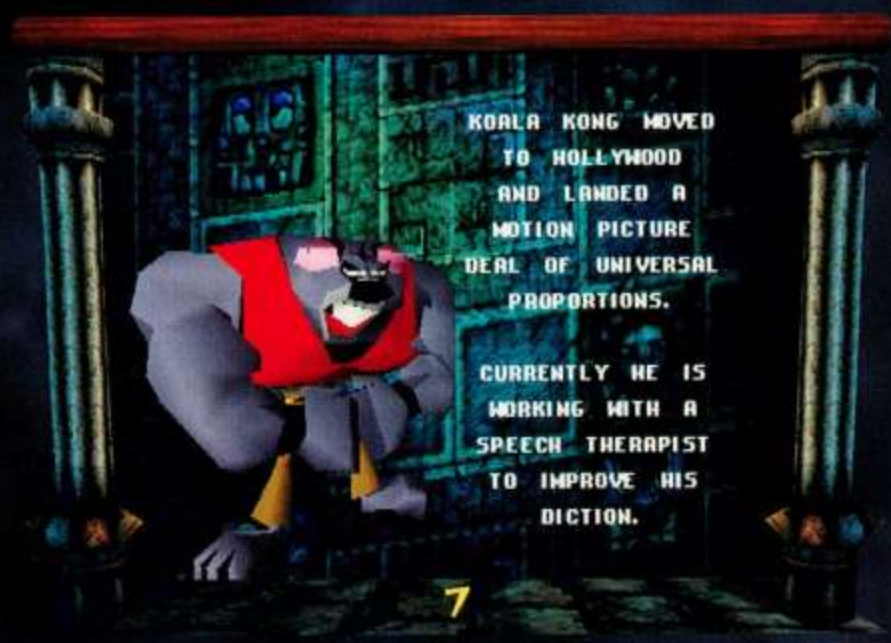

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9

10

11

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